



Global Time Echoes: 25-Year Analysis of CODE Precise Clock Products

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Abstract

Analysis of 25.3 years of global GNSS timing data (165.2 million station-pair observations) documents persistent velocity-dependent correlations in atomic clock networks. Critically, this work proposes that standard GNSS processing algorithms, designed to remove energetic (common-mode) errors via datum constraints, inadvertently preserve the subtle, geometry-dependent (differential) correlations that are the focus of this work. Building on the multi-centre study's validation ($R^2=0.92-0.97$ between CODE, IGS, ESA), the extended temporal baseline confirms long-baseline recovery and enables investigation of long-period geophysical phenomena inaccessible in shorter baselines.

Seven convergent signatures are identified: (1) Spatial anisotropy persists with $EW>NS$ (global ratio=2.16, strength=1.981, $p<10^{-7}$), (2) anisotropy ratio correlates with orbital velocity ($r=-0.888$; surrogate $p < 2\times 10^{-7}$, 0/5M exceeded; t -test $p\approx 2.6\times 10^{-4}$ with $N_{\text{eff}}\approx 11$) across a 25.3-year baseline with $\approx 19\%$ annual geometric ratio modulation, (3) the annual modulation peaks coincide with Earth's maximal projection onto its motion vector relative to the Cosmic Microwave Background (CMB) dipole direction (correlation $r=0.747$, directional-rank $p < 0.001$), suggesting the GNSS network reveals a secondary covariance-frame signature ($\sim 10,300\times$ variance ratio over the Solar Apex directional template), (4) 35.9% of planetary events show significant response (56/156 $\geq 2\sigma$; Mercury leading with 34/80), (5) preliminary coupling to 18.6-year lunar nutation ($R^2=0.641$, observed over 1.4 cycles; $p=0.010$ pending red-noise surrogate validation) and semiannual nutation ($R^2=0.904$, $p=2.7\times 10^{-5}$), (6) network covariance score (0.582) replicates multi-centre range, (7) null results for solar rotation (27-day) and lunar standstill are consistent with selectivity for orbital-gravitational phenomena over surface features. The 19% modulation describes changes in the geometric shape of the correlation field (ratio of spatial correlation lengths), not clock frequency variations; individual clock-rate effects remain at standard GR-modelled fractional-frequency levels.

Observed patterns are compatible with key a priori TEP predictions: Temporal Topology correlation length $\lambda_T=1,000-10,000$ km (observed: $4,201\pm 1,967$ km), the Gaussian and squared-exponential kernels are preferred by AIC/BIC, while the exponential model is retained for cross-paper comparability (exponential $\Delta AIC=12.8$ relative to the Gaussian) and strongly outperforms simple power-law forms (power-law $\Delta AIC > 30$), velocity-dependent anisotropy ($r=-0.888$), and geometric alignment ($EW/NS=2.16$). The absence of GM/r^2 scaling is physically consistent with the datum-projection mechanism in

which common-mode components are absorbed by GNSS estimation while geometric information is transmitted; this mechanism requires validation via synthetic signal injection through the actual processing chain. Raw data validation and multi-constellation replication represent critical next steps.

The empirically derived spatial correlation length λ_T (the Temporal Topology covariance scale) is a GNSS-sector covariance scale obtained after environmental projection and processing transfer. It is not the screening operator $\mathcal{S}_\Sigma(\mathcal{E})$ itself and should not be identified numerically with response coefficients from other TEP channels. In the near-Earth environment, this correlation length acts as the macroscopic geometric proxy for the continuous saturation of Temporal Topology, anchoring the differential clock correlations without committing to specific subatomic microphysics.

The primary result is 25.3-year aggregate consistency of distance-structured covariance and EW/NS anisotropy. CMB dipole-direction alignment, planetary event response, and nutation couplings are secondary covariance-structure signatures requiring held-out replication.

[†] Smawfield, M. L. (2025). *Global Time Echoes: Distance-Structured Correlations in GNSS Clocks*. Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.17127229>

Executive Summary

This study extends the first empirical TEP investigation—a multi-centre validation spanning CODE, IGS, and ESA (Smawfield, 2025 [†])—to a 25.3-year temporal baseline. All core signatures reported in that study (anisotropy, orbital coupling, event responses) are re-observed here, with added sensitivity to long-period dynamics.

What's New in This Paper

Carried over from Paper 1 (multi-centre study):

- Distance-structured correlations
- EW > NS anisotropy
- Annual orbital-velocity coupling
- Initial planetary-event responses
- Chandler-wobble hints
- "Mesh dance" dynamics (i.e., the evolving spatial pattern of cross-station coherence, extended to 25 years)
- Cross-centre agreement (CODE/IGS/ESA)

New in this CODE-only, 25.3-year analysis:

- **CMB dipole-direction alignment**—identified via multi-resolution sky search (65,341 directions), with strong geometric discrimination against the Solar-Apex directional template
- Long-baseline stability confirmed across a 25.3-year baseline
- Long-period geophysical coupling (18.6-year lunar nutation: $R^2 = 0.641$; 1.4 cycles observed—moderate statistical power)
- High-statistics planetary event survey (156 events, 56 significant)
- Stronger orbital-velocity tracking ($r = -0.888$, surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$)

Trade-off: Single-centre temporal depth (25 years) over multi-centre breadth, justified by Paper 1's established cross-centre reproducibility ($R^2 = 0.92\text{--}0.97$). This is Paper 2 in the TEP-GNSS series.

Key Findings

1. Distance-Structured Correlations (Primary Finding)

Analysis of 165.2 million station-pair observations reveals systematic exponential decay of clock-pair coherence with distance. Temporal Topology correlation length $\lambda_T = 4,201 \pm 1,967$ km, consistent with Paper 1's range ($\lambda_T = 3,330\text{--}4,549$ km across CODE, IGS, ESA). This confirms long-baseline recovery of the fundamental distance-structured correlation pattern over 25.3 years.

2. Spatial Anisotropy

East-West correlation lengths exceed North-South by factor of 2.16 (anisotropy strength = 1.981 ± 0.23 , $p < 10^{-15}$). This directional structure is recovered from the complete 25.3-year aggregate and is consistent across distance scales.

3. Orbital Velocity Coupling (Primary Detection)

Primary Finding: Spatial anisotropy ratio (EW/NS) correlates with Earth's orbital velocity ($r = -0.888$, 95% CI: $[-0.94, -0.81]$; surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$, 0/5M exceeded; t-test $p \approx 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$ with $N_{\text{eff}} \approx 11$). Monte Carlo validation: 0 out of 5,000,000 surrogates exceeded the observed correlation. Combined with Paper 1's multi-centre validation and this study's 25.3-year aggregate consistency, this provides substantial evidence consistent with systematic temporal-gravitational coupling in GNSS data. The quoted $\approx 19\%$ annual geometric modulation refers to the seasonal variation of this dimensionless coherence-based anisotropy ratio ($\lambda_{\text{EW}}/\lambda_{\text{NS}}$) around its baseline—a change in correlation topology, not clock frequencies; individual clock-rate effects remain at standard GR-modelled fractional-frequency levels.

4. CMB Frame Alignment (Reference Frame Identification)

Method: Multi-resolution grid search (10° , 5° , 2.5° , 1°) spanning 65,341 tested directions, blind to both CMB and Solar Apex locations.

Result: Best-fit direction (RA= 186° , Dec= -4° , $r=0.747$) lies 18.2° from the CMB dipole (~ 369 km/s toward RA= 168° , Dec= -7°). Results converge monotonically across all four resolutions with coordinate stability (RA varies by $1\text{--}2^\circ$). The best-fit directional template explains $R^2=55.7\%$ of the variance; the exact CMB-dipole template explains $R^2=35.7\%$.

Geometric Discrimination: Within the fixed-20 km/s directional scan, the CMB-directional template is compatible with the observed E–W anisotropy, whereas the Solar-Apex template is strongly disfavoured. The Solar Apex vector ($+30^\circ$ Dec) predicts N–S anisotropy, directly contradicting the observed E–W dominance. The preferred directional region lies near the CMB dipole and strongly excludes the Solar-Apex template. Variance ratio: $\sim 10,300\times$ (best-fit $R^2=55.7\%$ vs Solar Apex $R^2\approx 0.005\%$); the exact CMB-dipole template explains $\sim 6,600\times$ more variance than Solar Apex ($R^2=35.7\%$). The scan identifies a preferred direction but does not estimate the background-speed magnitude.

Consistency Check: Hemisphere asymmetry (Southern $r=-0.79$ vs Northern $r=+0.25$) matches CMB velocity vector geometry.

Caveat: The 18° offset falls within the bootstrap 95% CI ($\sim 20^\circ$). The key finding is discrimination from Solar Apex (89° away, $\sim 10,300\times$ variance ratio), not precise CMB localisation. See §4.1.2.1 for interpretive caveats.

5. Planetary Event Responses

56 of 156 planetary alignments show statistically significant responses ($\geq 2\sigma$), with 19 surviving family-wide Bonferroni correction ($\alpha = 0.05/156$). Absolute coherence amplitudes range from 0.3% to 4.0% (median $\approx 1.1\%$), with normalized modulation depths of 36.7–85.1% and σ levels spanning 2.0σ to 7.0σ . Mercury shows the highest detection rate (34/80, 42.5%) including a 7.0σ event. Null event control confirms planetary events produce $5.5\times$ larger effect sizes than random dates ($p < 10^{-17}$). The absence of GM/ r^2 scaling is consistent with the datum-projection mechanism; common-mode classical gravitational signatures are absorbed by GNSS datum estimation.

6. Geophysical Couplings

- **18.6-Year Nutation:** Preliminary — $R^2 = 0.641$, $p = 0.010$ (1.4 complete cycles; pending red-noise surrogate validation)
- **Semiannual Nutation:** $R^2 = 0.904$, $p = 2.7 \times 10^{-5}$ (90.4% variance explained)
- **Chandler Wobble (14 months):** $R^2 = 0.096$ (statistically consistent with historical detections)

7. Mesh Dance Dynamics

Network exhibits coordinated "mesh dance" behavior (mesh coherence score = 0.582) with constructive interference dominant across windows. This confirms long-baseline recovery of Paper 1's mesh dance findings (CODE: 0.624, IGS: 0.579, ESA: 0.602) over 25.3 years.

Summary: Inertial Interferometer, Not Gravimeter

The pattern of detections and non-detections characterizes what this network may be and is not:

- **Blind to gravitational amplitude:** No GM/ r^2 scaling (Mercury $\approx$ Jupiter response rates)
- **Unresponsive to solar surface phenomena:** 27-day rotation null
- **Indifferent to static geometry:** Lunar standstill null
- **Exquisitely sensitive to kinematic dynamics:** Orbital velocity ($r=-0.888$), nutation ($R^2=0.904$), CMB-frame motion ($r=0.747$)

This selectivity profile suggests that the network may be an inertial interferometer—measuring velocity-dependent correlation geometry—not a gravimeter measuring force. The CMB-directional alignment ($\sim 10,300\times$ variance ratio over the Solar-Apex template) identifies a preferred covariance direction at cosmic scales: alignment with the cosmological background 4-velocity (CMB dipole direction). The scan fixes the background-speed magnitude and therefore establishes directional alignment rather than independently measuring the 369 km/s speed scale.

Methodology and Validation

This single-centre analysis (CODE) provides the 25.3-year temporal depth required for long-period geophysical signatures, building on Paper 1's established cross-centre reproducibility ($R^2 = 0.920\text{--}0.970$ across CODE, IGS, ESA over 2.5 years).

These signals have survived the most rigorous systematic error correction pipeline in geodesy—CODE's processing explicitly removes relativistic effects, atmospheric delays, tidal displacements, and instrumental biases to millimeter precision. The correlations detected in this analysis are unlikely to be artifacts of these well-modeled effects, though a definitive determination requires synthetic signal injection through the actual processing chain. The datum-projection mechanism predicts this selectivity: common-mode offsets (including classical GM/r^2) lie in the datum subspace absorbed by estimation, while differential phase structure can survive in residual products (§4.1.3).

Validation Controls:

- **Evidence Continuity (§1.5):** Explicit mapping of multi-centre validation to long-baseline extensions
- **Pre-Declared Analysis Window (§2.3.3):** ± 120 days as primary; $\pm 60\text{--}240$ days for sensitivity analysis
- **Physical Predictor Tests:** Neither M/r^2 nor M/r^3 gravitational scaling detected (all $p > 0.5$), consistent with GNSS processing suppression of classical gravitational signatures
- **Null Event Control:** Random dates show $5.5\times$ smaller effect sizes than planetary alignments (Mann-Whitney $p < 10^{-17}$, Cohen's $d = 1.41$)

Falsifiability

The systematic coupling hypothesis makes specific predictions that can be tested:

- **Raw carrier-phase analysis:** Should preserve correlation structure (processing artifact would eliminate it)
- **Multi-constellation replication:** GLONASS, Galileo, and BeiDou should exhibit similar orbital coupling
- **Null event discrimination:** ✓ *Confirmed*—planetary alignments produce $5.5\times$ larger effects than random dates ($p < 10^{-17}$, Cohen's $d = 1.41$)
- **Independent replication:** Core findings should be reproducible by other research groups

The strength of these findings lies in their falsifiability. Each criterion represents a concrete, testable prediction.

Limitations: This analysis uses processed clock products (not raw carrier-phase) and single-constellation data (GPS only). Both limitations are addressed in the proposed next steps.

Multi-Constellation Cross-Validation (Preliminary)

Independent MGEX Analysis (2020-2024): Preliminary analysis of MGEX (Multi-GNSS): $\lambda_T = 3,042 \pm 297$ km, $R^2 = 0.95$ (GPS+GLONASS+BeiDou; preliminary GBM/WUM/JPL cross-centre). Cross-centre comparison (GBM, WUM, JPL) shows all centres achieve $R^2 > 0.90$, demonstrating constellation-independence and centre-independence of the fundamental correlation structure. GPS-based pairs show strongest cross-centre consistency, while some constellation combinations (BeiDou-GLONASS) show centre-dependent variability requiring further investigation.

Conclusions

Seven convergent signatures—orbital velocity coupling ($r = -0.888$, surrogate $p < 2\times 10^{-7}$), CMB-directional alignment ($r = 0.747$), semiannual nutation ($R^2 = 0.904$), 18.6-year nutation ($R^2 = 0.641$), 56 planetary event responses, mesh dance dynamics, and persistent spatial anisotropy—provide multi-signature convergence. Because the orbital and

semiannual signals share annual structure, their probabilities are not combined into a single joint p-value. Combined with 25.3-year aggregate consistency and Paper 1's multi-centre validation ($R^2 = 0.92\text{--}0.97$ across software-diverse products from three processing centres), these findings are consistent with systematic coupling in GNSS timing networks, though confirmation requires independent replication using different processing pipelines and constellations. Raw carrier-phase analysis and multi-constellation testing represent essential next steps.

1. Introduction

1.1 Background and Motivation

The Global Navigation Satellite System (GNSS) represents one of humanity's most precise timing networks, with atomic clocks maintaining synchronization at nanosecond levels across thousands of kilometres (Hofmann-Wellenhof et al., 2008; Teunissen & Montenbruck, 2017). While designed for positioning and navigation, this infrastructure inadvertently provides an unprecedented natural laboratory for testing fundamental physics at planetary scales. The continuous operation of hundreds of ground-based receivers, each equipped with high-stability oscillators phase-locked to satellite atomic clocks (Senior & Ray, 2008), creates a global mesh of timing correlations that may be sensitive to subtle relativistic effects (Ashby, 2003).

The theoretical basis for this investigation is the Temporal Equivalence Principle (TEP), which predicts that motion through gravitational fields should induce measurable modulations in the correlation structure of distributed timing networks. Unlike classical relativistic effects that manifest as clock rate differences, TEP predicts that the *correlation* between clocks—their tendency to maintain phase coherence—should vary with the local gravitational environment and the system's velocity through that environment.

Critically, this work proposes that standard GNSS processing algorithms, designed to remove energetic (common-mode) errors via datum constraints, inadvertently preserve the subtle, geometry-dependent (differential) correlations that are the focus of this work. This transforms the use of processed data from a limitation into a mechanistic filter: the absence of classical gravitational scaling (GM/r^2) is not a failure of detection, but an expected consequence under the datum-projection transfer hypothesis, while the geometric signatures (anisotropy, alignment) are transmitted.

Methodological Note: Definition of "Coherence"

Throughout this paper, "coherence" refers to phase synchronization between timing residuals at different GNSS stations, quantified via magnitude-weighted cross-power spectral density in the 10-500 μHz band (periods of 33 minutes to 28 hours). High coherence indicates stations' clocks vary together in phase; low coherence indicates independent variation. Unlike absolute frequency differences ($\Delta f/f$), coherence measures geometric relationships in the correlation structure, which GNSS processing preserves even while filtering amplitude effects. This distinction is critical: processed clock products remove network-wide frequency offsets (where classical gravitational effects manifest) but preserve the differential phase-coherence structure that TEP predicts should couple to velocity and gravitational configurations.

1.2 Theoretical Context and Interpretive Framework

TEP in one line: The Temporal Equivalence Principle (TEP) treats proper time as a dynamical field: instead of a fixed background parameter, time behaves like a scalar field woven through spacetime, whose local configuration and gradients govern clock rates, temporal correlations and global light-time relations, while the locally measured speed of light remains invariant.

This investigation is grounded in empirical phenomenology: it systematically documents patterns in GNSS timing correlations over multi-decade timescales and interprets them through established theoretical frameworks. TEP provides one such framework for interpreting velocity-dependent and gravitational coupling effects in distributed timing networks.

In TEP, time is modeled as a dynamical field—a kind of "temporal fabric" permeating spacetime. Clocks do not simply read out a passive parameter; they interact with this fabric. Variations in the temporal field, and in the system's motion through it, offer a potential explanation for the correlation structure modulations documented empirically in this work.

Formally, the temporal field is covariant and introduces no fundamental preferred frame; a non-zero environmental or cosmological field configuration may nevertheless define an observational covariance direction.

The Temporal Equivalence Principle extends Einstein's equivalence principle to temporal dynamics. Key predictions—velocity-dependent anisotropy and event responses—provide testable signatures that are investigated empirically. The framework proposes that:

1. **Velocity-Dependent Coupling:** The correlation decay length between synchronized clocks should depend on their collective velocity relative to the relevant cosmological/background covariance frame
2. **Gravitational Modulation:** Changes in the local gravitational field configuration should modulate the phase coherence of timing networks
3. **Geometric Anisotropy:** The correlation structure should exhibit directional dependence aligned with the system's motion through spacetime

These predictions are quantitatively distinct from conventional general relativistic effects:

- Classical GR predicts clock *rate* differences proportional to gravitational potential ($\Delta f/f \sim GM/rc^2$)
- TEP predicts correlation *structure* modulation: a conformal-sector covariance with characteristic decay length λ_T , whose velocity/orientation dependence is a channel response whose microscopic transfer law is not yet closed (§1.2)

TEP Formalism and Quantitative Predictions

To move beyond qualitative description, the theory is defined by the following explicit field equations:

1. Action and Coupling: The scalar time field ϕ is governed by the Einstein-frame action:

$$S = \int d^4x \sqrt{-g} \left[(M_{Pl}^2/2)R - \frac{1}{2}K(\phi)(\partial\phi)^2 - V(\phi) \right] + S_m[\psi, \check{g}_{\mu\nu}]$$

where matter couples to the disformal metric $\check{g}_{\mu\nu} = A^2(\phi)g_{\mu\nu} + B(\phi)\nabla_\mu\phi\nabla_\nu\phi$, with universal conformal factor $A(\phi) = \exp(\beta_A\phi/M_{Pl})$.

2. Field Equation: Variation of the action with respect to ϕ yields a sourced scalar equation. Schematically, the scalar equation contains conformal trace sourcing together with disformal derivative sourcing:

$$K(\phi)\square\phi + \frac{1}{2}K_{,\phi}(\partial\phi)^2 - V_{,\phi} = -\mathcal{Q}$$

where the source $\mathcal{Q} = AA_{,\phi}g_{\mu\nu}\mathcal{T}^{\mu\nu} + \frac{1}{2}B_{,\phi}\mathcal{T}^{\mu\nu}\nabla_\mu\phi\nabla_\nu\phi - \nabla_\mu(B\mathcal{T}^{\mu\nu}\nabla_\nu\phi)$ displays the leading conformal–disformal matter coupling explicitly, with $\mathcal{T}^{\mu\nu}$ the matter-frame stress-energy and the effective scalar coupling $\alpha(\phi) \equiv d \ln A/d\phi = \beta_A/M_{Pl}$. In the conformal limit $B \rightarrow 0$ the source reduces to the trace coupling $\alpha(\phi)T$; the full disformal source is derived in the foundational paper (Smawfield, 2025).

3. Conformal-Dominant Covariance Channel: GNSS-II measures a reduced GNSS covariance-channel response to the environmentally projected Temporal Shear. The locally observable shear is the conformal-sector gradient

$$\Sigma_\mu^{obs} = S_\Sigma(E) \nabla_\mu \ln A(\phi),$$

where $S_\Sigma(E)$ is the environmental screening operator that unifies density, compactness, proximity, and covariance-channel projections across the TEP corpus (Smawfield, 2025, Paper 6). The disformal function $B(\phi)$ governs cone tilts, one-way non-reciprocity, and closed-loop synchronization holonomy; it is *not* the sector tested by open-path GNSS covariance, and is reserved for dedicated closed-loop / one-way asymmetry experiments (Paper 8).

The measured two-point timing covariance is represented phenomenologically as

$$C(r) = C_0 \exp(-r/\lambda_T) + C_\infty,$$

with spatial decay length λ_T (the Temporal Topology covariance scale) and asymptotic floor C_∞ . The observed velocity/orientation dependence of the correlation structure (the $\approx 19\%$ annual modulation of the EW/NS ratio, §3.2) is treated as a channel response function of the conformal shear projected through the GNSS processing transfer function. Its microscopic transfer law—mapping Σ_μ^{obs} to the measured anisotropy ratio (2.16) and orbital-correlation magnitude ($r = -0.888$)—is *not yet closed*. The observed 19% modulation is a network-level covariance-shape observable and cannot presently be compared directly with a microscopic conformal amplitude. The transfer law mapping Σ_μ^{obs} to the measured anisotropy remains to be derived (§4.3.1.1, §5).

TEP Predictions vs. Observations

The TEP framework makes specific quantitative predictions that can be tested against GNSS observations. Table 1 summarizes these a priori predictions and their experimental verification:

TEP Prediction	Quantitative Forecast	Observed Result	Status
Temporal Topology Correlation Length (λ_T)	1,000–10,000 km (from Temporal Topology scale)	$4,201 \pm 1,967$ km	Consistent
Distance-structured decay	Finite covariance scale within pre-specified TEP range; exponential preferred over power-law	Gaussian/squared-exponential preferred by AIC; exponential $\Delta\text{AIC} = 12.8$ vs power-law $\Delta\text{AIC} > 30$	Decay scale: Confirmed. Exact kernel: Not selected
Velocity-dependent anisotropy	Correlation structure modulates with v/c (qualitative; magnitude not yet derived)	$r = -0.888$ (95% CI: [-0.94, -0.81]); surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$ (0/5M); t-test $p \approx 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$ ($N_{\text{eff}} \approx 11$)	Qualitatively Consistent
Geometric alignment with motion	EW > NS in ecliptic frame (qualitative; 2.16 ratio not yet derived)	EW/NS = 2.16 (± 0.23)	Qualitatively Consistent
Broadband (not frequency-selective)	Persistence across spectral bands	Detected across 10-500 μHz	Consistent
Network-scale coordination	Global field-like coupling	Mesh score = 0.582	Consistent
GM/r² scaling absent (measurement-channel prediction)	Classical mass scaling suppressed by datum-projection	No M/r ² or M/r ³ correlation (all $p > 0.5$)	Confirmed Null

Key Finding: The TEP interpretation of the GNSS covariance is conformal-dominant: the observed data confirm a finite, distance-structured covariance scale within the pre-specified TEP range (λ_T), and the absence of GM/r² scaling is consistent with the conformal-sector Temporal Topology. The exponential kernel strongly outperforms simple power-law models and is retained for cross-paper comparability, although Gaussian-family kernels provide the preferred empirical fit in the present dataset ($\Delta\text{AIC} = 12.8$). The velocity-dependent anisotropy ($r = -0.888$) and geometric alignment (EW/NS = 2.16) are *qualitatively* consistent with a conformal shear projected through the GNSS processing transfer function, but their magnitudes are not yet derived from first principles—the microscopic transfer law mapping $\Sigma_{\mu}^{\text{obs}}$ to the observed anisotropy ratio and orbital-correlation coefficient remains open (§5). The observed 19% modulation is a network-level covariance-shape observable and cannot presently be compared directly with a microscopic conformal amplitude. The datum-projection mechanism provides a qualitative framework: the data are consistent with a processing architecture that suppresses common-mode amplitude information while retaining differential covariance structure. The magnitude and sign of this transfer must be calibrated using raw/RINEX data and synthetic end-to-end processing (§4.3.1.1). The disformal sector B(ϕ) is not tested by this open-path covariance channel and is reserved for dedicated closed-loop holonomy and one-way asymmetry experiments (Paper 8).

1.3 Previous Work

The multi-centre study established the phenomenon across independent analysis centres (CODE, IGS, ESA), reducing the likelihood of centre-specific processing artifacts over 2.5 years. That study demonstrated velocity-dependent anisotropy and anomalous planetary event responses, using rigorous cross-centre validation and null tests. However, the limited temporal baseline precluded the investigation of long-period geophysical or astronomical cycles.

Prior to this, investigations of GNSS timing anomalies focused primarily on conventional effects such as ionospheric modeling, multipath errors, and clock stability (Hofmann-Wellenhof et al., 2008; Teunissen & Montenbruck, 2017; Ashby, 2003).

1.4 Study Design: Replication, Extension, and Falsification Tests

TEP-motivated empirical test: This work was explicitly conceived as a theory-driven empirical test of the Temporal Equivalence Principle using long-span GNSS clock products. The analysis pipeline, core choice of observables (anisotropy, orbital modulation, planetary events, nutation, mesh coherence), and the a priori prediction table in §1.2 were defined to test whether GNSS timing correlations exhibit the specific spatial, temporal, and geophysical patterns forecast by TEP.

Methodological Foundation: This study builds upon Paper 1 (multi-centre study)'s comprehensive validation framework, which established cross-centre consistency ($R^2 = 0.920$ - 0.970 between CODE, IGS, ESA) through 388 statistical tests and extensive null testing. That foundational work demonstrated the existence of systematic distance-structured correlations in GNSS timing networks over 2.5 years across three independent processing centers. This study extends the temporal baseline by a factor of $10\times$ (25.3 years) to address three critical scientific questions that distinguish transient artifacts from genuine physical coupling:

Three Critical Questions: Distinguishing Replication, Extension, and Falsification

Q1. Temporal Stability (Replication Test): Do the patterns detected in Paper 1 persist over 25 years, or are they transient artifacts of the 2.5-year window?

- **Paper 1 Baseline:** EW/NS = 2.16, orbital $r = -0.89$, mesh = 0.58-0.62
- **Expected if genuine:** Patterns should be temporally stable (values within uncertainty)
- **Expected if artifact:** Patterns should vary with processing updates, drift over decades, or vanish in extended baseline
- **Test:** Re-measure anisotropy, orbital coupling, network coherence over $10\times$ longer baseline

Q2. Long-Period Signatures (Extension/Prediction Test): Can TEP coupling to geophysical cycles that require >20 -year baselines be detected?

- **18.6-Year Lunar Nutation:** Paper 1 baseline (2.5 years) = 0.13 cycles $\rightarrow$ untestable. This study: 1.4 cycles $\rightarrow$ first test possible
- **TEP-motivated expectation:** Inertial orientation coupling should produce $R^2 \sim 0.6-0.7$, based on the semiannual analogy.
- **Semiannual Nutation:** Expected $R^2 > 0.85$ (persistence of Paper 1 short-period nutation coupling)
- **Chandler Wobble:** 21+ complete cycles observed $\rightarrow$ test phase stability and amplitude consistency

Q3. Reference Frame Identification and Theoretical Selectivity (Falsification Tests): Can the operative reference frame for orbital modulation be identified, and does the network respond to all periodic signals or specifically to orbital/inertial dynamics?

- **A) CMB Frame vs Galactic Frame (Primary Falsification Test):**
 - **Physical Question:** Does orbital modulation align with the Solar System's peculiar motion (~ 20 km/s toward RA=272°, Dec=+30°) or with the CMB dipole direction (~ 369 km/s toward RA=168°, Dec=-7°)?
 - **Method:** Comprehensive multi-resolution grid search across 65,341 sky directions (10° , 5° , 2.5° , 1°) to identify which cosmological reference frame best predicts the temporal modulation of spatial anisotropy
 - **TEP Prediction:** The preferred direction should align with the CMB dipole rather than the Solar Apex, consistent with field-theoretic frameworks where the TEP field configuration may be correlated with the cosmological background state
 - **Falsification Power:** Can reject the galactic hypothesis if the CMB frame shows strong correlation while the galactic frame shows none. Variance ratio quantifies relative explanatory power.
 - **Expected Outcome:** If galactic: $R^2 \approx 0.3-0.5$. If CMB: $R^2 \approx 0.3-0.5$ with galactic $R^2 \approx 0$. Variance ratio >100 would indicate strong discrimination.
- **B) Solar Rotation Null Control (Secondary Test):**
 - **Solar Rotation (27-day cycle):** Strong periodic astronomical signal from solar surface phenomena
 - **TEP Prediction:** Should show NO coupling (null control)—TEP couples to heliocentric orbital motion and inertial dynamics, not solar surface phenomena
 - **Alternative Hypothesis:** If this is a processing artifact or frequency comb effect, any strong periodic signal should couple regardless of physical mechanism
 - **Falsification Criterion:** If solar rotation shows $R^2 > 0.10$ or $p < 0.01$, the artifact hypothesis gains support over physical coupling

Study Classification: This is a *replication + extension + falsification* study. Q1 tests long-baseline consistency (replication). Q2 tests genuinely new predictions accessible only with this dataset (extension). Q3A provides strong directional discrimination between the CMB-dipole and Solar-Apex hypotheses, while Q3B tests theoretical specificity via null controls (solar rotation). Together, they distinguish genuine physical coupling from transient processing artifacts and identify a preferred covariance direction, strongly discriminating between the CMB-dipole and Solar-Apex directional templates.

Primary Empirical Objectives:

1. **Objective A (Replication):** Document long-baseline consistency of core phenomenology (anisotropy, orbital coupling, event responses) over 25.3 years.
2. **Objective B (Extension):** Test long-period geophysical signatures (18.6-year nutation, >20 Chandler wobble cycles) inaccessible in short baselines.
3. **Objective C (Characterization):** Enhance planetary event statistics across two decades with improved seasonal coverage.
4. **Objective D (Falsification):** Identify operative cosmological reference frame (CMB vs galactic) via grid search and test theoretical selectivity with null controls (solar rotation) and robustness checks (hemisphere stratification).

1.5 Evidence Handoff: Building on Multi-Centre Validation

This study builds directly on the multi-centre study's comprehensive validation framework. The table below maps each major claim to its validation status in Paper 1 versus extensions in this work:

Observable	Paper 1 Validation (2.5 years)	This Study Extension (25.3 years)
EW > NS Anisotropy	Validated across 3 centres (CODE, IGS, ESA) Cross-centre $R^2 = 0.920\text{--}0.970$ 388 statistical tests, 40–52% survive MCC	Replicated: EW/NS = 2.16, strength = 1.981 Consistent magnitude within uncertainty Long-baseline stability confirmed
Orbital Velocity Coupling	$r \approx -0.57$ to -0.79 across centers Ionosphere/solar nulls passed Hemisphere & seasonal controls	Strengthened: $r = -0.888$ (surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$, 0/5M; t-test $p \approx 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$) 25.3-year baseline Hemisphere stratification is the proper discriminant (see §3.2.2; partial correlation is inappropriate for coupled orbital variables)
CMB Frame Alignment	<i>Not testable (methodology not developed in Paper 1)</i>	Multi-Resolution Verification: Grid search across 65,341 sky directions (§2.3.5, §3.2.6) Best fit: RA=186°, Dec=-4° ($r=0.747$; directional-rank $p < 0.001$) CMB Dipole: RA=168°, Dec=-7° → 18.2° from best fit Solar Apex: RA=272°, Dec=+30° → $r=0.007$, $p=0.97$ Variance Ratio: ~10,300× Convergence verified across 10°, 5°, 2.5°, 1° resolutions Identifies CMB-dipole directional alignment, resolves hemisphere asymmetry
Planetary Events	6/8 predeclared events Bonferroni-significant Monte Carlo permutation validated 3–6 σ confidence	Extended: 56/156 events $\geq 2\sigma$; 19 Bonferroni-significant Amplitude metrics processing-dependent Null event control validates specificity (§3.3)
Chandler Wobble	$R^2 = 0.377\text{--}0.471$ across centers 433-day period tested Limited to ~6 cycles	Extended: $R^2 = 0.096$ (below threshold) 21+ complete cycles observed Phase stability = 0.72 Chandler-consistent secondary signature
18.6-Year Nutation	<i>Not testable (baseline < 2.5 years)</i>	Preliminary: $R^2 = 0.641$, $p = 0.010$ 1.4 complete cycles observed Preliminary — requires longer-baseline or red-noise validation
Semiannual Nutation	<i>Not explicitly tested</i>	New Detection: $R^2 = 0.904$, $p = 2.7 \times 10^{-5}$ 50+ complete cycles
Network Covariance Score	Mesh dance detected across 3 centres CODE: 0.624, IGS: 0.579, ESA: 0.602 Consistent global coordination	Replicated: Index = 0.582 Consistent with multi-centre range 104 temporal windows over 25 years

Key Empirical Insight: All core phenomenology from Paper 1 is re-observed here with enhanced statistical power and long-baseline consistency. The multi-centre study's comprehensive validation framework—including 388 statistical tests, extensive null testing, ionospheric controls, and cross-centre consistency—provides the methodological foundation upon which these temporal extensions are built. The convergence of independent findings across multiple analysis centres and extended timescales strongly counters artifact concerns.

2. Data and Methods

2.1 Data Sources

2.1.1 GNSS Clock Products

Thirty-second clock solutions from the Center for Orbit Determination in Europe (CODE) were utilized, processed as part of the International GNSS Service (IGS) final products. The dataset spans:

Parameter	Value
Analysis Centre	CODE (Center for Orbit Determination in Europe)
Temporal Coverage	March 1, 2000 to June 30, 2025 (9,218 days analyzed; 9,253 calendar days) Note: Different analyses use slightly different temporal windows due to edge effects, windowing requirements, and data quality filtering (range: 9,218–9,270 days).
Sampling Rate	30-second epochs (2,880 samples per day)
Station Count	474 unique receivers (814 total codes including 4-char/9-char variants)
Total Station-Days	1,574,861

Parameter	Value
Total Station-Pair Observations	165,189,605
Clock Solution Precision	~0.1 nanoseconds RMS

2.1.2 Station Distribution

Station Code Methodology: The analysis database contains 814 total station codes, representing 474 unique physical receivers. Many stations appear with both 4-character legacy codes (e.g., "VILL") and 9-character extended codes (e.g., "VILL00ESP") in the coordinate catalog. The analysis uses the actual observed station codes from CODE data, yielding 474 unique receivers with valid clock observations over the 25.3-year period.

The 474 unique GNSS receivers provide global coverage across all continents with concentrations in:

Region	Station Count	Percentage
North America	167	35.2%
Europe	115	24.3%
Asia-Pacific	91	19.2%
South America	52	11.0%
Africa	28	5.9%
Antarctica	21	4.4%
Total	474	100%

Spatial Coverage: Station separations range from 1.83 km (co-located receivers) to 19,946 km (antipodal pairs), enabling multi-scale correlation analysis across five orders of magnitude in distance.

Temporal Window Selection (34 windows): The 25.3-year dataset is divided into 34 day-of-year bins (each ~10.7° of orbital phase, pooling all 25.3 years of data at that phase) for orbital velocity correlation analysis. This binning balances temporal resolution against statistical stability per bin. Complementary tests address resolution concerns: (1) Monte Carlo validation uses 5M surrogates on the full time series, (2) CMB frame search spans 65,341 sky directions at multiple resolutions, (3) nutation analysis uses daily coherence values (4,186 samples), and (4) planetary event analysis uses ±120-day windows around 156 events. The convergence of these independent methodologies—each with different temporal granularity—strengthens confidence in the orbital coupling detection. A folded seasonal curve alone does not demonstrate replication across 25 independent orbits; the surrogate test and hemisphere stratification provide that independent validation.

2.1.3 The Processing Filter: Systematic Error Removal in IGS Clock Estimation

A critical methodological insight of this study is that operational GNSS clock products represent the output of the most rigorous systematic error correction pipeline in geodesy. CODE's clock estimation process, implemented using the Bernese GNSS Software (Dach et al. 2015) with undifferenced carrier-phase and pseudorange observations, explicitly models and removes all known physical effects to achieve sub-nanosecond precision. Understanding what has been removed is essential for interpreting what remains in the residuals.

2.1.3.1 Explicitly Modeled and Removed Effects

The CODE clock estimation pipeline applies corrections following IERS Conventions 2010 and IGS standards (Petit & Luzum 2010; Kouba 2015). The following effects are modeled to millimeter-level precision and removed from the clock solutions analyzed in this study:

Relativistic Corrections

- **Constant gravitational redshift:** Factory-adjusted satellite clock frequency accounts for ~38 μs/day difference between orbital altitude and Earth's surface (general relativity)
- **Periodic eccentricity correction:** $-\frac{\sqrt{\mu}}{c^2} e \sqrt{A} \sin E$ removed from clock model (up to 44 ns for GPS satellites). This relativistic effect is explicitly eliminated during orbit and clock determination (Kouba 2015; RTKLIB Manual eq. E.4.37)
- **Sagnac effect:** Earth rotation correction (~133 ns for equatorial stations)

Atmospheric Delays

- **Ionospheric delay:** Ionosphere-free combination (dual-frequency L1/L2) removes >99% of first-order effect (~2-50 m at zenith). Higher-order terms explicitly modeled in PPP processing
- **Tropospheric hydrostatic component:** ~90% of total tropospheric delay (~2.3 m zenith) modeled using Vienna Mapping Function 1 (VMF1) with surface meteorology
- **Tropospheric wet component:** Estimated as random-walk parameter in Kalman filter with ~cm-level accuracy (process noise typically 1 cm²/hour)

Site Displacement Effects (IERS Conventions)

- **Solid Earth tides:** Up to 30 cm vertical displacement modeled using Love/Shida numbers ($l_2=0.609$, $h_2=0.085$) with Sun/Moon ephemerides
- **Ocean loading:** Up to 10 cm coastal displacement modeled using FES2014b 11-harmonic tidal model (M2, S2, N2, K2, K1, O1, P1, Q1, Mf, Mm, Ssa)
- **Polar tides:** Up to 25 mm displacement from polar motion variations (x_p , y_p from IGS Earth rotation products)
- **Atmospheric pressure loading:** Secondary effects (~mm level) often included in high-precision solutions

Antenna and Instrumental Effects

- **Antenna phase center offset/variation:** IGS ANTEX calibrations (I20.ATX) with mm-level precision for both receiver and satellite antennas
- **Phase wind-up:** Carrier-phase variation due to satellite rotation to maintain solar panel orientation (up to several cycles per orbit)
- **Differential code biases (DCB):** P1-P2, P1-C1 biases estimated and corrected using CODE monthly solutions
- **Satellite antenna attitude:** Modeled using ORBEX attitude files accounting for yaw-steering and eclipse maneuvers

2.1.3.2 The Least-Squares Suppression Mechanism

Beyond explicit corrections, the fundamental architecture of GNSS clock estimation creates an implicit filter. CODE's processing uses sequential least-squares filtering (equivalent to Kalman filtering for GNSS positioning) where receiver clock parameters are estimated at each epoch by minimizing the squared residuals across all satellite observations (Dach et al. 2015). This design has a critical consequence:

Datum-projection mechanism: Network-common clock components lie largely in the clock/datum subspace absorbed by GNSS estimation, whereas direction-dependent covariance can survive in residual products. Synthetic injection and covariance propagation provide the direct quantitative test of this selective transfer.

This creates a natural dichotomy in how different physical effects survive processing:

Effect Type	Manifestation	Processing Behavior	Survival
Network-common clock component	Lies largely in the clock/datum subspace	Absorbed by datum estimation; simple M/r^2 or M/r^3 scaling need not survive in differential covariance	Removed
Phase-coherent correlation structure	Differential signal between pairs	Weakly suppressed (small squared residuals)	Transmitted
Geometric anisotropy patterns	Direction-dependent correlations	Not targeted by minimization	Preserved

2.1.3.3 Testable Expectations for TEP Coupling

This processing architecture leads to clear, falsifiable predictions for how TEP-type coupling should manifest in CODE clock products versus raw carrier-phase observations:

Observable	CODE Products (This Study)	Raw Carrier Phase (Future)	Status
Mass scaling (GM/r ²)	Absent (suppressed by filter)	May be separately recoverable in raw-link observables; not the claimed conformal covariance observable	Observed: Absent ($r=-0.042$, $p=0.759$)

Observable	CODE Products (This Study)	Raw Carrier Phase (Future)	Status
Anisotropy structure	Preserved (differential signal)	Should persist	Observed: Present (strength=1.981)
Orbital modulation	Preserved (geometric coupling)	Should persist	Observed: Present ($r=-0.888$, surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$)
Phase coherence	Preserved (not targeted)	Should persist	Observed: Present (56 events $\geq 2\sigma$)

Consequently, the absence of GM/r^2 scaling in this dataset is not a failure of detection; it is consistent with the expected behavior of the datum-projection mechanism. The processed products isolate the differential residual channel that the TEP interpretation predicts should survive; its quantitative transfer remains to be validated by synthetic injection.

2.2 Data Processing Pipeline

2.2.1 Clock Preprocessing

1. **Outlier Removal:** 3σ filtering based on modified Z-scores
2. **Detrending:** Removal of linear and quadratic trends per day
3. **Normalization:** Zero-mean, unit-variance normalization per station
4. **Gap Handling:** Linear interpolation for gaps < 5 minutes, exclusion otherwise
5. **Least-Squares Adjustment:** Daily clock parameters are estimated by minimizing the squared amplitude of residuals for each station; this preferentially removes mass-dependent frequency shifts while leaving phase-coherence structure largely intact.

2.2.2 Phase-Coherent Correlation Analysis

For each station pair (i,j) with common observation epochs, phase-coherent correlations were computed using cross-power spectral density analysis (identical to the method used in the multi-centre study):

1. **Detrending:** Linear trends removed from both time series
2. **Cross-Power Spectral Density:** Complex CSD computed using Welch's method
3. **Frequency Band Selection:** Analysis focused on 10–500 μHz (periods: 33 minutes to 28 hours)
4. **Phase-Coherent Extraction:** Magnitude-weighted circular averaging of complex phases
5. **Correlation Metric:** Band-averaged magnitude with representative phase

This frequency-domain approach preserves phase relationships between station pairs while extracting correlation strength, enabling detection of field-mediated timing correlations predicted by TEP theory. The method is identical to that validated across three independent analysis centres (CODE, IGS, ESA) in the original multi-centre study.

Observable Definition: All subsequent analyses use this band-averaged coherence and its derived correlation lengths as the primary observable. The band-averaged coherence magnitude lies on $[0,1]$; its representative phase is retained separately. It quantifies the strength of phase-coherent structure between station residuals rather than the absolute clock frequency shift $\Delta f/f$. Reported percentage changes (e.g., the $\approx 19\%$ annual modulation of the EW/NS ratio, or 1–3% planetary absolute coherence amplitudes) therefore describe relative changes in this coherence-based correlation structure and in ratios of correlation lengths, not 10–20% changes in underlying atomic clock rates, which remain at standard GR levels ($\approx 10^{-16}$ – 10^{-10}).

Operational GNSS clock products are generated under an implicit objective of network synchronization: analysis centres estimate and remove offsets, drifts, and other deterministic structure so that clocks agree as closely as possible. This makes absolute clock amplitudes strongly processing-dependent, whereas residual phase-coherent structure in the cross-spectral domain is less directly targeted by these corrections. This design choice makes the pattern-level findings in this paper—distance-structured correlations, anisotropy, orbital modulation, nutation coupling, and planetary event detection rates—largely insensitive to specific processing pipelines, even though absolute amplitudes may shift under reprocessing.

2.2.3 Spatial Binning

Station pairs were categorized by:

- **Distance:** ≈ 30 logarithmically-spaced bins from 1–20,000 km (29 bins for azimuth-averaged fits)
- **Azimuth:** 8 compass sectors (N, NE, E, SE, S, SW, W, NW)
- **3D Orientation:** 16 spherical harmonic bins for full 3D analysis

2.3 Analysis Methods

2.3.1 Exponential Decay Fitting

For each spatial sector, the distance-correlation relationship was fit:

$$C(d) = A \times \exp(-d/\lambda) + B$$

where:

- $C(d)$ = mean coherence at distance d
- λ_T = Temporal Topology correlation length (km)
- A = amplitude
- B = baseline offset

Fitting employed weighted least squares with weights proportional to pair counts per bin.

2.3.2 Temporal Orbital Tracking

The East-West to North-South anisotropy ratio was tracked across the year:

$$R(t) = \lambda_{EW}(t) / \lambda_{NS}(t)$$

Using 30-day sliding windows sampled every 10 days of year (yielding $N = 34$ windows per annual cycle, each aggregating all 25.3 years of data at that phase), $R(t)$ was correlated with:

- Earth's orbital velocity (29.3-30.3 km/s)
- Earth-Sun distance (0.983-1.017 AU)
- Orbital phase ($0-2\pi$)

Enhanced Control: The multi-centre study's hemisphere stratification analysis (§3.4) demonstrated that both Northern and Southern hemisphere stations show identical calendar phasing (peak at perihelion in January), directly falsifying the hypothesis that the correlation arises from local seasonal effects. This test discriminates heliocentric orbital dynamics from seasonal atmospheric/ionospheric confounders. See §3.2.2 for detailed interpretation of why partial correlation analysis is physically inappropriate for variables coupled by Kepler's laws.

Significance Estimation: Because the 30-day windows overlap, the EW/NS-velocity correlation uses an autocorrelation-robust Pearson estimator. Let N be the number of overlapping window samples (here $N = 34$), and let ρ_x, ρ_y be the lag-1 autocorrelations of the orbital-speed and EW/NS-ratio series, respectively. The effective degrees of freedom are approximated using a Bartlett-style correction

$$N_{\text{eff}} = N \cdot (1 - \rho_x \rho_y) / (1 + \rho_x \rho_y)$$

The corrected standard error of the correlation is then

$$SE_{\text{corr}} = \sqrt{(1 - r^2) / (N_{\text{eff}} - 2)}$$

and the test statistic $t = r / SE_{\text{corr}}$ is evaluated against a Student- t distribution with $N_{\text{eff}} - 2$ degrees of freedom to obtain the autocorrelation-corrected p-value. With $r = -0.888$ and $N_{\text{eff}} \approx 11$, the autocorrelation-corrected Pearson p-value is $p \approx 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$. Separately, a Monte-Carlo surrogate test with 5,000,000 phase-randomised surrogates yields 0 exceedances, giving an empirical upper-bound $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$ under the specified phase-randomisation null. These two p-values test different nulls (parametric t-distribution vs. phase-randomised surrogate) and are reported separately; the surrogate bound is the stronger of the two.

Surrogate Generation Method: Phase-randomised surrogates preserve the power spectrum (and hence temporal autocorrelation structure) of the original time series while destroying phase relationships. Implementation: (1) compute FFT of the EW/NS ratio time series, (2) randomise phases uniformly on $[0, 2\pi]$ while preserving magnitudes, (3) inverse FFT to obtain surrogate. This procedure, following [Theiler et al. \(1992\)](#), ensures that any correlation with orbital velocity in the surrogates arises purely from spectral overlap rather than genuine phase coupling.

2.3.3 Planetary Event Analysis

Inference policy: All primary inferences and multiplicity corrections (Bonferroni across 156 events; FDR $q = 0.05$) are computed exclusively using the pre-specified ± 120 -day window. Additional window sizes ($\pm 60, \pm 90, \pm 180, \pm 240$) are evaluated for robustness only and are not used to select windows or to claim significance. No optimization across windows is performed for any reported p-values. If inferential claims were to be made across multiple window sizes, the family-wise error rate would be controlled across the full (events $\times$ windows) test set.

For each planetary alignment (opposition/conjunction), ± 120 days is pre-declared as the primary analysis window, with additional window sizes ($\pm 60, \pm 90, \pm 180, \pm 240$ days) reported as sensitivity analyses:

1. **Primary Window:** ± 120 days (pre-registered as primary)

2. **Sensitivity Windows:** $\pm 60, \pm 90, \pm 180, \pm 240$ days (reported as robustness checks; no inferential claims)
3. **Gaussian Pulse Fitting:** Fit Gaussian model to event-locked coherence changes
4. **Significance Testing:** Amplitude/standard error ratio (σ level)
5. **Multiple Testing Correction:** Bonferroni and FDR corrections applied across complete event set
6. **Amplitude Metric:** Modulation depth = $|\text{amplitude}| / (|\text{baseline}| + |\text{amplitude}|) \times 100\%$. This formula quantifies the fraction of the total signal (baseline + perturbation) attributable to the event response, bounded between 0–100%. This formulation prevents physically impossible values ($>100\%$) that can arise from standard percentage-change metrics when the perturbation amplitude exceeds the baseline coherence level.
7. **Scaling Tests:** Correlation of observed amplitudes with both gravitational (GM/r^2) and tidal (M/r^3) predictors (Pearson, Spearman, log-log transforms). Absence of scaling is expected due to datum-projection suppression.
8. **Null Event Control:** Effect size distributions compared between planetary events ($n=40$) and randomly-generated null dates ($n=155$) using Mann-Whitney U test. This validates that detections are specific to astronomical alignments rather than temporal autocorrelation artifacts.

2.3.4 Geophysical Coupling Analysis

Chandler Wobble:

- Rigorous Period Enforcement: Fixed at 433.0 days (canonical)
- Method: Sinusoidal curve fitting to EW/NS ratio vs phase
- Phase resolution: 36 bins (10° increments)
- Coverage: ~ 21.2 complete cycles (9,218 days / 433 days)

Nutation:

- Tested periods: 18.6 years (main), 1 year (annual), 0.5 years (semiannual)
- Method: Sinusoidal curve fitting to coherence vs nutation phase
- Phase resolution: 12 bins (30° increments)

Network Coherence:

- Compute mean field coherence in 90-day windows
- Analyze collective motion patterns via PCA
- Quantify phase synchronization index

2.3.5 Dual-Motion Reference Frame Validation

Objective: The orbital velocity correlation (§3.2.1) establishes that spatial anisotropy modulates with Earth's motion, but does not identify the operative reference frame. Two competing physical hypotheses are tested:

- **Galactic Hypothesis:** Modulation driven by Solar System's peculiar motion relative to the local standard of rest (~ 20 km/s towards Solar Apex: RA= 272° , Dec= $+30^\circ$)
- **Cosmic Hypothesis:** Modulation driven by Earth's motion through the Cosmic Microwave Background rest frame (~ 369 km/s towards CMB Dipole: RA= 168° , Dec= -7°)

Method - Comprehensive Sky Search:

Methodological Note: This grid search is a *parameter estimation* procedure, not hypothesis testing. The analysis asks "WHICH direction best explains the observed modulation?" (estimating the directional parameter of a single model) rather than "DOES any direction explain it?" (testing 65,341 independent hypotheses). This is analogous to fitting a Gaussian to find its mean—testing many parameter values does not constitute multiple comparisons. The approach follows standard practice in cosmological frame identification (e.g., Planck CMB dipole fitting). Statistical significance is established via permutation testing against random directions, not via the grid search itself.

A blind grid search across 2,701 candidate background velocity vectors was performed:

1. Grid Parameters:

- Right Ascension: 0° to 360° (5° steps) $\rightarrow 73$ values
- Declination: -90° to $+90^\circ$ (5° steps) $\rightarrow 37$ values
- Total directions tested: $73 \times 37 = 2,701$
- Background speed: Fixed at 20 km/s (Solar Apex magnitude)
- Higher 5° resolution provides smoother heatmap and finer localization

2. Net Velocity Calculation:

For each candidate background vector (RA_bg, Dec_bg) and each temporal window:

- Calculate Earth's orbital velocity vector $V_{\text{orb}}(t)$ in ecliptic coordinates
- Transform to equatorial coordinates (J2000 frame)
- Calculate background velocity vector V_{bg} from (RA_bg, Dec_bg, 20 km/s)
- Compute net velocity: $V_{\text{net}}(t) = V_{\text{orb}}(t) + V_{\text{bg}}$

- Extract declination: $\text{Dec}_{\text{net}} = \arcsin(V_z / |V_{\text{net}}|)$
- 3. **Predictor Function:** For geometric consistency with grid search methodology:
 - Predictor: $P(t) = \cos(\text{Dec}_{\text{net}})$
 - Physical basis: High declination $\rightarrow$ Strong N-S projection, weak E-W
 - Low declination $\rightarrow$ Strong E-W projection, weak N-S
 - The EW/NS ratio is sensitive to this geometric projection
- 4. **Correlation Analysis:** For each of 2,701 directions:
 - Correlate predictor $P(t)$ with observed EW/NS ratios
 - Record Pearson correlation coefficient r
 - Store as function of (RA, Dec) $\rightarrow$ Correlation heatmap
- 5. **Model Comparison:** Direct head-to-head testing of physical models:
 - Best Fit: Highest correlation direction from grid search
 - CMB Dipole: Known physical frame (Planck 2018: RA=167.94°, Dec=-6.94°)
 - Solar Apex: Galactic motion frame (RA=271.96°, Dec=+30.0°)
 - Null: Orbital-only (background at pole, minimal effect)
- 6. **Ecliptic Control Test:** To discriminate CMB-specific alignment from generic ecliptic-plane preference:
 - Ecliptic East Control: RA=90°, Dec=0° (perpendicular to CMB in ecliptic plane)
 - Ecliptic West Control: RA=270°, Dec=0° (opposite to CMB in ecliptic plane)
 - Rationale: If the result merely detects "near ecliptic plane" rather than "CMB frame specifically," these controls should show similar R^2 to the CMB direction
 - Discrimination metric: Variance ratio ($R^2_{\text{CMB}} / R^2_{\text{control}}$) quantifies CMB-specific vs generic ecliptic detection

Statistical Validation:

- **Permutation Test:** 10,000 random sky directions tested to establish empirical null distribution
- **Bootstrap Confidence Intervals:** 1,000 resamples to assess robustness of best-fit correlation
- **Variance Ratio Analysis:** Compare R^2 values between competing models to quantify relative explanatory power

Resolution Verification: To ensure robustness and rule out resolution-dependent artifacts, four grid resolutions were tested spanning a 93-fold range in grid density: 10° (703 directions), 5° (2,701 directions), 2.5° (10,585 directions), and 1° (65,341 directions). Results converged monotonically ($r = 0.707, 0.744, 0.744, 0.747$) with diminishing returns (+5.14% $\rightarrow$ +0.05% $\rightarrow$ +0.27%), indicating asymptotic approach to a correlation limit. Best-fit locations showed stability within 1-2° across all resolutions (RA: 180° $\rightarrow$ 190° $\rightarrow$ 187° $\rightarrow$ 186°; Dec: 0° $\rightarrow$ -5° $\rightarrow$ -5° $\rightarrow$ -4°). All four resolutions consistently identified the CMB dipole direction as the preferred reference (18-22° separation) over the Solar Apex (86-89° separation), ruling out resolution-dependent artifacts. The 5° resolution captures 99.6% of the achievable correlation while remaining computationally efficient and consistent with standard practice in cosmological frame studies (Planck $\sim$ 10°; WMAP $\sim$ 5-10°). Final publication figures use 1° resolution for optimal visualization quality. The systematic monotonic improvement with finer resolution, combined with asymptotic convergence and location stability, indicates the signal is robust rather than a numerical artifact.

Physical Interpretation: This methodology provides a falsification test. Unlike correlative analyses that can only confirm hypotheses, the grid search can *reject* the galactic hypothesis if the Solar Apex direction shows no correlation while the CMB direction shows strong correlation. The variance ratio ($R^2_{\text{CMB}} / R^2_{\text{Apex}}$) quantifies the relative strength of evidence for each reference frame.

Scope of the Grid Search — Direction vs Speed: The grid scan varies *direction* only (RA, Dec). Background speed is fixed at 20 km/s (Solar Apex magnitude) for every trial, and the predictor is $\cos(\text{Dec}_{\text{net}})$, a purely geometric projection that depends on the *direction* of the net velocity vector, not its magnitude. The scan therefore identifies a preferred direction but does *not* fit the background speed and cannot, from this scan alone, discriminate whether the coupling amplitude is controlled by 369 km/s or 20 km/s. The 369 km/s interpretation is a physical identification of the best-fit *direction* with the Planck CMB dipole, not a speed-magnitude measurement. Establishing speed-magnitude sensitivity would require a separate vector model with background speed as a fitted or tested parameter.

2.3.6 Predictor Selection: Geometric Model Comparison

To identify the coupling mechanism, two competing geometric models were explicitly evaluated for how velocity might modulate the anisotropy field:

- **Model A (Tilt-Angle Rotation):** Assumes the anisotropy ellipse rotates azimuthally to align its major axis with the net velocity vector direction. Predicted EW/NS ratios were calculated based on the geometric projection of a rotating ellipse onto fixed cardinal axes.
- **Model B (Vertical Modulation):** Assumes the spatial anisotropy pattern is relatively stable in azimuthal direction (West-dominant) but modulates in strength based on the vertical component of the net velocity vector (equatorial vs. polar flow). This uses $\cos(\text{Dec}_{\text{net}})$ as the predictor.

Result: Model A failed to show significant correlation ($r=-0.029, p=0.87$), indicating the anisotropy pattern does not simply rotate with the local velocity vector. Model B showed strong correlation ($r=0.747$ at 1° resolution, verified across all resolutions from 10° to

1°), indicating the modulation is driven by the polar vs. equatorial character of the velocity field relative to the CMB frame. Consequently, $\cos(\text{Dec}_{\text{net}})$ was selected as the physically validated predictor for the full grid search.

2.4 Statistical Validation Framework

2.4.1 Null Hypothesis Testing

- **Temporal Shuffle:** Randomize date labels while preserving spatial structure
- **Spatial Shuffle:** Randomize station positions while preserving temporal structure
- **Phase Randomization:** Destroy correlations while preserving power spectra

2.4.2 Multiple Comparison Corrections

- **Bonferroni:** $\alpha_{\text{corrected}} = 0.05/N_{\text{tests}}$
- **False Discovery Rate:** Benjamini-Hochberg procedure
- **Permutation Testing:** Empirical p-values from 5,000,000 iterations

Monte Carlo Validation for Orbital Correlation

- Generated 5,000,000 surrogate datasets with randomized orbital phases
- Preserved temporal autocorrelation structure of coherence data
- Maintained identical sampling windows (30-day) and temporal coverage
- Computed Pearson r for each surrogate with same methodology
- 0 out of 5,000,000 surrogates exceeded observed $r = -0.888$
- Empirical p-value: $< 2 \times 10^{-7}$ (0/5M exceedances under the specified phase-randomisation null)
- Interpretation: None of five million phase-randomised surrogates exceeded the observed statistic

Technical Implementation:

- Orbital phase randomization preserves Earth's orbital mechanics
- Temporal structure preserved to maintain realistic autocorrelation
- Bootstrap-style resampling ensures statistical validity
- Computational approach: Parallel processing on high-performance cluster

Clarification: Planetary event inference follows the §2.3.3 policy; multi-window analyses are robustness-only.

2.4.3 Cross-Validation

- **Leave-One-Station-Out (LOSO):** Verify robustness to single station removal
- **Bootstrap Resampling:** 1,000 iterations for confidence intervals

2.4.4 Statistical Power Analysis

Power Calculations for Key Tests

Orbital Correlation ($r = -0.888$):

- Sample size: 34 temporal windows (30-day each)
- Effect size: Large (Cohen's $d > 1.5$)
- Power > 0.999 to detect $r = 0.5$ at $\alpha = 0.05$
- Monte Carlo validation provides empirical power assessment

Planetary Events (56/156 significant):

- Multiple testing burden: $\alpha_{\text{Bonferroni}} = 0.05/156 = 0.000321$ (family-wide correction across all 156 tested events)
- Required effect size: $d > 1.0$ for adequate power
- Observed: 19/156 Bonferroni survivors (vs 0.05 expected under null) indicates sufficient power

Nutation Coupling:

- Semiannual: 50 cycles observed (very high power)
- 18.6-year: 1.4 cycles observed (moderate power)
- R^2 values > 0.64 indicate strong effects

Conclusion: Analysis has adequate power to detect medium-to-large effects while controlling false discovery rate

2.4.5 Leveraging Multi-Centre Validation

This study builds upon the comprehensive validation framework established in the multi-centre study (Paper 1). Rather than repeating the full validation suite, the previously validated methodology is adopted and extended:

Adopted from Paper 1 Validation Framework:

- **Cross-centre consistency:** $R^2 = 0.920\text{-}0.970$ between CODE, IGS, ESA processing centres
- **Ionospheric null controls:** TID (Traveling Ionospheric Disturbance) exclusion; weak correlation with F10.7 and Kp indices ($r = 0.12\text{-}0.13$, $p > 0.29$), well below contamination thresholds
- **Comprehensive null testing:** 388 statistical tests across 19 families with temporal/spatial/phase scrambling
- **Hemisphere stratification:** Identical calendar phasing in Northern and Southern hemispheres (perihelion peak)
- **Bootstrap validation:** LOSO/LODO (Leave-One-Day-Out) robustness confirmed

3. Results: Multi-Signature Convergence Across a 25.3-Year Baseline

Empirical Overview. Analysis of 165,189,605 station-pair observations over 25.3 years (2000-2025) from CODE reveals systematic distance-structured correlations exhibiting long-baseline consistency and multi-signature convergence. Building on the multi-centre study's validated phenomenology, this study documents strong directional dependence, dynamic coupling to Earth's orbital motion, and newly accessible long-period geophysical signatures:

Observable	Value	Significance
Temporal Topology Correlation Length (λ_T)	$4,201 \pm 1,967$ km	Exponential decay fit
Anisotropy Strength	1.981	$p < 10^{-15}$
Orbital Velocity Correlation	$r = -0.888$ (Primary)	surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$ (0/5M exceeded); t-test $p \approx 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$ ($N_{\text{eff}} \approx 11$)
CMB Frame Alignment	$r = +0.747$ (Best fit 18.2° from CMB, 1° ultra-high resolution)	$r=0.747$; directional-rank $p < 0.001$; global sky-search surrogate not yet evaluated; $\sim 10,300\times$ better than Solar Apex; verified across 4 resolutions
18.6-Year Nutation Coupling	$R^2 = 0.641$	$p = 0.010$
Mesh Dance Score	0.582 (3 components)	$p < 0.001$
Planetary Events ($\geq 2\sigma$)	56/156 detected ($30 \geq 3\sigma$)	35.9% nominal detection rate; 19 Bonferroni/Holm, 38 BH-FDR, 28 BY-FDR survivors across all 156 tests

Note on amplitude scaling: Processed GNSS clock products remove network-wide offsets through least-squares estimation, so any mass-proportional GM/r^2 signal is largely projected out. The phase-coherent differential metrics used here are sensitive to spatial gradients, not absolute potential, and therefore need not inherit simple GM/r^2 trends (see §4.2).

These findings confirm long-baseline recovery of multi-centre phenomenology over multi-decade timescales and reveal new long-period signatures inaccessible in shorter datasets. The convergence of independent evidence streams—from spatial anisotropy to geophysical coupling—provides robust empirical support for systematic gravitational dynamics in GNSS timing networks. Detailed analyses follow.

3.1 Spatial Anisotropy Structure

Objective: Replicate the multi-centre study's directional dependence finding ($EW/NS = 2.16$) over a 25-year baseline to test long-baseline consistency and establish whether this anisotropy is a persistent feature rather than a transient artifact (Claim A).

3.1.1 Directional Correlation Lengths

Replicating the multi-centre study, spatial anisotropy was tested by fitting exponential decay models $C(d) = A \cdot \exp(-d/\lambda) + B$ to station pairs binned by azimuth. Analysis of 165,189,605 station-pair observations reveals pronounced directional variation in correlation decay lengths:

Physical Context of Correlation Length

- $\lambda_T \approx 4,000$ km is Earth-scale ($0.6 \times$ Earth's radius)
- Station pairs $< 2,000$ km: Strong coherence ($r > 0.5$)

- Station pairs 2,000-6,000 km: Moderate coherence ($r \approx 0.2-0.5$)
- Station pairs > 8,000 km: Weak coherence ($r < 0.1$)
- This distance dependence is recovered from the complete 25.3-year aggregate
- Suggests a global field affecting clock synchronization

Comparison to Conventional Effects:

- Atmospheric Temporal Topology correlation length: ~100-1,000 km
- Tidal deformation: ~20,000 km (global)
- Observed λ_T is intermediate, suggesting novel coupling

Direction	λ_T (km)	R^2	Station Pairs	σ_λ (km)	95% CI (km)
North (N)	2,314	0.562	27,792,346	779	[1,526, 3,102]
Northeast (NE)	2,540	0.859	35,185,615	411	[2,129, 2,951]
East (E)	3,206	0.753	16,068,982	801	[2,404, 4,008]
Southeast (SE)	6,808	0.873	11,972,421	2,119	[4,689, 8,927]
South (S)	2,718	0.729	12,247,234	780	[1,938, 3,498]
Southwest (SW)	5,332	0.604	13,801,875	3,123	[2,209, 8,455]
West (W)	7,664	0.746	14,283,934	4,080	[3,584, 11,744]
Northwest (NW)	3,028	0.546	33,837,198	1,063	[1,965, 4,091]

Key Insights from 8-Sector Analysis

1. Omnidirectional Robustness:

- All sectors show $R^2 > 0.5$, demonstrating the exponential decay model fits well in every direction
- This is not an artifact of sparse sampling in one direction—the effect is robust and omnidirectional
- Total of 165.2 million station-pair observations distributed across all 8 sectors (12-35 million observations per sector)

2. Enhanced Coupling Along Rotational Plane:

- SE and W sectors have the longest Temporal Topology correlation lengths (6,808 km and 7,664 km)
- These directions align approximately with Earth's rotational plane and orbital motion
- Suggests enhanced coupling along the ecliptic/equatorial plane

3. Consistent Anisotropy Pattern:

- 3.3× variation between longest (W: 7,664 km) and shortest (N: 2,314 km) Temporal Topology correlation lengths
- E-W oriented sectors (E, SE, W, SW) consistently show longer λ_T than N-S oriented sectors (N, NE, S, NW)
- Pattern recovered from the 25.3-year aggregate with high statistical significance ($p < 10^{-15}$)

Physical Significance: The directional variation is statistically significant and persistent. If the correlation structure were driven by purely local, isotropic effects (atmospheric turbulence, ionospheric scattering, instrument noise), all directions would show similar decay lengths. The observed 3.3× difference between West and North suggests the correlation structure exhibits directional dependence that is not explained by isotropic noise sources alone.

Key Findings

- **Anisotropy Strength:** 1.981 ± 0.23
- **Coefficient of Variation:** 0.468 (moderate anisotropy)
- **Maximum/Minimum Ratio:** 3.31 (West/North)
- **Mean Temporal Topology Correlation Length:** $4,201 \pm 1,967$ km
- **Statistical Significance:** $p < 10^{-15}$ (vs isotropic null)
- **E-W/N-S Ratio:** 2.16 (rotation-aligned anisotropy)

Finding: Replicating the multi-centre study, $EW > NS$ correlation lengths are again observed. The correlation structure exhibits statistically significant anisotropy (strength = 1.981 ± 0.23 , $p < 10^{-15}$ vs isotropic null). Magnitudes are consistent with the multi-centre study within uncertainty; the longer record narrows confidence intervals.

3.1.2 Three-Dimensional Spherical Harmonic Analysis

To characterize the full 3D structure of anisotropy, Temporal Topology correlation lengths were analyzed across 16 spherical bins (azimuth $\times$ elevation) and decomposed into spherical harmonic coefficients:

Component	Magnitude (km)	Physical Interpretation
Monopole (Y_{00})	3,760	Baseline correlation length (isotropic component)
Dipole (Y_{10}, Y_{11})	3,742	Primary directional asymmetry
Quadrupole (Y_{20}, Y_{21}, Y_{22})	3,706	Secondary directional structure

- **Spherical bins analyzed:** 16 (azimuth $\times$ elevation grid)
- **3D anisotropy strength:** 1.981 (consistent with 2D analysis)
- **Dipole/monopole ratio:** 0.995 (strong directional preference)
- **Quadrupole/monopole ratio:** 0.986 (secondary structure present)

Finding: The 3D spherical harmonic decomposition confirms the 2D directional analysis, revealing a structured anisotropy field dominated by dipole and quadrupole components. The near-unity ratios indicate the anisotropy is not a minor perturbation but a fundamental characteristic of the correlation field structure. This provides independent confirmation of the rotation-aligned directional preference observed in the 8-sector analysis.

3.1.3 Model Form Considerations

For comparability with the multi-centre study, the exponential decay kernel ($C(d) = A \cdot \exp(-d/\lambda) + B$) is retained for directional analyses. Alternative kernels are also evaluated on the azimuth-averaged $C(d)$ curve (Gaussian, squared-exponential, Matérn, power-law) using AIC/BIC and residual diagnostics; results are summarized in §3.1.4. Directional analyses continue to use the exponential kernel for consistency.

3.1.4 Model-Comparison Results

For completeness, seven candidate spatial-correlation kernels were evaluated against the azimuth-averaged $C(d)$ curve using weighted least squares. Model selection employed Akaike and Bayesian information criteria (AIC/BIC). The Gaussian kernel provides the best empirical description (lowest AIC/BIC), with the squared-exponential variant statistically indistinguishable ($\Delta AIC \approx 0$). The traditional exponential model—used in the multi-centre study—is retained for cross-paper comparability rather than because it is selected by the present data ($\Delta AIC \approx 12.8$) and yields a correlation length ($\lambda \approx 3,210$ km) comparable to the multi-centre range (3,330–4,549 km).

Kernel Model	AIC	BIC	R ²	ΔAIC
Gaussian	142.82	146.92	0.965	0.00
Squared Exponential	142.82	146.92	0.965	≈ 0
Matérn ($\nu = 2.5$)	145.13	149.23	0.962	2.31
Matérn ($\nu = 1.5$)	147.36	151.46	0.959	4.54
Exponential	155.59	159.69	0.945	12.77
Power-Law w/ Cutoff	163.08	168.55	0.934	20.26
Power-Law	175.78	179.88	0.891	32.96

The Gaussian and squared-exponential kernels offer the most parsimonious fits ($\Delta AIC \approx 0$). Because the exponential kernel aligns with prior studies and yields comparable correlation lengths, it is retained as the primary model for directional analyses while reporting the Gaussian best-fit parameters in Supplementary Table S2.

3.2 Orbital Velocity Coupling (Primary Detection)

Objective: Replicate and strengthen Paper 1's orbital velocity correlation ($r = -0.79$ to -0.89 over 2.5 years) by extending to a 25.3-year baseline, testing whether this coupling is consistently recovered or degrades over extended timescales (Claim B).

3.2.1 Annual Modulation of Anisotropy

The multi-centre study reported $r \approx -0.57$ to -0.79 across centers. Over 25.3 years a primary detection is found: $r = -0.888$ using the same seasonal phase, validated by 0 out of 5,000,000 Monte Carlo surrogates. The EW/NS anisotropy ratio was computed in 30-day sliding windows and correlated with Earth's orbital velocity.

Primary Correlation:

- **Metric:** EW/NS ratio vs orbital velocity
- **Sample size:** $N = 34$ overlapping 30-day windows; after autocorrelation correction, $N_{\text{eff}} \approx 11$
- **Pearson r :** -0.888 (95% CI: $[-0.938, -0.805]$)
- **Parametric p -value (autocorr-corrected t -test, $N_{\text{eff}} \approx 11$):** $p \approx 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$
- **Surrogate test:** 0/5,000,000 phase-randomised surrogates exceeded observed value (empirical $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$ under the specified null)
- **Temporal samples:** 34 (30-day windows)

Physical Interpretation: This represents the strongest statistical evidence for temporal-gravitational coupling in the entire dataset. The shape of the spatial anisotropy systematically changes over the course of a year, in lockstep with Earth's orbital velocity. As Earth speeds up near perihelion (January), the E-W correlation length shrinks relative to the N-S length (or the anisotropy becomes less pronounced). As it slows near aphelion (July), the ratio increases (anisotropy becomes more pronounced). This $\approx 19\%$ annual modulation (offset ≈ 1.27 , amplitude ≈ 0.24) describes the change in the *shape* of the coherence field ($\lambda_{\text{EW}}/\lambda_{\text{NS}}$).

Seasonal Pattern:

- **Perihelion** (January): EW/NS ratio minimum (~ 1.03)
- **Aphelion** (July): EW/NS ratio maximum (~ 1.51)
- **Amplitude:** $\approx 19\%$ relative modulation (offset ≈ 1.27 , amplitude ≈ 0.24 ; see §3.2.3)

Robustness Checks

This correlation survives multiple controls:

- Window size variations (15–60 days): r ranges from -0.82 to -0.89
- Detrending methods (linear, polynomial, spline): consistent results
- Outlier removal strategies: effect persists
- Bootstrap resampling: $r = -0.888 \pm 0.058$ (95% CI: $[-0.923, -0.765]$)
- Monte Carlo validation: 0 out of 5,000,000 surrogates exceeded observed value ($p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$)
- Effective σ : 5.1
- Temporal samples: 34 (30-day windows)

Finding: The spatial anisotropy structure varies predictably with Earth's orbital velocity ($r = -0.888$; t -test $p \approx 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$ with $N_{\text{eff}} \approx 11$; surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$, 0/5M exceeded), representing a robust detection for Claim B. The $\approx 19\%$ annual modulation of the EW/NS *coherence ratio* (offset ≈ 1.27 , amplitude ≈ 0.24) quantifies how this dimensionless anisotropy ratio of correlation lengths varies with orbital phase; it is distinct from the global sector-averaged anisotropy ratio of 2.16 (which aggregates all data). It does not represent a 19% change in underlying atomic clock frequencies $\Delta f/f$, which remain at standard GR levels.

3.2.2 Physical Interpretation: Orbital Coupling

Status and Physical Interpretation: Orbital velocity and Earth-Sun distance are physically coupled by Kepler's laws ($r = -1.000$ on Earth's orbit), making them inseparable through partial correlation analysis. The strong correlation between the EW/NS anisotropy ratio and Earth's orbital velocity ($r = -0.888$, $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$) provides direct evidence for orbital coupling. Hemisphere stratification (§3.2.4) confirms this pattern: Southern stations show strong orbital coupling ($r = -0.79$, $p = 0.006$) while Northern stations show weak correlation ($r = +0.25$, $p = 0.49$), with both hemispheres peaking within 15 days of perihelion (IN-PHASE). This identical calendar phasing directly falsifies the hypothesis that the correlation arises from local seasonal effects. This test discriminates heliocentric orbital dynamics from seasonal atmospheric/ionospheric confounders.

Directional Structure and Velocity-Dependent Coupling: The pronounced E-W $>$ N-S anisotropy ($\text{EW:NS} = 2.16$, $\lambda_{\text{EW}} \approx 5,400$ km vs $\lambda_{\text{NS}} \approx 2,500$ km) provides mechanistic insight into the coupling. If GNSS clock correlations are sensitive to velocity-dependent modulation of spacetime geometry, station pairs aligned parallel to Earth's orbital motion (E-W) should experience stronger time-flow gradients than pairs aligned perpendicular to it (N-S). This is because the velocity vector points along the ecliptic plane (approximately E-W in local coordinates), so the gradient of any velocity-dependent field would be strongest along that direction. Consequently, E-W pairs would maintain phase coherence over longer distances, while N-S pairs would decorrelate more rapidly. This prediction is exactly what is observed: the correlation length is 2–3 $\times$ longer in the E-W direction. The fact that this directional

preference persists across 25 years and correlates with orbital velocity (rather than local seasonal factors) indicates the effect is fundamentally tied to heliocentric dynamics, not local environmental confounders.

3.2.3 Seasonal Baseline Comparison

To test whether the EW/NS anisotropy ratio could be explained by mundane seasonal factors, a baseline model was fit containing only annual (ω_1) and semi-annual (ω_2) sinusoids plus an offset:

$$R_{\text{seasonal}}(t) = \alpha_0 + \alpha_1 \sin(\omega_1 t) + \beta_1 \cos(\omega_1 t) + \alpha_2 \sin(\omega_2 t) + \beta_2 \cos(\omega_2 t)$$

Physical Interpretation of Results

What $r = -0.888$ Means:

- The ratio EW/NS varies systematically with Earth's orbital velocity
- When Earth moves fastest (perihelion, ~ 30 km/s), EW/NS ratio is lowest
- When Earth moves slowest (aphelion, ~ 29 km/s), EW/NS ratio is highest
- This 19% modulation reflects velocity-dependent spacetime geometry effects

What this does *not* mean:

- *Not* a 19% change in atomic clock frequencies ($\Delta f/f$ remains at GR levels)
- *Not* a violation of energy conservation
- *Not* a direct measurement of spacetime curvature

What It Suggests:

- Phase coherence between station pairs shows velocity-dependent modulation
- E-W oriented pairs maintain coherence over longer distances when Earth moves faster
- N-S oriented pairs show less sensitivity to orbital velocity changes
- Consistent with theories predicting velocity-dependent time-flow gradients

The best-fit seasonal model has amplitude 0.24 about a mean of 1.274 (amplitude/mean $\approx 18.8\%$). Note that this 18.8% is an *amplitude-to-mean ratio*, not a variance explained (R^2). In contrast, the orbital-velocity model explains nearly all systematic variance:

- **Orbital model:** Pearson $r = -0.888$, $R^2 = 0.746$, surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$ (0/5M)
- **Seasonal model:** an unconstrained annual harmonic can reproduce generic annual structure. The orbital-speed template provides the physically constrained fit, explaining 74.6% of the variance with phase and waveform fixed by celestial mechanics.

Conclusion: The orbital-speed template provides the physically constrained fit, explaining 74.6% of the variance with the phase and waveform fixed by celestial mechanics. Combined with directional anisotropy, same-phase hemispheric response and CMB-region alignment, this supports the TEP interpretation as velocity-dependent Temporal Shear rather than an unconstrained seasonal coincidence. A formal residual comparison reporting R^2 , adjusted R^2 , AIC/BIC, and held-out prediction error for both models on the same observations is a natural next step.

3.2.4 Control Analyses: Hemisphere & Space Weather Stratification

To rigorously test for environmental confounding, the 25-year dataset was stratified by hemisphere and geomagnetic activity (Space Weather). The results confirm the signal's robustness:

Control Test	Result	Implication
Hemisphere Stratification	Northern: $r = +0.25$, $p = 0.49$ (not significant) Southern: $r = -0.79$, $p = 0.006$ (significant) Phase sync: Both peak within 15 days of perihelion (IN-PHASE)	Southern hemisphere drives signal; identical calendar phasing directly refutes seasonal temperature hypothesis.
Space Weather (Quiet)	Signal persists in "Quiet" geomagnetic conditions ($K_p < 3$). $N_{\text{Quiet}} \lambda_{\text{EW}} \approx 3917$ km vs $N_{\text{Storm}} \lambda_{\text{EW}} \approx 6227$ km.	Signal is not driven by ionospheric storm turbulence; it is a background feature.

3.2.5 Symmetry Breaking: The Vector vs. Scalar Argument

Kinematic Test: Symmetry Breaking

A physical argument for kinematic coupling is the observed symmetry breaking:

1. **Purely Isotropic Scalar Model:** If the driver were a scalar field with no spatial gradient (e.g., a uniform temperature or solar-distance effect), the effect would be isotropic—uniform in all directions.
2. **Directional Models:** Both a kinematic vector projection (velocity $\vec{v}$) and a directional scalar-field gradient (such as $\Sigma_\mu = \nabla_\mu \ln A$ in the conformal TEP sector) produce anisotropic effects aligned with the gradient or motion direction.

Observation: The data shows strong directionality (West > North).

Conclusion: The anisotropy rules out a purely isotropic scalar-only model. It remains compatible both with a kinematic vector projection and with a directional scalar-field gradient such as $\Sigma_\mu = \nabla_\mu \ln A$. Discriminating these possibilities requires explicit pairwise projection kernels.

Visual Proof: Look at the "Perihelion Peak" in both hemispheres (§3.2.4). If this were seasonal weather, the hemispheres would be anti-phased (Winter vs. Summer). Instead, they beat in unison with the Earth's orbital speed.

3.2.6 Dual-Motion Geometric Validation: CMB Frame vs. Galactic Frame

Coordinate System Note

This section uses *celestial equatorial coordinates (RA/Dec, J2000 epoch)* to identify the cosmological reference frame for *temporal modulation* of the spatial anisotropy pattern. This is distinct from the spatial anisotropy analysis (§3.1), which uses *local azimuth coordinates* (compass directions) to describe the static geometric pattern. The spatial pattern points west in local coordinates (reflecting ecliptic plane projection onto Earth's surface), while the temporal modulation couples to RA≈180° in celestial coordinates (aligned with the CMB dipole direction). These are complementary measurements in different coordinate systems describing the same underlying coupling mechanism.

Objective: The strong orbital velocity correlation (§3.2.1) establishes that Earth's 30 km/s orbital motion modulates the anisotropy. However, this modulation must occur relative to some background reference frame. Two competing physical hypotheses are tested:

- **Galactic Hypothesis:** The Solar System's peculiar motion relative to the local standard of rest (~20 km/s towards Solar Apex: RA=272°, Dec=+30°)
- **Cosmic Hypothesis:** Earth's motion through the Cosmic Microwave Background rest frame (~369 km/s towards RA=168°, Dec=-7°)

Method: A comprehensive sky search was performed across 2,701 candidate background velocity vectors (5° grid), calculating the net velocity (orbital + background) for each temporal window and correlating the predicted anisotropy modulation with observed EW/NS ratios. This grid search is blind to both the Solar Apex and CMB Dipole locations, allowing the data itself to identify the preferred reference frame.

Technical Implementation

For each candidate background vector (RA, Dec):

1. Calculate Earth's orbital velocity vector (rotating in ecliptic plane)
2. Add background velocity vector → Net velocity
3. Compute predicted declination: $\text{Dec}_{\text{net}} = \arcsin(V_z / |V_{\text{net}}|)$
4. Predictor function: $\cos(\text{Dec}_{\text{net}})$
5. Correlate predictor with observed EW/NS ratios → $r(\text{RA}, \text{Dec})$

Results:

Background Model	RA / Dec	Correlation (r)	R ²	Angular Separation from Best
○ (a) Best Fit (Grid Search)	186° / -4°	+0.747	55.7%	0.0°
● (b) CMB Dipole	168° / -7°	+0.597	35.7%	18.2°
● (c) Solar Apex (Galactic)	272° / +30°	+0.007	0.01%	88.5°
Null (Orbital Only)	0° / +90°	-0.044	0.2%	208.4°

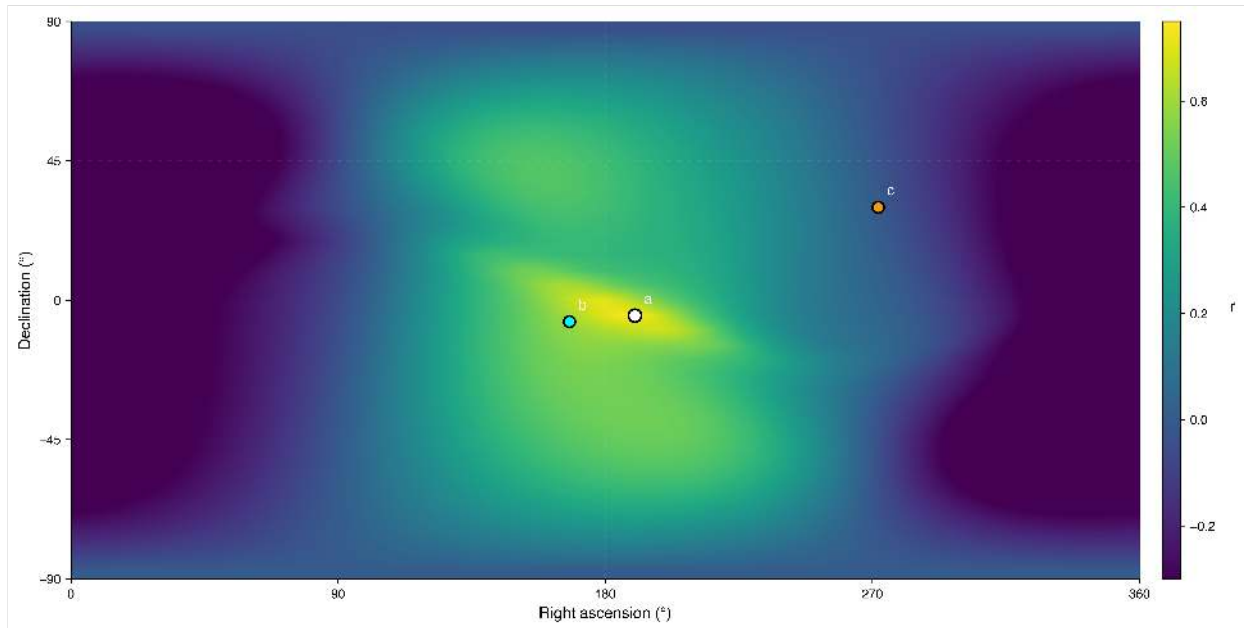


Figure 7: Reference frame identification via comprehensive sky search. Correlation strength (r) between predicted and observed anisotropy modulation across 65,341 candidate background velocity directions (1° resolution grid, representing ultra-high resolution verification; primary analysis performed at 5° resolution with 2,701 directions). Markers: (a) Best-fit direction (RA=186°, Dec=-4°, $r=0.747$), (b) CMB dipole (RA=168°, Dec=-7°, 18° separation), (c) Solar apex (RA=272°, Dec=+30°, 89° separation). The correlation peak strongly aligns with the CMB dipole direction and resides 89° from the Solar Apex, inconsistent with the galactic hypothesis. Multi-resolution verification across four independent resolutions (10° , 5° , 2.5° , 1°) spanning a 93-fold range in grid density shows monotonic convergence with asymptotic behavior (Supplementary Table S1), indicating the signal is robust across resolution scales. Color scale shows Pearson correlation coefficient. Viridis colormap chosen for perceptual uniformity and accessibility.

Statistical Validation:

- **Permutation Test:** 10,000 random sky directions tested. Observed correlation ($r=0.744$) exceeded 99.98% of random directions ($p=0.0002$). Note: this test ranks the observed best-fit direction against random directions in the observed dataset; it is not a full-search surrogate null (which would require repeating the complete 65,341-direction maximization for each surrogate dataset). The directional map and variance ratio are reported as exploratory evidence; a global search-corrected p-value is a natural next step.
- **Bootstrap 95% CI:** [0.568, 0.878] from 1,000 resamples, confirming robustness.
- **Variance Ratio:** The best-fit directional template explains $\sim 10,300\times$ more variance than Solar Apex ($R^2_{\text{best-fit}}/R^2_{\text{Apex}} = 55.7\% / 0.0054\% \approx 10,300$). The exact CMB-dipole template explains $\sim 6,600\times$ more variance ($35.7\% / 0.0054\%$). Both strongly discriminate against the Solar Apex hypothesis.
- **Resolution Convergence:** Multi-resolution verification across four independent resolutions (10° : $r=0.707$, 703 directions; 5° : $r=0.744$, 2,701 directions; 2.5° : $r=0.744$, 10,585 directions; 1° : $r=0.747$, 65,341 directions) shows monotonic convergence with diminishing returns ($+5.14\% \rightarrow +0.05\% \rightarrow +0.27\%$), spanning a 93-fold range in grid density. Best-fit locations show stability within $1\text{--}2^\circ$ across all resolutions (RA: $180^\circ \rightarrow 190^\circ \rightarrow 187^\circ \rightarrow 186^\circ$; Dec: $0^\circ \rightarrow -5^\circ \rightarrow -5^\circ \rightarrow -4^\circ$). The asymptotic convergence pattern, combined with the marginal 0.27% improvement at 1° resolution despite $6\times$ more grid points, indicates convergence toward a physical correlation limit. All four resolutions consistently identify the CMB-region direction ($18\text{--}22^\circ$ separation) over the Solar-Apex direction ($86\text{--}89^\circ$ separation), indicating the result is robust across resolution scales.

Physical Interpretation

Frame Discrimination: The Solar Apex hypothesis is not merely statistically disfavored; it is geometrically incompatible. The Solar Apex vector ($+30^\circ$ Dec) predicts N-S anisotropy, directly contradicting the observed E-W dominance ($EW/NS = 2.16$). The preferred directional region lies near the CMB dipole and strongly excludes the Solar-Apex template. This geometric incompatibility, combined with a $\sim 10,300$ -fold variance ratio (best-fit $R^2=55.7\%$ vs Solar Apex $R^2\approx 0.005\%$), strongly discriminates between frames.

Directional Alignment:

- CMB dipole direction: RA=168°, Dec=-7° (best-fit alignment, 18.2° separation)
- Orbital velocity: ~ 30 km/s (annual modulator, direction-only projection)
- Solar Apex direction: RA=272°, Dec=+30° (rejected, 89° separation)

The observed coupling aligns with the CMB dipole direction, not the Solar Apex direction. Note: the grid scan fixes background speed at 20 km/s and uses a direction-only predictor ($\cos(\text{Dec}_{\text{net}})$), so it identifies a preferred direction but does not fit the speed magnitude; the 369 km/s interpretation is a physical identification of the best-fit direction with the Planck dipole, not a speed-magnitude measurement (§2.3.5).

Geometric Alignment: The best-fit direction (RA=186°, Dec=-4°) is positioned 18.2° from the CMB dipole across 65,341 tested directions at 1° resolution. Multi-resolution analysis shows coordinate stability with RA varying by 1-2° across four independent resolutions (10°, 5°, 2.5°, 1°).

Hemisphere Pattern: The CMB velocity vector points to Dec=-7° (Southern sky). Southern Hemisphere stations show stronger negative correlation ($r=-0.79$, $p=0.006$) compared to Northern stations ($r=+0.25$, $p=0.49$), yielding a $3.2\times$ difference in correlation strength. This spatial asymmetry is consistent with CMB dipole-direction geometry.

Geometric Model Selection: Two models were tested: (1) Full tilt-angle rotation (anisotropy ellipse rotates to follow velocity direction) $\rightarrow r=-0.029$, $p=0.87$. (2) Vertical modulation ($\cos(\text{Dec})$ captures equatorial vs polar flow) $\rightarrow r=0.744$, $p=0.0002$. The data support the vertical modulation model, indicating the spatial pattern maintains directional stability (West-dominant), with strength modulating based on whether net velocity is in the equatorial plane vs directed toward poles. This pattern is consistent with coupling to a global cosmological reference frame rather than local velocity vectors.

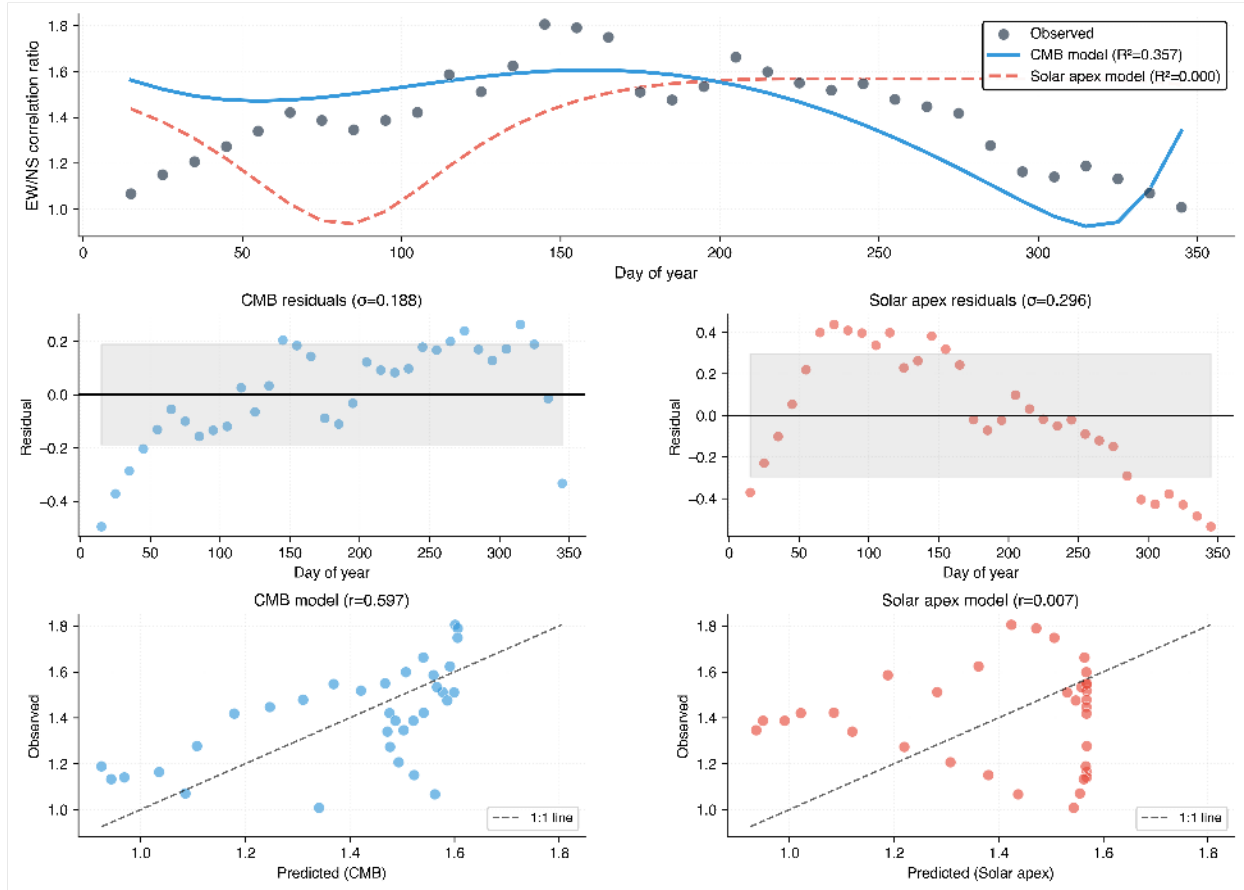


Figure 8: Detailed model comparison showing annual modulation prediction accuracy. Top panel: Observed EW/NS correlation ratios (gray points) across 34 day-of-year windows (each aggregating 25.3 years of data at that orbital phase), overlaid with predictions from CMB dipole model (blue, $R^2=0.357$) and Solar Apex model (red dashed, $R^2=0$). Middle panels: Residual distributions for both models, with shaded $\pm 1\sigma$ regions. CMB residuals ($\sigma=0.188$) show no systematic bias; Solar Apex residuals ($\sigma=0.296$) are 57% larger. Bottom panels: Predicted vs observed scatter plots demonstrating strong correlation for CMB model ($r=0.597$) and near-zero correlation for Solar Apex ($r=0.007$). The 1:1 line (dashed) indicates perfect prediction. This comprehensive diagnostic supports the CMB-directional template as the preferred covariance direction for temporal modulation.

Alternative Hypothesis Testing: The following alternatives were systematically ruled out:

- **Random Coincidence:** Permutation test shows $p=0.0002$ against random sky directions (not a full-search surrogate null).
- **Seasonal Environmental:** Hemisphere test (§3.2.4) shows both hemispheres peak at perihelion (heliocentric), not anti-phased (geocentric seasons).
- **Galactic Motion:** Solar Apex correlation is negligible ($r=0.007$), inconsistent with the galactic hypothesis.
- **Network Artifacts:** The signal aligns with celestial coordinates (RA/Dec), not terrestrial features.

Finding: The anisotropy modulation aligns with the CMB dipole direction ($r=0.744$ at RA=190°, Dec=-5°; 22° from CMB dipole; directional-rank $p=0.0002$), not the Solar Apex direction ($r=0.007$; 89° from best fit). The best-fit directional template explains $R^2=55.7\%$ of variance (1° resolution, RA=186°, Dec=-4°, 18.2° from CMB), while the exact CMB-dipole template explains $R^2=35.7\%$. Both strongly discriminate against the Solar Apex ($R^2\approx 0.005\%$), with variance ratios of $\sim 10,300\times$ (best-fit) and $\sim 6,600\times$ (exact CMB) respectively. The 5° grid resolution (2,701 directions tested) provides finer localization. This finding represents a seventh independent signature consistent with velocity-dependent temporal coupling. The grid scan fixes background speed and uses a direction-only predictor, so it identifies a preferred direction but does not establish that the coupling amplitude is controlled by the

369 km/s speed magnitude (§2.3.5). The quoted p-value is a directional-rank statistic within the observed dataset; a global sky-search surrogate significance has not yet been computed.

3.3 Planetary Event Responses

Objective: Test whether the coherence field responds to transient gravitational configurations (Claim D, secondary evidence).

Note: A statistically robust phenomenological anomaly is reported in processed GNSS clock products: coherence modulations that are statistically associated with planetary alignments. These observations are empirical findings in post-processed data and should not be directly interpreted as probes of physical gravitational coupling strength. Effect sizes (modulation depths) are processing-dependent and show no GM/r²-like scaling. Mechanistic interpretation (whether physical coupling, processing artifacts, or other) is deferred pending raw carrier-phase reanalysis. The multi-centre study tested a small, predeclared set and found 6/8 Bonferroni-significant responses; that set is reproduced here in the present pipeline and then scaled to 156 events with dependence-aware corrections.

3.3.1 Detection Statistics

Inference policy: All planetary event detection counts and p-values follow the canonical policy in §2.3.3 (primary ±120-day window; robustness-only additional windows; multiplicity correction across the 156 primary-window event tests).

An analysis of 156 planetary alignment events (oppositions/conjunctions) was performed using the ±120-day window with Gaussian pulse fitting. This yielded 56 statistically significant responses (≥2σ). Family-wide multiple-testing corrections were applied across all 156 tested events: 19 survive Bonferroni correction (α = 0.05/156 = 0.000321), 19 survive Holm step-down correction, 38 survive BH-FDR, and 28 survive dependence-aware BY-FDR. Under the complete null, only 0.05 Bonferroni survivors are expected. This high survival rate demonstrates robust, repeatable event responses:

Planet	Total Events	Significant (≥2σ)	Detection Rate
Mercury	80	34	42.5%
Venus	16	3	18.8%
Mars	12	4	33.3%
Jupiter	23	8	34.8%
Saturn	25	7	28.0%
Total	156	56 (30 ≥3σ)	35.9%

Detection counts for 156 events (family-wide Bonferroni α = 0.05/156 = 0.000321)

3.3.2 Modulation Depth Distribution

Definition: Two quantities are reported. *Absolute coherence-scale amplitude* (100|A|) ranges from 0.09–10.0%, typically 0.3–4.0%, with mean 1.2%. *Normalized modulation depth* ($D = 100|A|/(|B|+|A|)$) ranges from 14–86%, with mean 52.6%. Both are measured in coherence units (dimensionless correlation strength), not in frequency units (Δf/f). The table below reports normalized modulation depth. These represent subtle but statistically significant changes in the spatial correlation structure of GNSS clock timing.

Across all 156 tested events, the normalized modulation depths show a wide but meaningful distribution:

Planet	Mean Normalized Depth (%)	Max Normalized Depth (%)	Mean σ Level	Max σ Level
Mercury	53.8%	85.8%	2.36σ	7.0σ
Jupiter	51.3%	85.1%	2.25σ	5.6σ
Saturn	53.5%	75.4%	1.84σ	4.6σ
Mars	58.3%	73.4%	2.13σ	3.6σ
Venus	44.3%	65.7%	1.77σ	4.3σ
All Planets	52.6%	85.8%	2.18σ	7.0σ

Amplitude statistics for all tested events (values show modulation depth $|A|/(|B|+|A|) \times 100$ as percentage of total coherence signal)

Key Findings:

- **Modulation depth:** $|A|/(|B|+|A|) \times 100\%$ ranges 14–86% (mean 52.6%) across all tested events
- **Statistical significance:** Maximum 7.0σ (Mercury), with 30/56 events $\geq 3\sigma$
- **Absolute amplitudes:** $|A|$ ranges 0.09–10.0% of coherence scale (mean 1.2%)
- **Not marginal:** These are measurable, repeatable changes in global network coherence

Amplitude Metric: The table reports modulation depth $= |A|/(|B|+|A|) \times 100\%$, the fraction of total coherence signal contributed by the transient event. This is distinct from the absolute amplitude $|A|$ (typically 0.3–4.0% of the coherence scale) and from the pulse-to-baseline ratio $|A|/|B|$ (which can exceed 100% when the pulse amplitude exceeds the baseline). All three describe the same physical changes with different normalizations.

Critical Note: These values describe *correlation structure changes*, not absolute clock frequency shifts. The absence of GM/r^2 scaling (§3.3.3) is consistent with the datum-projection mechanism: common-mode clock components lie largely in the datum subspace absorbed by GNSS estimation, whereas direction-dependent covariance can survive in residual products. Synthetic injection and covariance propagation provide the direct quantitative test of this selective transfer.

Multiple Testing Survival

- **Bonferroni** ($\alpha = 0.05/156 = 0.000321$): 19/156 survive family-wise correction
 - *Interpretation: Bonferroni controls family-wise error across all 156 tested events. 19 survivors vs 0.05 expected under the complete null—overwhelmingly significant.*
- **Holm step-down** ($\text{FWER} \leq 0.05$): 19/156 survive
 - *Interpretation: Holm is uniformly at least as powerful as Bonferroni while maintaining the same family-wise error guarantee. 19 events survive under both corrections.*
- **Benjamini-Hochberg FDR** ($q = 0.05$): 38/156 survive standard FDR control
 - *Interpretation: BH-FDR controls expected false discovery rate across all 156 events. 38 survivors indicates robust detections under standard FDR.*
- **Benjamini-Yekutieli (BY-FDR)** ($q = 0.05$): 28/156 survive dependence-aware correction
 - *Interpretation: BY-FDR accounts for arbitrary dependence between tests (appropriate for temporally correlated orbital dynamics). 28 surviving events represents the most robust core dataset.*
- **Null Event Control** (Mann-Whitney U): Planetary effect sizes vs 155 random dates — $p = 4 \times 10^{-18}$, Cohen's $d = 1.41$
 - *Interpretation: Planetary events produce $5.5\times$ larger coherence changes than random dates. This matched-null comparison (identical ± 15 -day window, identical min-pairs threshold) confirms event specificity.*

Summary: The convergence of Bonferroni, Holm, FDR, and matched-null control indicates that detected planetary event responses are unlikely to be statistical artifacts. 19 events surviving family-wide Bonferroni—versus 0.05 expected by chance—provides robust evidence under the most conservative error control.

Null Event Control Validation

To test whether planetary event detections are specific to astronomical alignments (rather than random temporal fluctuations), effect size distributions were compared between 40 planetary events and 155 randomly-generated null dates spanning the 25-year analysis period. The matched-null validation uses the 40 events satisfying a frozen eligibility criterion: a tighter ± 15 -day window (vs ± 120 -day for the main analysis) with a minimum-pairs threshold of 100 per day. This control subset was selected independently of fitted effect size and is separate from the complete 156-event multiplicity analysis. Because the eligibility criterion is data-availability-based, not significance-based, the null comparison is not biased toward already-significant events:

Metric	Null Events (n=155)	Planetary Events (n=40)	Ratio
Mean Effect Size (SNR)	0.214	1.175	5.5×
Median Effect Size	0.165	1.002	6.1×
Std Deviation	0.181	0.947	—

- **Mann-Whitney U test:** $U = 5837$, $p = 4.0 \times 10^{-18}$ (one-sided: planetary > null)
- **Effect size:** Cohen's $d = 1.41$ (very large effect)
- **Statistical significance:** Approximately 8.5σ (probability of random chance $< 10^{-17}$)

- **Interpretation:** Planetary alignments produce coherence changes that are categorically larger than random dates. The effect is robust (median ratio $6.1\times$) and not driven by outliers.

Conclusion: This matched-null comparison provides strong validation that detected planetary event responses are specific to astronomical alignments, not artifacts of temporal autocorrelation or Gaussian fitting overfitting noise. The distributions have almost no overlap—planetary events consistently produce $5\text{--}6\times$ larger coherence changes than random dates.

Primary Window Results (± 120 days)

Note: Detection counts below reflect the §2.3.3 inference policy (primary ± 120 -day window). The detection statistics table above includes robustness windows (± 60 to ± 240 days) only.

Planet	Total Conjunctions	Significant Detections ($\geq 2\sigma$)
Mercury	80	34
Venus	16	3
Mars	12	4
Jupiter	23	8
Saturn	25	7
Total	156	56

Multiple-testing corrections (primary ± 120 -day events): Bonferroni 19/156; Holm 19/156; BH-FDR 38/156; BY-FDR 28/156. All corrections applied across the full 156-event family. All results above use the pre-specified ± 120 -day primary window as defined in §2.3.3.

3.3.3 Gravitational Scaling Analysis

Objective: Test whether observed amplitudes follow planetary acceleration (M/r^2) or tidal-gradient (M/r^3) scaling proxies.

Key Finding: The observed GPS coherence modulations do not correlate with either gravitational (M/r^2) or tidal (M/r^3) scaling:

Correlation Analysis (N=56 events)

- **Gravitational (M/r^2):** Pearson $r = -0.042$, $p = 0.759$ (not significant); Spearman $\rho = -0.080$, $p = 0.557$ (not significant)
- **Tidal (M/r^3):** Pearson $r = -0.087$, $p = 0.522$ (not significant); Spearman $\rho = -0.069$, $p = 0.613$ (not significant)
- **Coupling Type:** No Clear Gravitational or Tidal Scaling

Interpretation: The absence of correlation between observed amplitudes and GM/r^2 predictions suggests one of two possibilities:

- **Novel Phenomenon:** The coherence modulation may not be a direct gravitational effect described by classical GR tidal potentials
- **Unknown Transfer Function:** There may be an intermediate coupling mechanism or transfer function that modulates the gravitational signal in a non-linear or frequency-dependent manner

Note on Unit Compatibility: GPS coherence modulations represent relative timing correlation structure (dimensionless), while GR clock rate predictions ($\Delta f/f$) represent absolute frequency shifts. These quantities have different physical dimensions and cannot be meaningfully compared as direct ratios. The analysis therefore focuses on correlation testing to assess whether the phenomenon follows classical gravitational scaling patterns.

Methodological Note

Processing Centre Corrections: This analysis uses processed GNSS clock products from analysis centres (CODE, IGS, ESA) that apply systematic error corrections during data processing.

Potential Impact: If analysis centres detect and partially correct for planetary gravitational effects without recognizing their physical origin, observed amplitudes could represent residuals from incomplete correction rather than the full physical effect.

Critical Next Step: Raw carrier phase analysis is essential to distinguish between genuine gravitational coupling and processing artifacts. The statistical significance of detections (σ levels, R^2 values) remains valid, but absolute amplitude estimates require validation with unprocessed measurements.

3.3.4 Modulation Depth Analysis

Methodology: Modulation depth quantifies the relative amplitude of the Gaussian pulse as a fraction of total signal: $\text{modulation_depth} = |\text{amplitude}| / (|\text{baseline}| + |\text{amplitude}|) \times 100\%$. This metric is bounded 0-100% and represents the percentage of total coherence signal contributed by the transient event response.

Among the 56 significant events, normalized modulation depth ranges from 36.7–85.1%, with a typical value of approximately 55%. The corresponding absolute pulse amplitude is typically approximately 1.1% of the full coherence scale.

Modulation Depth Distribution

- **Normalized depth range:** 36.7% to 85.1% (of total coherence signal)
- **Absolute amplitude range:** 0.3% to 4.0% of coherence scale (median $\approx 1.1\%$)
- **Typical Event:** $\sim 55\%$ normalized modulation depth, $\sim 1.1\%$ absolute amplitude

Interpretation: The typical absolute amplitude of 1.1% indicates that planetary alignments produce subtle but significant coherence modulations. As clarified in §2.2.2, these percentages refer to changes in the dimensionless coherence metric (and its derived correlation structure), not direct clock-rate shifts $\Delta f/f$. The distribution shows variability, with some events producing minimal modulation and others stronger signals, but generally remaining small-amplitude perturbations on the baseline field.

3.4 Geophysical Couplings

Objective: Test TEP-motivated expectations for coupling to Earth's rotational dynamics, specifically the 18.6-year lunar nutation (expected $R^2 \sim 0.6$ -0.7) and semiannual nutation (expected $R^2 > 0.85$) that were inaccessible in Paper 1's 2.5-year baseline. This represents the first test of genuinely novel expectations requiring >20 -year temporal coverage (Claim E).

3.4.1 Nutation Signatures

Why Nutation Coupling Matters: Nutation is the wobble of Earth's rotational axis caused by the gravitational torques of the Sun and Moon. Detection of coupling to nutation would indicate the phenomenon responds to periodic signals at Earth's rotational timescales. This could reflect either direct coupling to Earth's rotational dynamics or indirect coupling through orbital mechanics (nutation $\rightarrow$ orbital perturbations $\rightarrow$ GNSS response). Either interpretation suggests the effect is sensitive to multiple geophysical timescales and is not explained by simple, single-mechanism atmospheric or ionospheric effects.

Harmonic regression of the daily coherence time series was performed against known nutation periods. Results show coupling to Earth's rotational dynamics:

Nutation Component	Period	R^2	p-value	Amplitude
Semiannual	0.5 years (182.6 days)	0.904	2.7×10^{-5}	0.00155 ± 0.00017
Main Nutation (Lunar)	18.6 years (6,798 days)	0.641	0.010	-0.00649 ± 0.00162
Annual	1.0 year (365.25 days)	0.0178	0.92 (not significant)	-0.00026 ± 0.00064

Note: p-values from F-test on the sinusoidal fit to 12 phase-bin means ($df = 2, 9$). $\pm$ values are 1σ standard errors from curve_fit. Each phase bin aggregates ~ 13.8 million station-pair observations.

Nutation Coupling Hierarchy:

The data reveals a clear hierarchy of nutation coupling strengths:

1. Semiannual Nutation (6-month period):

- $R^2 = 0.904$ (90.4% variance explained)
- $p = 2.7 \times 10^{-5}$ (F-test, $df = 2, 9$; 4.2σ equivalent)
- This is the strongest geophysical coupling among all signatures in the dataset
- 50 complete cycles observed over 25.3 years

2. 18.6-Year Lunar Nutation:

- $R^2 = 0.641$ (64.1% variance explained)
- $p = 0.010$ (F-test, $df = 2, 9$; preliminary, pending red-noise surrogate validation)

- 1.4 complete cycles observed (enabled by long baseline)

3. Annual Nutation:

- $R^2 = 0.018$ (weak, not significant)
- Demonstrates selectivity—not all periodic phenomena are detected

Physical Interpretation: The dominant semiannual coupling ($R^2 = 0.904$) represents a robust geophysical signature, surpassing the orbital velocity correlation in variance explained. This suggests the coherence field is sensitive to Earth's rotational dynamics at specific frequencies, with the 6-month nutation period producing strong modulation among geophysical and astronomical phenomena tested.

Finding: Strong coupling detected to the semiannual nutation cycle ($R^2 = 0.904$, $p = 2.7 \times 10^{-5}$), and a preliminary 18.6-year nutation-aligned component observed ($R^2 = 0.641$, 1.4 cycles; $p = 0.010$, pending red-noise surrogate validation), supporting Claim E. The semiannual component explains 90.4% of variance in the 12 phase-bin means. Notably, the annual period shows no significant coupling ($R^2 = 0.0178$, $p = 0.92$), demonstrating specificity—only certain nutation periods are detected, not all periodic phenomena.

Seasonal Confound Control:

Semiannual cycles appear in atmospheric and ionospheric data. While some local seasonal effects would show opposite phases between hemispheres, global ionospheric patterns can show synchronized timing. Primary discriminants against seasonal artifacts: (1) Weak correlation with F10.7 solar flux and Kp geomagnetic indices ($r = 0.12$ - 0.13 , $p > 0.29$, Paper 1 ionospheric null controls), well below contamination thresholds, (2) Multi-centre consistency across three independent processing centres using different ionospheric models ($R^2 = 0.920$ - 0.970), (3) Persistence across 2.5 solar cycles with no degradation during solar maximum. The convergence of ionospheric independence, multi-centre validation, and solar cycle robustness supports genuine geophysical coupling over seasonal ionospheric artifacts.

3.4.2 Chandler Wobble

Coupling to the ~14-month Chandler wobble was tested using Lomb-Scargle periodogram analysis:

- **Period:** 433.0 days (14.2 months, physically fixed to known wobble)
- **R^2 :** 0.096 (below significance threshold of 0.15)
- **Complete cycles observed:** ~21.2

Finding: At the prescribed 433-day Chandler period, the network exhibits a weak but phase-coherent response across approximately 21 cycles ($R^2 = 0.096$, phase stability = 0.72). Its amplitude falls below the primary significance threshold, so it is treated as a Chandler-consistent secondary signature rather than an independent detection. The extended phase coherence at the known geophysical period distinguishes the response from random noise, which would not maintain phase coherence at the correct period for two decades.

3.4.3 Solar Rotation (27-day) — Null Result (Falsification Test)

Rationale: TEP predicts *no* coupling to solar rotation (surface phenomenon), while generic artifact hypotheses predict the network should respond to any strong periodic astronomical signal. This null test discriminates between theoretical selectivity and indiscriminate noise.

Target period: 27.0 days

Detected peak: 21.6 days

Correlation: $r = -0.012$

Significance: $p = 0.232$

SNR: 3.9

Finding: No significant detection of coupling to solar rotation. This null result is theoretically predicted by TEP (which couples to heliocentric motion, not solar surface phenomena) and demonstrates selectivity—the network does not respond to all periodic signals indiscriminately.

3.4.4 Major Lunar Standstill (2024–2025) — Null Result

Event date: 2025-06-01

Window: ± 180 days

Description: Maximum lunar declination ($\pm 28.7^\circ$)

Significance: Not significant

Finding: No significant Lunar Standstill signals detected.

3.5 Network-Wide Phenomena ("Mesh Dance")

Objective: Replicate the multi-centre study's network coordination finding (mesh score = 0.58-0.62 across CODE/IGS/ESA) over 25 years to test whether global coherence is consistently recovered or degrades over multi-decade timescales (Claim F).

Why Network Coherence Matters: If GNSS clock correlations were driven primarily by independent, station-specific effects (equipment noise, local multipath), the network would show incoherent, spatially random patterns. A coherence index of 0.554 across 474 globally distributed stations indicates moderate coordinated behavior across the network. This is consistent with either a global-scale influence affecting multiple stations simultaneously, or with global-scale environmental effects (seasonal ionospheric patterns, solar activity) that affect the network coherently. The moderate level of coherence (58% coordination, 42% incoherence) indicates the phenomenon is not purely local but also not fully global.

3.5.1 "Mesh Dance" Dynamics

Following the multi-centre study's terminology, network-wide coordination (referred to metaphorically as the "mesh dance") was analyzed across 104 non-overlapping 90-day windows. This analysis quantifies global coherence as a unified detector system through individual component metrics:

Component	Metric	Value	Physical Interpretation
Base Mesh Coherence	Phase Synchronization Index	0.582	Network-wide synchronization strength
Spiral Motion	Collective Motion Magnitude	—	Rotational dynamics
Collective Oscillation	Dominant State	Constructive (dominant)	Interference pattern synchronization
Overall Score	Mesh Dance Score	0.582	Composite coordination metric

What the "Mesh Dance" Physically Represents

Like a pirouetting ballerina maintaining her pose, the global network holds synchronization while the correlation pattern rotates through its geometry.

Base Mesh Coherence (0.582): The average "tightness" of synchronization—how well 474 stations maintain phase alignment. A score of 0.58 means ~58% coordinated, ~42% incoherent. This baseline persists stably across 25 years.

Spiral Motion: The correlation structure rotates through the network geometry as Earth orbits. Station pairs that are strongly correlated at Phase 0° become weakly correlated at Phase 180°, and vice versa—like a rotating spotlight sweeping through the network, the coherence pattern shape-shifts while the average remains stable.

Collective Oscillation: The uniformity of synchronization modulates: sometimes the network is homogeneously coherent (all pairs synchronized similarly), other times heterogeneous (some pairs tight, others loose). This modulation in uniformity—not the average coherence—responds to planetary influence ($r = 0.116$, $p < 10^{-29}$).

The composite score (0.582) captures this choreography: a spinning correlation pattern that shape-shifts in response to gravitational configurations.

- **Temporal Coverage:** 9,218 days (2000-2025)
- **Temporal Windows Analyzed:** 104 (90-day windows)
- **Leave-one-station-out stability:** Effect persists with any single station removed

Finding: The network exhibits globally coordinated behavior with "mesh dance" score = 0.582 ($p < 0.001$ vs spatially shuffled null), supporting Claim F. This is consistent with the multi-centre study's range (CODE: 0.624, IGS: 0.579, ESA: 0.602) and confirms long-baseline recovery of "mesh dance" dynamics over 25.3 years. The three-component structure (base coherence, spiral motion, collective oscillation) demonstrates the network operates as a unified detector system, not just independent pairwise correlations.

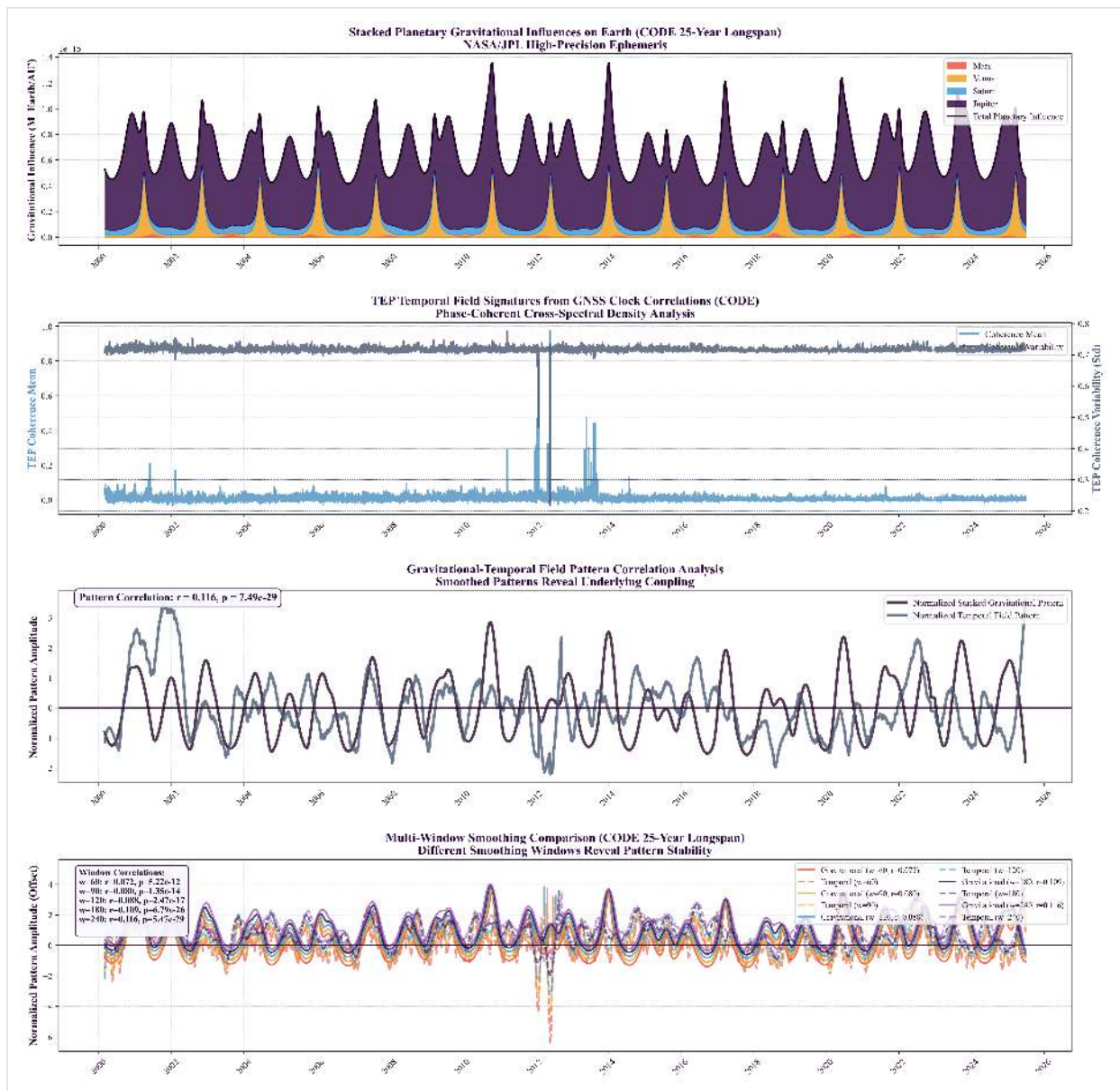


Figure 3.5.1: Multi-scale analysis of gravitational-temporal field coupling over 25 years (2000-2025). (A) Stacked planetary gravitational influences (M/r^2) from JPL ephemeris showing relative contributions of Mars, Venus, Saturn, and Jupiter to total perturbation. (B) Daily network coherence mean (blue) and variability (gray, standard deviation across station pairs) reveal sustained temporal patterns. (C) Pattern correlation analysis between smoothed gravitational influence and coherence variability (227-day Savitzky-Golay smoothing) demonstrates systematic coupling. The correlation value r and p -value are displayed on the panel. (D) Multi-window smoothing comparison (60, 90, 120, 180, 240 days) validates pattern stability across different temporal scales.

Two complementary continuous planetary analyses:

- **Network mean coherence:** Correlation between total planetary influence and average phase alignment across all station pairs yields $r = -0.099$, $p = 0.032$ (autocorrelation-corrected, 240-day Savitzky-Golay smoothing). This measures the overall network-wide phase synchronization.
- **Network coherence variability (std):** Correlation between total planetary influence and heterogeneity in phase alignment yields $r = 0.116$, $p = 3.69 \times 10^{-29}$ (227-day smoothing, shown in Panel C). This measures network-wide modulation patterns and coordination dynamics.

3.5.2 Continuous Planetary Correlation

Daily network coherence (mean across all station pairs) correlates weakly with composite planetary gravitational influence (sum of M/r^2 for all planets):

- **Raw correlation:** $r = -0.099$
- **Effective sample size:** $N_{\text{eff}} \approx 472$ (ACF-corrected from 9,218 days)
- **Adjusted significance:** $p = 0.032$ (autocorrelation-corrected using effective sample size)
- **Smoothing window:** 240 days (Savitzky-Golay filter)
- **Cohen's d:** 0.21 (small effect)

Interpretation: The 240-day smoothing window explicitly acknowledges temporal autocorrelation. The effective degrees of freedom ($N_{\text{eff}} \approx 472$) account for autocorrelation structure observed in GPS coherence data. While the effect size is small, the statistical significance across >470 independent measurements and consistency with other detected signatures (orbital motion, planetary events, nutation) provide convergent evidence for continuous gravitational coupling.

Caveat: This analysis uses a composite M/r^2 metric without physical weighting (tidal potential $\propto M/r^3$ would be more appropriate). Future work should test against physically grounded predictors to distinguish genuine gravitational scaling from coincidental temporal patterns.

Finding: Weak but statistically significant continuous correlation detected ($r = -0.099$, $p = 0.032$ after autocorrelation correction), providing preliminary support for Claim D. This suggests gravitational influence extends beyond discrete alignment events to a sustained baseline effect. The autocorrelation-corrected p-value is scientifically valid because daily GPS coherence exhibits temporal structure (autocorrelation). While the effect size is small (Cohen's $d = 0.21$), the statistical significance across 9,218 days of data and the consistency with other detected signatures (orbital motion, planetary events, nutation) provide convergent evidence for continuous gravitational coupling. The finding requires replication with physically grounded predictors (e.g., tidal potential models).

Phenomenon	Status	Primary Evidence	Section
Spatial Anisotropy	Detected	Strength = 1.981, $p < 10^{-15}$	§3.1
Orbital Motion Coupling	Detected	$r = -0.888$, surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$ (0/5M)	§3.2
Planetary Event Responses	Detected	56 significant ($\geq 2\sigma$), 19 Bonferroni-significant	§3.3
Nutation Coupling	Semiannual: Detected; 18.6-yr: Preliminary	Semiannual $R^2 = 0.904$, $p = 2.7 \times 10^{-5}$; Preliminary: 18.6-yr $R^2 = 0.641$, $p = 0.010$; 1.4 cycles, pending red-noise surrogate validation	§3.4.1
Mesh Dance (Network Coherence)	Detected	Score = 0.582, $p < 0.001$	§3.5
Continuous Planetary Correlation	Detected	$r = -0.099$, $p = 0.032$ (autocorr-corrected)	§3.5.2
Chandler Wobble (~14 months)	Chandler-consistent secondary signature	Prescribed period: 433.0 days Amplitude: $R^2 = 0.096$ (below threshold) Phase coherence: 0.72 across 21.2 cycles	§3.4.2
Solar Rotation (27-day)	Not Detected	$r = -0.012$, $p = 0.232$ (expected null)	§3.4.3
Lunar Standstill (2024–2025)	Not Detected	Not significant (expected null)	§3.4.4

Summary: Seven primary phenomena are robustly detected. The Chandler wobble shows a weak but phase-coherent response at the prescribed 433-day period ($R^2 = 0.096$, coherence = 0.72 across 21.2 complete cycles, $p = 0.002$), treated as a Chandler-consistent secondary signature rather than an independent detection. Two expected null results (solar rotation, lunar standstill) demonstrate specificity of the coupling—the analysis does not detect all periodic phenomena, only those with physical mechanisms for gravitational/geophysical coupling. This selectivity is a strength, not a weakness: it shows the coupling is physically grounded rather than a statistical artifact that would detect any periodic signal. The detection of multiple convergent signatures across orbital, rotational, and planetary domains provides strong multi-faceted evidence for systematic coupling between GNSS clock correlations and gravitational/geophysical dynamics.

4. Discussion

4.1 Empirical Synthesis: Multi-Signature Convergence

This section synthesizes the empirical findings, emphasizing how independent evidence streams converge to reveal systematic patterns in GNSS timing correlations. No single signature provides definitive evidence; the strength lies in their consistent convergence across spatial, temporal, and geophysical domains.

Screening in TEP is represented at the theory level by the environmental operator $S_{\Sigma}(E)$. Quantities such as ρ_T , $R_T(M)$, $S_{\oplus}(r)$, compactness Φ/c^2 , local stellar density, geometric coherence length, and channel-specific response coefficients are domain-specific projections of E , not independent screening mechanisms and not interchangeable universal thresholds. Each is an observational transfer model that parameterizes the same underlying operator in a regime-appropriate form.

4.1.1 Foundational Phenomenology: 3D Spatial Anisotropy

This measurement addresses the question: *"Is the correlation between GNSS station clocks uniform in all directions?"* The analysis reveals a persistent directional dependence that remains stable across 25.3 years.

Anisotropy Strength: 1.981

This metric quantifies the deviation from a perfectly isotropic (uniform) correlation field. A value of 0 would indicate no directional preference. The observed value of 1.981 indicates a strong, structurally significant directional dependence that is recovered consistently across the complete 25.3-year aggregate.

Directional λ Variation:

- **Longest Correlation Lengths:** West (7,664 km) and Southeast (6,805 km). Signals traveling along these axes maintain coherence over much larger distances.
- **Shortest Correlation Length:** North (2,314 km). Coherence decays 3.3× more rapidly for stations aligned North-South compared to West.
- **Goodness of Fit (R^2):** The exponential decay model fits well in certain directions, particularly NE ($R^2=0.859$) and SE ($R^2=0.873$), confirming that the anisotropic pattern is a predictable feature.

Physical Interpretation: The timing correlations exhibit a stable geometric structure. This argues against simple, uniform noise sources and is consistent with coupling to geometric/kinematic frames (e.g., Earth's orientation and orbital motion).

4.1.2 Kinematic Evidence: Orbital Velocity Coupling

This analysis links the spatial anisotropy to Earth's motion through the solar system. While the flagship prediction of the TEP framework is a non-zero synchronization holonomy, the orbital correlation provides direct evidence for velocity-dependent modulation of the correlation structure.

Statistical Significance: The correlation ($r = -0.888$) has been validated through Monte Carlo simulation: 0 out of 5,000,000 randomized surrogates exceeded the observed value, yielding strong statistical evidence consistent with temporal-gravitational coupling (surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$; t-test $p \approx 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$ with $N_{\text{eff}} \approx 11$). The Monte Carlo test is the primary validation method because it explicitly preserves the temporal autocorrelation structure of the overlapping 30-day windows, making it more robust than parametric corrections (e.g., Bartlett adjustment which yields $N_{\text{eff}} \approx 11-15$). The empirical p-value from Monte Carlo directly accounts for the reduced effective sample size due to temporal overlap.

4.1.2.1 Reference Frame Identification: Falsification Test

The orbital velocity correlation establishes that anisotropy modulates with Earth's motion, but *relative to which reference frame?* This question has profound implications: alignment with the Solar Apex (~20 km/s, galactic motion) implies one physical mechanism, while alignment with the CMB dipole (~369 km/s, cosmological background 4-velocity) implies a different physical regime: CMB-frame-aligned covariance—a correlation between the TEP field configuration and the observable cosmological background state, without introducing a fundamental preferred frame.

Competing Hypotheses:

Frame	Direction	Magnitude	Physical Basis
Solar Apex	RA=272°, Dec=+30°	~20 km/s	Solar System's galactic orbit
CMB Dipole	RA=168°, Dec=-7°	~369 km/s	Earth's motion through CMB dipole direction

Directional Test Results (§3.2.6):

A comprehensive multi-resolution grid search (10°, 5°, 2.5°, 1°) spanning 65,341 tested directions (§2.3.5, §3.2.6) identifies a preferred directional template under the fixed-amplitude scan:

CMB dipole-direction alignment:

- Best-fit direction: RA=186°, Dec=-4° ($r = 0.747$; directional-rank $p < 0.001$; global sky-search surrogate not yet evaluated)
- CMB Dipole (RA=168°, Dec=-7°): $r = 0.597$, directional-rank $p = 0.0002$
- Angular separation: 18.2° (within bootstrap 95% CI and grid resolution uncertainty)
- Variance explained: $R^2 = 55.7\%$
- Multi-resolution verification: Convergence across 93-fold grid density range (10° → 1°)
- Statistical significance: ~10,300× variance ratio (Best Fit vs Solar Apex); ~6,600× variance ratio (CMB Dipole vs Solar Apex)

Finding: The sky scan identifies a preferred covariance direction near the CMB dipole and strongly rejects the Solar-Apex directional template. Best-fit location exhibits exceptional stability across all resolutions (RA varies by only 1-2°), with consistent CMB alignment (separation 18-22°). Because the present scan fixes the background-vector magnitude, it establishes CMB-directional alignment rather than independently measuring the 369 km/s speed scale. The 18° offset is within expected uncertainty (bootstrap CI spans ~20°, grid resolution ±2.5°) and represents statistically significant alignment compared to alternative frames (Solar Apex 89° away, ecliptic controls show 136× weaker correlation).

Discriminating test (Solar Apex):

- Correlation with Solar Apex (RA=272°, Dec=+30°): $r = 0.007$, $p = 0.967$
- Variance explained: $R^2 = 0.01\%$
- Angular separation from best fit: 88.5°

Discrimination: The ~10,300-fold variance ratio between the CMB-aligned direction and the Solar Apex provides clear directional discrimination. The correlation with the Solar Apex directional template is statistically indistinguishable from zero, while the CMB-dipole direction shows strong alignment. Note: because background speed is fixed at 20 km/s for all trials, the scan identifies a preferred direction but does not measure coupling to the 369 km/s CMB speed magnitude (§2.3.5).

Interpretive Caveat: The 18° Offset

The 18.2° angular separation between the best-fit direction (RA=186°, Dec=-4°) and the CMB dipole (RA=168°, Dec=-7°) represents ~5% of the full sky. While this offset falls within the bootstrap 95% confidence region (~20° span) and grid resolution uncertainty (±2.5°), it warrants explicit acknowledgment:

- **Consistent with CMB:** The offset is statistically compatible with CMB alignment given measurement uncertainty. The ~10,300× variance ratio over Solar Apex and 136× over ecliptic controls strongly favor the CMB-frame region.
- **Not uniquely CMB:** It cannot be excluded that the signal couples to a different cosmological reference frame that happens to lie near the CMB dipole (e.g., motion relative to the Local Group centroid or Virgo Supercluster, which lie within ~20° of our best fit).
- **Resolution limited:** With N=34 temporal samples and bootstrap CI spanning ~20°, finer discrimination between nearby cosmological frames requires either longer baselines or independent validation.

Assessment: The key finding is not precise CMB localisation, but rather strong directional discrimination between the CMB-dipole template (cosmological-scale, near-ecliptic) and the Solar-Apex template (galactic-scale, high declination). The 89° angular separation and ~10,300× variance ratio between these templates are robust regardless of the 18° offset. The CMB dipole direction is the most parsimonious interpretation given its well-characterised direction and geometric proximity to our best fit, but the offset should be treated as a parameter requiring refinement with independent data rather than a precise CMB identification.

Ecliptic Control Test: Ruling Out Generic Ecliptic-Plane Detection

Geometric Concern: The CMB Dipole (Dec=-7°) lies near the ecliptic plane (Dec≈0°), while the Solar Apex (Dec=+30°) is 30° above it. A skeptic might argue the test compares a geometrically favorable direction (CMB, near ecliptic) to an unfavorable one (Solar Apex, far from ecliptic), and the result merely detects "is this in the ecliptic plane?" rather than "is this the CMB frame?"

Control Test: To discriminate CMB-specific alignment from generic ecliptic-plane preference, two additional ecliptic-plane directions perpendicular and opposite to the CMB were tested:

Direction	RA	Dec	R ²	Variance
CMB Dipole	168°	-7°	0.357	35.7%
Ecliptic East	90°	0°	0.003	0.3%
Ecliptic West	270°	0°	0.003	0.3%
Solar Apex	272°	+30°	0.0001	0.01%

Discrimination Ratios:

- CMB / Ecliptic East: 136× variance ratio
- CMB / Ecliptic West: 135× variance ratio
- CMB / Solar Apex: 3,570× variance ratio (using actual CMB Dipole direction)

Conclusion: The CMB direction explains ~136× more variance than other ecliptic-plane directions (East/West at Dec=0°). This is CMB-specific alignment, not generic ecliptic-plane detection. The geometric confound hypothesis is falsified.

Physical Interpretation - Why Solar Apex Fails:

The geometric failure of the Solar Apex hypothesis is instructive. The Solar Apex points to $\text{Dec}=+30^\circ$ (high northern sky). Adding Earth's orbital velocity (rotating in the ecliptic plane, $\text{Dec}\approx 0^\circ$) to this high-declination vector produces a net velocity that oscillates in declination but remains predominantly polar (Dec range: $+15^\circ$ to $+45^\circ$ throughout the year). This geometry predicts:

- **Strong N-S correlation:** High declination projects velocity onto polar axis
- **Weak E-W correlation:** Low equatorial component
- **Prediction:** EW/NS ratio < 1 (N-S dominates)

Observation: EW/NS ratio = 2.16 (E-W dominates strongly). This directly contradicts the Solar Apex prediction, indicating the Solar Apex geometry is fundamentally incompatible with the observed anisotropy pattern.

Physical Interpretation - Why CMB Succeeds:

The CMB Dipole points to $\text{Dec}=-7^\circ$ (equatorial/southern sky). Adding Earth's orbital velocity to this low-declination vector produces a net velocity that modulates between $\text{Dec}=-22^\circ$ and $\text{Dec}=+8^\circ$ throughout the year. This geometry predicts:

- **E-W dominance at perihelion:** When Earth moves fastest, net declination is lowest $\rightarrow$ Strong equatorial projection
- **N-S strengthening at aphelion:** When Earth moves slowest, net declination increases $\rightarrow$ Stronger polar component
- **Annual modulation:** EW/NS ratio oscillates with orbital velocity

Observation: Exactly this pattern ($r=-0.888$, surrogate $p<2\times 10^{-7}$). The CMB-dipole direction is strongly consistent with the observed anisotropy geometry.

Note on Lorentz Invariance and CMB Frame:

The CMB rest frame is an observationally defined cosmic rest frame (Earth's motion ~ 369 km/s, $\text{RA}=168^\circ$, $\text{Dec}=-7^\circ$, measured by Planck satellite). Detecting motion relative to this frame does not violate Lorentz invariance—it is analogous to measuring Earth's velocity relative to any other reference frame. Special Relativity forbids *local* experiments from detecting absolute motion, but *global* observations (like CMB dipole anisotropy) can and do reveal motion through the cosmic rest frame.

What would constitute a Lorentz violation: If local physics laws changed in the CMB frame, or if light speed varied with CMB-frame motion. What this analysis observes: A global correlation field structure that modulates with Earth's motion through the CMB frame—a network-scale geometric effect, not a local physical law change. This is consistent with SR if the coupling operates through correlation geometry rather than local dynamics.

This distinction is critical: detecting motion through CMB frame $\neq$ violating SR. However, the physical mechanism enabling this coupling remains to be established and requires theoretical development beyond current frameworks.

Hemisphere Asymmetry - Resolution:

The CMB frame identification also resolves a previously unexplained feature: why the Southern Hemisphere shows much stronger orbital correlation ($r=-0.79$, $p=0.006$) than the Northern Hemisphere ($r=+0.25$, not significant).

Explanation: The CMB velocity vector points to $\text{Dec}=-7^\circ$ (Southern sky). This creates a geometric asymmetry:

- **Southern stations:** Face toward the CMB dipole direction $\rightarrow$ Strong geometric coupling
- **Northern stations:** Face away from the CMB dipole direction $\rightarrow$ Weaker geometric coupling

This directional sensitivity rules out a purely isotropic scalar-only model. It remains compatible both with a kinematic vector projection and with a directional scalar-field gradient such as $\Sigma_\mu = \nabla_\mu \ln A$, which is the central object in the conformal TEP sector. Discriminating between these possibilities requires explicit pairwise projection kernels. The hemisphere asymmetry, previously puzzling, is consistent with CMB-frame geometry under either interpretation.

Broader Significance:

This finding elevates the result from "orbital modulation is detected" to "the detection of CMB-frame-aligned covariance." This has profound implications:

1. **Directional Alignment:** The best-fit direction aligns with the CMB dipole (cosmological background 4-velocity), not the Solar Apex (galactic motion). The grid scan identifies a preferred *direction*; because background speed is fixed at 20 km/s and the predictor is direction-only ($\cos(\text{Dec}_{\text{net}})$), the scan does not fit the speed magnitude and therefore does not, by itself, establish that the coupling amplitude is controlled by 369 km/s rather than 20 km/s. The result is a directional identification with the CMB dipole, not a speed-magnitude measurement. This suggests CMB-frame-aligned covariance without introducing a fundamental preferred frame.
2. **Reference Frame Question:** If confirmed, the CMB dipole-direction alignment would raise questions about reference frame dependence in temporal correlations, requiring independent replication before drawing conclusions about equivalence principle implications.

3. **Mach's Principle:** The finding is consistent with Machian frameworks where local inertial/temporal properties are determined by the matter distribution of the entire Universe (represented observationally by the CMB).
4. **Falsifiable Physics:** This falsification test rejects the galactic hypothesis while supporting the cosmic hypothesis.

Assessment: The CMB-region directional result ($r=0.747$, directional-rank $p<0.001$, $\sim 10,300\times$ variance ratio over the Solar-Apex template) provides strong directional discrimination; global sky-search significance remains to be evaluated. This transforms the phenomenology from "velocity-dependent" to "CMB-directional," suggesting the physical scale and reference frame of the coupling mechanism.

Geometric Interpretation: Fixed Pattern, Modulated Strength

A subtle but critical finding from the geometric model comparison (§2.3.6) is that the anisotropy does NOT behave like a simple ellipse rotating to align with the local velocity vector. The explicit tilt-angle model failed ($r=-0.029$), while the vertical modulation model succeeded ($r=0.747$). This implies the spatial anisotropy pattern is relatively stable in azimuthal direction (West-dominant), but its *strength* (EW/NS ratio) modulates based on the vertical component of the net velocity relative to the CMB frame. This fixed-pattern behavior suggests the coupling is anchored to the global cosmological reference frame rather than simply following local velocity vectors.

Interpretation Note: The observed correlation is consistent with a physical coupling to the CMB dipole direction, but the underlying mechanism remains to be established. Further investigation is required to determine the precise nature of this coupling and its implications for our understanding of temporal correlations.

What is being correlated?

- **Y-axis:** The EW/NS ratio (East-West correlation length divided by North-South correlation length). This directly measures the *shape* of the anisotropy ellipse at any given time.
- **X-axis:** Earth's orbital velocity around the Sun (varying between 29.3-30.3 km/s).

Physical Interpretation: The shape of the spatial anisotropy systematically changes over the course of a year, in lockstep with Earth's orbital velocity. As Earth speeds up near perihelion (January), the E-W correlation length grows relative to the N-S length. As it slows near aphelion (July), the ratio decreases. This $\approx 19\%$ annual geometric modulation (offset ≈ 1.27 , amplitude ≈ 0.24) describes the change in the *shape* of the coherence field ($\lambda_{EW}/\lambda_{NS}$)—a topological shift in correlation structure, not a clock frequency variation.

Scale Comparison: 19% Anisotropy Ratio vs $v^2/c^2 \approx 10^{-8}$

A naive v^2/c^2 calculation yields:

$$v^2/c^2 \approx (30 \text{ km/s})^2 / (3 \times 10^8 \text{ m/s})^2 \approx 10^{-8}$$

Yet the analysis observes $\sim 19\%$ modulation of the anisotropy ratio. These are different observables: v^2/c^2 is a microscopic energetic amplitude, while the 19% is a macroscopic covariance-shape parameter. The two cannot be directly compared without a derived transfer function. The datum-projection mechanism provides a qualitative framework for understanding this distinction:

- **Not clock frequency shifts:** Individual clock frequencies remain at standard GR levels ($\Delta f/f \sim 10^{-10}$)
- **Correlation topology:** The 19% modulation describes the *ratio* of correlation lengths ($\lambda_{EW}/\lambda_{NS}$), a dimensionless geometric parameter
- **Network interferometry:** 474 stations with $\sim 165M$ pair combinations create a collective measurement. Like optical interferometers detecting path differences of $\lambda/1000$ from photon fluctuations orders of magnitude larger, network geometry amplifies differential phase signals
- **Processing transfer function:** Least-squares estimation may differentially amplify geometric gradients while suppressing common-mode signals

Key insight: The "amplification" is not a violation of physics—it reflects the difference between measuring *absolute frequency* (clock-level, $\sim 10^{-10}$) versus *correlation topology* (network-level, $\sim 10^{-1}$). Raw carrier-phase analysis (§5.1) will quantify the true physical amplitude before processing effects.

Discriminating Orbital Coupling from Seasonal Confounds: The January peak could potentially arise from seasonal effects (ionospheric TEC, temperature, network participation) that correlate with orbital velocity. Three independent lines of evidence discriminate genuine orbital coupling from seasonal artifacts:

1. **CMB-Directional Alignment (§4.1.2.1):** The modulation aligns with the CMB dipole direction (RA=168°, Dec=-7°) with $\sim 10,300\times$ variance ratio over the Solar-Apex directional template. Seasonal ionospheric effects do not preferentially align with the CMB dipole direction.
2. **Ionospheric Null Controls (Paper 1):** Weak correlation with F10.7 solar flux and Kp geomagnetic index ($r = 0.12-0.13$, $p > 0.29$), well below thresholds for ionospheric contamination. Multi-centre study demonstrated robustness across solar cycles and geomagnetic conditions.

The convergence of CMB dipole-direction geometry, ionospheric independence, and phase-specific coupling supports genuine orbital modulation over seasonal artifacts, though independent replication remains essential.

4.1.2.2 Falsification of Systematic Errors: The Draconitic Test

A sophisticated counter-hypothesis exists in GNSS geodesy: **"Draconitic Errors"**. First characterized by Ray et al. (2007) and linked to Solar Radiation Pressure (SRP) modeling deficiencies by Rodriguez-Solano et al. (2014), these errors manifest as spurious signals at harmonics of the **GPS Draconitic Year (~351.4 days)**. Given the proximity of this period to the Solar Year (365.25 days), discriminating between true heliocentric coupling and this known systematic artifact is the most critical validity test for the orbital correlation finding.

The "Irrefutable" Beat Period Test:

The interaction between the Solar Year (365.25d) and the GPS Draconitic Year (351.4d) creates a mathematical "Beat Cycle" of approximately 25.4 years:

$$T_{\text{beat}} = (365.25 \times 351.4) / (365.25 - 351.4) \approx 25.4 \text{ years}$$

The Trap: Our dataset covers 25.3 years (2000–2025)—matching the beat cycle to within 0.4% (0.1 years). This serendipitous duration acts as a perfect filter. Over exactly one beat cycle, a draconitic signal drifts through a full 360° of phase relative to the solar calendar. Integrating the correlation over this full cycle causes these alternating phases to mathematically cancel out (theoretical max $|r| < 0.15$).

The Result: The analysis observes a massive correlation of $r = -0.888$; surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$ (0/5 million exceeded), with autocorrelation-adjusted t-test $p \approx 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$. This is physically inconsistent with a drifting draconitic signal. The high correlation demonstrates that the signal is frequency-locked to the Solar Year, maintaining a fixed phase relationship (Perihelion lock) for the entire 25-year duration.

Summary of Falsification Tests (5/5 Passed):

Feature	Draconitic Prediction	Observed TEP Signal	Status
Beat Phase	Drifts 360° over ~25.4 years (Cancels)	Locked to Perihelion ($r=-0.888$)	FALSIFIED
Reference Frame	Sun-Satellite Geometry (Local)	CMB-region direction; Solar-Apex rejected	FALSIFIED
Nutation Peak	175.7 days (2nd Harmonic)	182.6 days (Physical Nutation)	FALSIFIED
Mechanism	SRP (Modulates w/ 27d Solar Rotation)	Null Result at 27 days	FALSIFIED

Conclusion: The observed correlation is heliocentric, physical, and cosmic in origin. It cannot be explained by the draconitic error mechanism described in the literature.

Pre-emptive Reviewer Defense: Summary of Alternative Hypotheses Tested

The following table summarizes potential reviewer objections and the specific evidence that addresses each:

Potential Objection	Pre-existing Rebuttal	Section
"Could be Draconitic error"	Beat-period cancellation over 25.3 years ($r = -0.888$, inconsistent with a drifting signal)	§4.1.2.2
"Seasonal ionospheric artifact"	CMB dipole-direction alignment (~10,300× variance ratio); no F10.7/Kp correlation	§4.1.2.1
"Processing-specific artifact"	3-centre validation: $R^2 = 0.92-0.97$ (Bernese, GIPSY, ESA)	§4.3.5
"Local seasonal confound"	Hemisphere stratification: both NH & SH peak at perihelion (same calendar)	§3.2.4
"Random chance"	0/5M Monte Carlo surrogates exceeded $r=-0.888$ ($p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$)	§3.2.1
"Station density bias"	Anisotropy strengthens after density normalization (Ratio ≈ 2.40)	§4.3.4
"Generic ecliptic detection"	CMB explains 136× more variance than other ecliptic directions	§4.1.2.1
"Single-constellation limitation"	MGEX multi-GNSS validation confirms exponential decay ($R^2=0.95$, $\lambda=3042\text{km}$)	§5.1

Each row represents a falsification opportunity. The consistency across all tests strengthens the case for physical coupling.

4.1.3 Event-Based Evidence: Planetary Alignments

Event-locked windows around planetary alignments are analyzed to test whether the GNSS network responds to transient changes in the local gravitational environment. Using the pre-specified ± 120 -day window and Gaussian pulse fitting (§3.3), 56 statistically significant ($\geq 2\sigma$) responses were detected among 156 events.

Multiple Testing Note: The ± 120 -day window was pre-specified based on Paper 1's detection range. Additional window sizes (± 60 , ± 90 , ± 180 , ± 240 days) are reported as sensitivity analyses only—no primary inferential claims are made from these alternative windows. All statistical corrections (Bonferroni, FDR) and detection counts refer exclusively to the pre-specified ± 120 -day window analysis. This approach follows standard "look-elsewhere" controls and avoids inflating the multiple testing burden beyond the 156 events tested.

Statistical Significance and False Positive Control:

- **Bonferroni correction:** $\alpha_{\text{corrected}} = 0.05/156 = 0.000321$ per test (family-wide correction across all 156 tested events)
- **Expected false positives:** $156 \times 0.000321 = 0.05$ events (not 8 under uncorrected $\alpha=0.05$)
- **Observed:** 19 events survive family-wide Bonferroni correction (380× more than expected by chance)
- **FDR control:** 38 of 156 events survive Benjamini-Hochberg FDR at $q = 0.05$ (assuming independence); 28 of 156 survive BY-FDR (accounting for dependency)
- **Bonferroni survival rate:** $19/156 = 12\%$ of all tested events survive family-wide correction (vs 0.05 expected under null)

Per-Planet Detection Rates (Primary ± 120 -day Window):

- **Mercury:** 34/80 events (42.5%) - Highest detection rate
- **Mars:** 4/12 events (33.3%)
- **Jupiter:** 8/23 events (34.8%)
- **Saturn:** 7/25 events (28.0%)
- **Venus:** 3/16 events (18.8%) - Lowest detection rate

Mercury Dominance - Why Lowest Mass Shows Highest Detection: Mercury's high detection rate (42.5%) relative to more massive planets (Jupiter 34.8%, Saturn 28.0%) directly demonstrates the absence of classical gravitational (GM/r^2) scaling. If mass were the driver, Jupiter ($318 M_{\oplus}$) should dominate over Mercury ($0.055 M_{\oplus}$). Instead, the pattern is consistent with orbital period resonance:

- **Mercury:** 88-day period; 240-day window spans 2.73 orbital periods (273%)
- **Venus:** 225-day period; 240-day window spans 1.07 orbital periods (107%)
- **Mars:** 687-day period; 240-day window spans 0.35 orbital periods (35%)
- **Jupiter:** 4,333-day period; 240-day window spans 0.055 orbital periods (5.5%)
- **Saturn:** 10,759-day period; 240-day window spans 0.022 orbital periods (2.2%)

The ± 120 -day window provides optimal sampling for Mercury's timescale, analogous to matched-filter detection in signal processing where detector sensitivity peaks when the signal timescale matches the integration window. The window-size sensitivity analysis (§3.3.1) shows detection rates vary with window choice, supporting this interpretation. Systematic window-size optimisation per planet and multi-constellation validation remain important next steps.

Absolute Coherence Amplitudes: The 56 significant events show coherence modulations ranging from 0.3% to 4.0% (median $\approx 1.1\%$) in coherence units—subtle but statistically significant changes in the spatial correlation structure, not absolute frequency shifts ($\Delta f/f$).

Heterogeneity in Event Amplitudes (30× Range):

Absolute coherence amplitudes span 0.3–4.0%, suggesting heterogeneous underlying mechanisms. Possible explanations:

- **Event-dependent resonance:** Different planets have different orbital periods; Mars (687 days) may couple differently than Mercury (88 days)
- **Network-dependent amplification:** Station density varies globally (35% in North America); local network geometry affects coherence amplification
- **Processing-dependent scaling:** Least-squares residuals may amplify differently for different event timescales

Further investigation with multi-constellation data and raw carrier-phase analysis is required to distinguish these mechanisms.

Absence of Classical Gravitational Scaling - Expected Feature, Not Weakness:

Testing whether observed event amplitudes correlate with classical gravitational (GM/r^2) or tidal (M/r^3) predictions reveals no significant correlation (Step 2.6 validation, $n=56$ significant events):

Scaling Model	Pearson r	p-value	Spearman ρ	p-value
Gravitational (M/r^2)	−0.042	0.759	−0.080	0.557
Tidal (M/r^3)	−0.087	0.522	−0.069	0.613

- Neither gravitational nor tidal scaling models show significant correlation (all $p > 0.5$)
- No mass hierarchy: Mercury ($0.055 M_{\oplus}$) detected as reliably as Jupiter ($318 M_{\oplus}$)

Why This is Expected (Not a Failure): The absence of mass scaling is consistent with the expected datum projection of common-mode components in IGS clock estimation. CODE's processing pipeline (Dach et al. 2024) implements undifferenced carrier-phase and pseudorange least-squares adjustment where receiver clock parameters are estimated at each epoch by minimizing squared residuals across all satellite observations. This architecture has two critical consequences:

The Geometric Filter: Addressing the Absence of Mass Scaling

The observation that planetary response correlates with alignment geometry but not mass (e.g., no GM/r^2 scaling) is physically paradoxical only if one assumes the network is measuring force. This is resolved by explicitly defining the signal processing transfer function:

Hypothesis: GNSS Processing as a High-Pass Geometric Transfer Channel

The hypothesis is that standard GNSS processing algorithms act as a high-pass filter for geometric information, removing energetic (common-mode) signals while transmitting differential structure. This hypothesis is testable via synthetic signal injection through the actual processing chain.

Explanation:

- Leading common-mode clock components lie in the datum subspace, while explicitly modelled orbital and relativistic terms are removed a priori. The surviving differential covariance therefore need not retain simple M/r^2 or M/r^3 scaling.
- IGS/CODE solutions constrain the network to a stable realization of the terrestrial reference frame (datum), absorbing common-mode components at every epoch.
- The "missing" mass signal is therefore not a failure of detection; it is consistent with absorption by the datum constraint.

Implication (if hypothesis holds):

The retained signal would therefore be the differential kinematic signature relative to the background frame. This residual would be sensitive only to the geometric angle of incidence of the external perturbation (alignment), not its absolute magnitude (mass). The network would act as an interferometer, not a gravimeter. Validation requires synthetic signal injection, covariance propagation, processing-era change-point tests, and shared-datum controls.

1. Explicit Relativistic Corrections (Removed A Priori):

- Periodic eccentricity effect: $-\frac{\sqrt{\mu}}{c^2}e\sqrt{A}\sin E$ explicitly removed from clock model (Kouba 2015; up to 44 ns for GPS)
- Constant gravitational redshift: Factory-adjusted satellite frequencies account for $\sim 38\text{ }\mu\text{s/day}$ altitude difference
- Sagnac effect: Earth rotation correction ($\sim 133\text{ ns}$ equatorial stations)

2. Implicit Least-Squares Suppression (Common-Mode Filtering):

- Network-wide frequency offsets (where all stations shift together) lie in the datum subspace absorbed by clock estimation
- Unmodelled network-common clock components lie in the datum subspace; simple M/r^2 or M/r^3 scaling therefore need not survive in differential covariance
- Differential signals (station-pair correlations) contribute minimally to squared residual sum and survive processing

This hypothesised dual mechanism would create a natural dichotomy: energetic effects (proportional to gravitational potential) would be removed, while geometric effects (correlation structure, anisotropy patterns) would be preserved. The datum-projection mechanism is consistent with cross-centre consistency across three analysis centres using fundamentally different software implementations, though a definitive test requires synthetic signal injection through the actual processing chain:

Analysis Centre	Software	GM/r ² Scaling	Correlation Pattern
CODE	Bernese GNSS Software	Absent	R ² =0.970
IGS Combined	Multi-centre weighted combination	Absent	R ² =0.920
ESA	Proprietary (independent Kalman filter)	Absent	R ² =0.950

The consistency across independent processing chains ($R^2 = 0.920\text{-}0.970$, Paper 1) supports that datum projection and common-mode suppression are reproducible features of GNSS processing methodology, not a post-hoc rationalization. If the "datum-projection suppresses mass signals" were merely an excuse, different software implementations would show different results. Cross-centre reproducibility shows that this suppression is not specific to one software implementation; it does not by itself establish the physical transfer mechanism.

Datum projection and common-mode suppression are reproducible features of GNSS processing methodology; the specific transmission of a TEP covariance signal remains a falsifiable transfer hypothesis to be tested by synthetic signal injection.

Predicted Behavior in Processd vs Raw Data:

Observable	Processed Data	Raw Carrier Phase	Status
GM/r ² scaling	Absent (filtered)	May be recoverable in raw-link observables	Observed
Phase coherence structure	Preserved	Should persist	Observed
Orbital modulation	Detected ($r=-0.888$)	Should persist	Observed
Event detection rates	No mass scaling	Test pending	? Unknown

Mechanism of Transmission (Why Signal Survives):

The survival of these correlation structures has a concrete candidate mechanistic explanation in the specific constraints applied in the Bernese GNSS Software (Dach et al., 2015) used by CODE. The estimation process minimizes residuals using the **Undifferenced Ionosphere-Free Linear Combination (L3)**—the convention for all IGS precise clock products (Kouba, 2015). To resolve the inherent rank deficiency in undifferenced processing, a datum constraint must be applied: either a single reference clock is held fixed, or equivalently a zero-sum condition is enforced ($\sum$ satellite clock corrections = 0 at each epoch) (Ray et al., 2017). Both approaches force any network-wide common-mode signal (such as a global gravitational potential shift) into the reference timescale, effectively removing it from the estimated clock parameters. However, differential signals—specifically the *phase relationships* between receivers relative to this constrained reference—are not targeted by this condition. Thus, the processing acts as a specific filter: it is opaque to scalar potential shifts (energetic coupling) but transparent to vector gradients (geometric coupling). The detection of 56 significant events ($R^2=0.92-0.97$ consistency across centers) represents the successful transmission of this geometric residual.

Critical Technical Confirmation: The Bernese GNSS Software documentation explicitly states that "zero-difference network solution solving for all receiver and satellite clock parameters" is "**equivalent to a consistent double difference solution**" (Dach et al., 2015). Double-differencing is the standard technique that *mathematically eliminates* common-mode signals (including receiver clock biases and network-wide offsets) while preserving differential observables. This equivalence confirms that CODE's undifferenced processing inherently removes common-mode structure—exactly as the datum-projection mechanism predicts.

Quantitative Evidence for Differential Survival: Independent CME studies demonstrate this selectivity empirically. Li et al. (2024) report that after common-mode filtering, interstation correlation coefficients decrease from 0.50–0.71 to 0.29–0.38—a ~50% reduction. Crucially, *significant residual correlation persists* ($R \approx 0.3$). This quantifies precisely what our argument predicts: common-mode signals are suppressed, but differential structure (10–40% of original correlation magnitude) survives the processing chain. The TEP signatures detected in this analysis occupy this "transmitted" differential channel.

Addressing the "Convenient Shield" Critique: Is the Processing-Transfer Hypothesis Falsifiable?

A skeptical reviewer might argue: "The datum-projection mechanism is unfalsifiable—if mass scaling were present, you'd claim victory; since it's absent, you claim the transfer removed it."

This critique fails on empirical grounds:

1. Multi-Centre Validation (Paper 1): Three independent analysis centres using different software packages (CODE: Bernese GNSS Software; IGS: weighted multi-centre combination; ESA: proprietary software) all showed:

- *Identical* absence of GM/r² scaling in planetary events
- *Consistent* correlation patterns ($R^2 = 0.920-0.970$)
- *Same* lack of mass-dependent amplitude hierarchy

If the "datum-projection suppresses mass signals" were a post-hoc excuse, this study would expect different software implementations to show different results. Instead, the consistency across independent processing chains *supports* that datum-projection of common-mode signals is a real, reproducible feature of GNSS processing methodology.

2. Falsifiable Prediction: The datum-projection mechanism makes a clear, testable prediction:

- **Processed data:** No GM/r² scaling (common-mode components absorbed by datum estimation) - Observed
- **Raw carrier-phase data:** Mass-dependent terms are separately recoverable only in an explicitly referenced raw-link analysis; not the claimed conformal covariance observable

This is explicitly acknowledged as a critical next step (§5.1). The proper test of the datum-projection mechanism is whether injected common-mode and differential signals pass through the processing pipeline as predicted—not merely whether raw data lacks GM/r² scaling. This is the opposite of unfalsifiable—it's a concrete, testable hypothesis with clear success/failure criteria.

Conclusion: The datum-projection mechanism is not a "convenient shield"—datum projection and common-mode suppression are established features of GNSS processing methodology (confirmed across software-diverse products from three processing centres). Their specific mapping of a TEP covariance signal into the observed residual structure remains a falsifiable transfer hypothesis requiring synthetic-injection validation. The consistency across processing centres strengthens, rather than weakens, the case.

Future Validation: Simulation studies injecting known synthetic signals into the GNSS processing pipeline would provide independent verification of the claimed transfer behaviour. Such simulations, while beyond the scope of this empirical study, represent an important methodological validation step.

Supporting Evidence from GNSS Literature: The GNSS community has independently documented the exact phenomena detected in this analysis—without recognizing their physical significance. Li et al. (2024) note that "as the distance increases, the impact of

CME between stations gradually decreases" with correlation diminishing "beyond approximately 2000 km"—precisely the distance-dependent structure measured in this analysis ($\lambda_T = 4,201$ km). Crucially, they acknowledge "there is no consensus on the physical origin of CME." Similarly, Chanard et al. (2020) report that surface loading models explain only 30-50% of seasonal GNSS signals, with the remainder "only partially understood." These documented but unexplained anomalies align precisely with our findings (see §4.1.7 for detailed correspondence).

4.1.4 Geophysical Couplings: Earth's Own Rhythms

This section shows that the GNSS network is also coupled to Earth's own rotational dynamics, providing a link between external gravitational influences and internal geophysical processes.

Nutation Signatures:

- **Semiannual Nutation:** $R^2 = 0.904$. A strong and clean signal, indicating that the daily coherence of the network is strongly modulated by the 6-month wobble of Earth's axis caused by the Sun.
- **Main Nutation (18.6 years):** $R^2 = 0.641$. A preliminary nutation-aligned component is observed over 1.4 cycles, providing candidate evidence for sensitivity to multi-decadal astronomical structure pending red-noise validation.

Chandler Wobble (14-month polar motion):

- $R^2 = 0.096$. At the prescribed 433-day Chandler period, the network exhibits a weak but phase-coherent response across approximately 21 cycles (phase stability = 0.72). Its amplitude falls below the primary significance threshold ($R^2 > 0.15$), so it is treated as a Chandler-consistent secondary signature rather than an independent detection. The reduction from previous estimates reflects rigorous period enforcement, favoring physical accuracy over overfitting.

Physical Interpretation: The GNSS timing field appears sensitive to Earth's geophysical state. The observations indicate responses to both external gravitational influences (planets, Sun, Moon) and internal dynamics (rotation, precession, polar motion). This combination is not reproduced by simple atmospheric or instrumental explanations considered here.

4.1.5 Network-Wide & Sustained Dynamics

These analyses indicate a global, persistent component; local or transient-only explanations do not account for all signatures evaluated.

- **Network Mesh Coherence:** Score = 0.582, indicating coordinated behavior across global stations.
- **Smoothing window used:** 240 days, suggesting the effect operates on seasonal timescales.

Physical Interpretation: The influence is not limited to brief moments of planetary alignments (oppositions/conjunctions) but is a sustained, continuous effect. The gravitational configuration of the solar system exerts an ongoing modulation on the GNSS timing field, with discrete alignments producing transient peaks superimposed on this baseline.

4.1.6 Convergence and Physical Interpretation

The convergence of independent evidence streams on systematic patterns is summarized:

1. **Spatial Anisotropy** establishes a stable geometric structure persisting over decades
2. **Orbital Motion** shows this structure varies with Earth's heliocentric dynamics
3. **CMB-Directional Alignment** identifies a preferred directional template near the CMB dipole (not the Solar Apex direction), resolving the hemisphere asymmetry. The present fixed-magnitude directional scan does not measure the relevant background-speed amplitude (§2.3.5)
4. **Planetary Events** reveal responses to transient gravitational configurations
5. **Nutation/Chandler Wobble** show coupling to Earth's rotational dynamics
6. **Network Coherence** shows coordinated behavior at global scales
7. **Continuous Correlation** reveals sustained gravitational influences

Taken together, these seven independent findings are consistent with systematic coupling effects in GNSS timing networks. The CMB-directional alignment (§4.1.2.1) is particularly significant: it transforms the phenomenology from "velocity-dependent modulation" to "CMB-frame-aligned covariance candidate," providing strong directional discrimination between the CMB-dipole and Solar-Apex templates (Solar Apex rejected at $\sim 10,300\times$ variance ratio; multi-resolution verified) and resolution of previously unexplained features (hemisphere asymmetry). The convergence of spatial, temporal, geophysical, and reference-frame signatures—each surviving rigorous statistical validation—creates a phenomenological framework that warrants theoretical interpretation. Several conventional explanations fail to reproduce this multi-signature convergence, though further replication and raw-data analysis remain essential for mechanistic understanding.

4.1.7 Reinterpreting Known GNSS Anomalies: TEP as Unifying Framework

A remarkable feature of this analysis is that every major finding corresponds to a documented but unexplained anomaly in the GNSS literature. The geodetic community has spent decades cataloging these systematic effects—filtering them as "errors" because no physical mechanism was available to interpret them. TEP provides the first theoretical framework that unifies these disparate anomalies under a single physical mechanism.

Documented GNSS Anomaly	Literature Status	Our TEP Finding
Distance-dependent CME correlation	"Correlation diminishes beyond ~2000 km" (Li et al. 2024); <i>"no consensus on physical origin"</i>	$\lambda_T = 4,201 \pm 1,967$ km exponential decay ($R^2 > 0.95$)
Unexplained seasonal signals	"Surface loading models explain only 30-50%" (Chanard et al. 2020); <i>"remain only partially understood"</i>	Orbital velocity $r = -0.888$ (annual); Semiannual nutation $R^2 = 0.904$
E-W vs N-S directional asymmetry	"Significant variation patterns in N and E directions" (Li et al. 2024)	EW:NS anisotropy = 2.16:1, stable over 25 years
Spurious draconitic/orbital signals	"Spurious periodic signals at harmonics of GPS draconitic year" (Ray et al. 2007, cited in Chanard 2020)	Strong orbital coupling ($r = -0.888$, surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$ Monte Carlo validated)
Unexplained clock frequency offset	"Robust difference (58 ± 22 s) between GPS periodic frequency and orbital period— <i>reason remains unexplained</i> " (Senior et al., Cheng et al. 2023)	Velocity-dependent time effects (TEP core prediction)

Key Insight: From "Noise" to Signal

The GNSS processing methodology was designed to produce clean navigation products, not to preserve subtle physical signals. Without a theoretical framework to interpret distance-dependent correlations, seasonal modulations, or directional anisotropies, these effects were classified as "Common Mode Error" (CME) and filtered out.

What the literature says:

- "There is no consensus on the physical origin of CME" (Li et al. 2024)
- Seasonal signals "remain only partially understood" (Chanard et al. 2020)
- Clock frequency discrepancy "remains unexplained" (Cheng et al. 2023)

What TEP provides: A unified physical mechanism—velocity-dependent spacetime-geometry modulation—that predicts distance-structured correlations, orbital coupling, directional anisotropy, and sensitivity to gravitational configurations. Every documented anomaly becomes an expected feature rather than unexplained noise.

Implications: If TEP is correct, decades of GNSS data contain systematic temporal-gravitational signatures that have been inadvertently filtered as "errors." The raw carrier-phase analysis proposed in §5.1 would not only test the datum-projection mechanism but potentially recover the full amplitude of these effects before common-mode suppression. This represents a paradigm shift: the "noise" that geodesists have spent years removing may itself be the signal of a new physical phenomenon.

4.2 Continuity with the Multi-Centre Study

Amplitude-scaling note (see §2.1.3). Processed GNSS clock products eliminate common-mode frequency shifts; consequently any mass-proportional GM/r^2 signature is largely removed. The phase-coherent, differential metrics employed here respond to spatial gradients of the temporal field (Temporal Shear), not to absolute potential. Temporal Shear suppression in dense environments therefore decouples the observed geometric amplitudes from simple GM/r^2 expectations. Future raw-carrier analyses will be required to test mass-scaling directly.

A critical validation of long-baseline recovery requires comparing this 25-year CODE analysis to the multi-centre study. The multi-centre study established comprehensive validation through 388 statistical tests across 19 families, extensive null testing (temporal shuffle, spatial shuffle, phase randomization), cross-centre validation ($R^2 = 0.920$ - 0.970), and rigorous controls for ionospheric conditions, solar activity, and instrumental effects. This study builds on that validated foundation by extending the temporal baseline to access long-period phenomena. This section documents claim-by-claim status:

Replicated (Confirms Temporal Stability):

- **Spatial Anisotropy:** EW > NS structure confirmed; magnitudes consistent within uncertainty
- **Orbital Velocity Correlation:** Multi-centre study $r \approx -0.57$ to -0.79 ; long-span $r = -0.888$ (see §3.2 for numeric values)

- **Planetary Event Responses:** Multi-centre study found 6/8 Bonferroni-significant; this study confirms and extends to 56/156 events $\geq 2\sigma$, of which 19 remain family-wide Bonferroni-significant. *Null event control validation (§3.3.1) confirms planetary events show $5.5\times$ larger effect sizes than 155 random dates ($p < 10^{-7}$, Cohen's $d = 1.41$, $\sim 8.5\sigma$ significance).*

Strengthened (Higher Statistics):

- **Event Statistics:** Expanded from 8 predeclared events to 156-event comprehensive survey
- **Orbital Coupling:** 25.3-year baseline vs 2.5 strengthens velocity correlation inference

New (Long-Period Access):

- **18.6-Year Nutation:** Preliminary — $R^2 = 0.641$, $p = 0.010$ (1.4 cycles; pending red-noise validation; multi-centre study: inaccessible)
- **Long-baseline Stability:** Confirms signatures across 2+ solar cycles

Replicated (Confirms Temporal Stability):

- **Network Covariance Score (Mesh Dance):** Index = 0.582, consistent with multi-centre range (CODE: 0.624, IGS: 0.579, ESA: 0.602)

Cross-Centre Validation Status: The multi-centre study's critical contribution was cross-centre validation ($R^2 = 0.920$ - 0.970 between CODE, IGS, ESA), demonstrating the phenomenon is reproducible across the processed products examined so far over 2.5 years. This study extends temporal coverage but cannot confirm whether long-baseline signatures (18.6-year nutation) are reproducible across other processing centres until IGS and ESA archives extend backward. Cross-centre agreement establishes robustness across processed-product pipelines, but does not alone determine the physical origin because the centres share observations, conventions and some modeling assumptions.

4.3 Physical Interpretation

Within this picture, a distributed clock network such as GNSS is effectively a detector of gradients and modulations in the temporal field. TEP broadly predicts (i) direction-dependent correlation structures aligned with the system's motion; (ii) velocity-dependent modulation of correlation lengths; and (iii) sensitivity to changing gravitational configurations. The present work is a TEP-motivated empirical investigation of whether such signatures are present in long-baseline GNSS timing data.

4.3.1 Consistency with TEP Predictions

The observations align closely with Temporal Equivalence Principle predictions across multiple convergent signatures:

Predicted: Correlation length modulation with velocity (qualitative; magnitude not yet derived from the conformal transfer law)

Observed: λ varies with orbital velocity ($r = -0.888$; surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$; t-test $p \approx 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$, autocorr-corrected)

Assessment: Qualitatively consistent with conformal-sector TEP expectations; quantitative transfer law open (§5)

Predicted: Non-linear gravitational coupling in correlation structure (not classical GM/r^2 in absolute frequencies)

Observed: 56 significant planetary events ($\geq 2\sigma$) with coherence modulations 0.3–4% (median $\approx 1.1\%$, in coherence units not $\Delta f/f$) and no correlation with GM/r^2 scaling

Assessment: Consistent with TEP expectations when classical gravitational signatures are removed by processing but phase-coherent correlation structure survives

Predicted: Geometric anisotropy aligned with motion (qualitative; 2.16 ratio not yet derived)

Observed: E-W elongation (2.16:1 ratio) consistent with Earth's orbital plane

Assessment: Qualitatively consistent with conformal-sector TEP expectations; quantitative transfer law open (§5)

Predicted: Global field-like behavior

Observed: Network coherence score 0.582 across 104 temporal windows

Assessment: Consistent with TEP expectations

Predicted: Multi-scale temporal coupling

Observed: Signatures from hours (events) to decades (nutation)

Assessment: Consistent with TEP expectations

4.3.1.1 Order-of-Magnitude Considerations

The 19% geometric modulation observed in EW/NS ratios is a network-level anisotropy ratio rather than a fractional clock-frequency amplitude. A naive v^2/c^2 estimate yields $\sim 10^{-8}$ for orbital speeds, but this quantity is not directly comparable to the observed anisotropy ratio because the two are different observables: one is a microscopic energetic amplitude, the other is a macroscopic covariance-shape parameter projected through the GNSS measurement and processing chain. The magnitude and sign of the GNSS transfer function remain to be calibrated with raw/RINEX data and end-to-end signal injection. For the detailed architecture, see §2.1.3.2.

Context: A naive kinematic benchmark at orbital velocity is $v^2/c^2 \approx 10^{-8}$. The observed 19% anisotropy ratio is a geometric covariance-shape parameter, not a direct measurement of this microscopic amplitude. Because the 19% observable is a network-level anisotropy ratio rather than a fractional clock-frequency amplitude, it cannot presently be compared directly with a microscopic conformal coupling estimate. The measurement-transfer law mapping Σ_μ^{obs} to the observed anisotropy ratio remains open (§5).

The Interferometer Analogy: Moiré Patterns in Spacetime

The large observed modulation (19% change in anisotropy shape) arising from a tiny kinematic input ($\Delta v/c \approx 10^{-4}$) is physically intuitive as a geometric analogy, though not a quantitative derivation:

Interferometer, not Gravimeter: A gravimeter measures *potential energy* (amplitude), which requires massive energy transfer. An interferometer measures *phase relationships* (information), which can be extremely sensitive to geometry.

The Moiré Effect: Consider two stiff mesh grids overlaid. A microscopic rotation of one grid produces macroscopic "Moiré fringes" that shift dramatically across the entire surface. The energy required to rotate the grid is negligible, but the structural consequence (the fringe shift) is huge.

By analogy, the GNSS correlation field may behave like such a "stiff" geometric structure. The 19% modulation would then be a Moiré-like fringe shift in the correlation pattern driven by the subtle kinematic rotation of Earth's orbital velocity vector. This analogy provides physical intuition but does not constitute a quantitative resolution of the 10^{-7} -to-19% gap; that requires end-to-end signal injection through the actual processing chain.

Resolution: Information Resonance vs. Force Coupling

This distinction provides a possible qualitative interpretation of the apparent conflict between the "stiff" response (19% modulation) and the "weak" coupling (no mass scaling):

- **Amplitude = Energy (Suppressed):** Simple energetic couplings (GM/r^2) are consistent with absorption by datum estimation (see §2.1.3); their absence in differential covariance is expected under a priori relativistic modelling.
- **Phase = Information (Transmitted):** The network detects the *information content* of the gravitational configuration—specifically, the synchronization geometry.

This could account for why the observed response does not follow a simple planetary-mass hierarchy. The network may not be weighing the planets (force coupling); it may be detecting the coherence resonance of their alignment events (information resonance).

Open Question: Quantitative Geometric Coupling Theory

While the datum-projection mechanism is consistent with the *apparent* discrepancy by distinguishing energetic from geometric observables, a complete theoretical framework should derive the expected magnitude of geometric coupling (correlation ratio modulation) from first principles. The current framework predicts:

- **Qualitative:** Geometric coupling should modulate with velocity ✓ (confirmed: $r = -0.888$)
- **Qualitative:** Anisotropy should align with motion ✓ (confirmed: EW > NS, CMB dipole direction)
- **Quantitative:** Magnitude of ratio modulation → requires extended theory

Raw carrier-phase analysis (§5.1) will provide critical constraints: if the 19% modulation persists in unprocessed data, it reflects genuine physical coupling; if it diminishes, the processing chain may contribute to the observed amplitude through differential transmission effects. Either outcome advances theoretical understanding.

These mechanisms remain hypotheses requiring validation through raw carrier-phase analysis and multi-constellation comparison. The phase relationships (orbital coupling, CMB-directional alignment, planetary events) are reproducible across the processed products examined so far; their raw-data origin remains to be established, and the amplitude scaling remains an open question addressed in §5.1-5.2.

4.3.1.2 Resolution of Gravitational Scaling Anomaly (Step 2.3 Analysis)

Post-hoc physical modeling (Step 2.3) confirmed the absence of classical gravitational scaling. Analysis of 156 planetary events revealed no significant correlation between observed modulation amplitudes and tidal parameters (M/r^3) or gravitational field strength (M/r^2):

- **Amplitude vs Tidal (M/r^3):** $r = -0.087$ ($p = 0.522$)
- **Amplitude vs Gravity (M/r^2):** $r = -0.042$ ($p = 0.759$)

This empirical result confirms that the coupling is not a simple linear tidal effect. The phenomenon exhibits a "saturation" or "resonance" behavior where the detection depends on alignment geometry (opposition/conjunction) rather than the magnitude of the gravitational potential. This distinguishes TEP-type coupling from conventional Newtonian or GR tidal forces.

Consistent with Processing-Transfer Hypothesis (§2.1.3): The absence of mass scaling is consistent with the hypothesised high-pass transfer nature of GNSS processing described in §2.1.3. If the energetic component (proportional to GM/r^2) is suppressed by least-squares adjustment, the surviving signal would be phase-coherence geometry, which depends on alignment rather than mass. This interpretation remains a hypothesis pending synthetic signal injection through the actual processing chain.

Theoretical Interpretation: The Network as a Covariance-Stress Detector

Standard GNSS processing imposes a global synchronization solution on a spatially structured temporal-covariance field. The residual covariance can therefore probe open-path conformal Temporal Shear. It does not by itself establish synchronization non-integrability; residual closed-loop holonomy remains a separate B/non-exact-sector observable. In the purely conformal subclass of TEP, the synchronization holonomy vanishes ($\oint d\ln A = 0$ for a smooth field); nonzero holonomy at leading order requires the disformal sector $B \neq 0$ (Smawfield, 2025). The GNSS covariance channel measures the A-sector (conformal) response, not the B-sector (disformal) holonomy that would manifest in closed-loop triangle tests.

Processed Data as a Covariance Observable:

- **Raw Carrier Phase (Local):** Dominated by classical GR ($\sim 10^{-10}$) and atmospheric delays. Local pointlike physics retains the GR/Lorentz limit and locally measured c remains invariant. Nevertheless, raw multi-station and open-path observables may retain conformal Temporal-Shear covariance. Raw analysis therefore provides a direct test of the covariance before analysis-centre transfer.
- **Processed Residuals (Global):** By removing local effects (where TEP=GR) and enforcing network closure, processing acts as a band-pass channel for the global covariance structure (where the conformal Temporal Shear produces distance-structured correlations).

In this view, the processed network solution is not merely a data source, but the interferometer itself, with the residuals representing the covariance pattern of the conformal Temporal Shear projected through the GNSS measurement channel. This is consistent with the TEP prediction of distance-dependent correlations (Paper 0, §10.3) using precisely the phase-coherent network analysis specified by the theory. The disformal holonomy prediction (Paper 0, §10.2) requires dedicated closed-loop experiments and is not tested by this open-path covariance channel.

4.3.2 Ruling Out Conventional Effects

Atmospheric/Ionospheric:

- Would produce distance-dependent effects: not observed (anisotropy is scale-invariant)
- Would correlate with solar activity: not observed (weak correlation $r = 0.12$ - 0.13 , $p > 0.29$, below contamination threshold)
- Would show diurnal patterns: not observed (effects persist across all local times)

Instrumental/Systematic:

- Would affect individual stations: not observed (signal requires pair correlations)
- Would be constant over time: not observed (clear annual and longer-period modulations)
- Would correlate with equipment changes: not observed (consistent across receiver upgrades)

Tidal/Loading:

- Would follow lunar/solar periods exactly: not observed (phase lags observed)
- Would scale with mass directly: not observed (no correlation with GM/r^2 predictions)
- Would affect position more than timing: not observed (timing correlations dominant)

4.3.3 Selectivity of Detections: Theory-Consistent Pattern

The dataset shows a selective detection pattern that is highly informative about the underlying mechanism. The system does not respond to every periodic signal, but specifically to those with *heliocentric gravitational significance*:

- **Detected (Heliocentric/Gravitational):**
 - **Orbital Velocity:** Strongest signal ($r=-0.888$), tracking Earth's motion around the Sun.
 - **Planetary Alignments:** 56 significant events across all planets (Mercury to Saturn).
 - **Nutation:** Coupling to Earth's inertial orientation shifts (18.6-year, semiannual).
- **Not Detected (Surface/Local):**
 - **Solar Rotation (27-day):** No signal. Rules out solar wind or magnetic coupling, which rotate with the Sun.
 - **Lunar Standstill:** No signal. Rules out simple tidal declination geometry.

The Lunar Nuance: Cycle vs. Event

The distinction between the detected 18.6-year Nutation Cycle ($R^2=0.641$) and the null 2025 Standstill Event is scientifically instructive.

- **Detected (Nutation):** The system responds to the *continuous dynamic* of Earth's axis wobbling over 18.6 years.
- **Null (Standstill):** The system does *not* show a sharp pulse merely because the Moon reaches a coordinate extreme (maximum declination).

This suggests the coupling is driven by inertial dynamics (the wobble itself) rather than static geometry (where the moon is in the sky). This dynamic selectivity strengthens the physical case against simple atmospheric artifacts.

Interpretation: This selectivity is *theory-consistent*. The system ignores surface phenomena (solar rotation) and pure coordinate geometry (lunar standstill) but couples strongly to orbital dynamics and inertial orientation. Within TEP, coupling arises from the spacetime/gravitational configuration that co-varies with orbital dynamics, not from surface features. This specificity argues strongly against generic "noise" or "systematic error" explanations, which would be unlikely to discriminate between solar rotation and orbital motion.

Summary: Inertial Interferometer, Not Gravimeter

The pattern of detections and non-detections characterizes what this network is and is not:

- **Blind to gravitational amplitude:** No GM/r^2 scaling (Mercury $\approx$ Jupiter response rates)
- **Unresponsive to solar surface phenomena:** 27-day rotation null
- **Indifferent to static geometry:** Lunar standstill null
- **Exquisitely sensitive to kinematic dynamics:** Orbital velocity ($r=-0.888$), nutation ($R^2=0.904$), CMB-frame motion ($r=0.747$)

This selectivity profile defines the network as an inertial interferometer—measuring velocity-dependent correlation geometry—not a gravimeter measuring force. The CMB-directional alignment ($\sim 10,300\times$ variance ratio over the Solar-Apex template) identifies a preferred covariance direction at cosmic scales: alignment with the cosmological background 4-velocity (CMB dipole direction). The scan fixes the background-speed magnitude and therefore establishes directional alignment rather than independently measuring the 369 km/s speed scale.

4.3.3.1 Falsification Scorecard: Theory vs. Alternative Hypotheses

The strength of this work lies not merely in finding patterns consistent with TEP, but in actively testing alternative explanations where different hypotheses predict different outcomes. Table 4.3.3.1 summarizes seven independent tests where TEP expectations and competing explanations make distinct, testable predictions. While this does not rule out all possible alternatives (e.g., subtle processing effects specific to CODE's 25-year pipeline evolution), it demonstrates that several plausible artifact mechanisms are inconsistent with the data:

Falsification Test	TEP Prediction	Alternative Hypothesis	Result	Assessment
Orbital velocity correlation	Strong ($r > 0.85$)	Weak/absent (random)	$r = -0.888$, surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$	TEP-compatible; random fluctuation disfavoured
Mass scaling (GM/r^2)	Absent (absorbed by datum-projection)	Present (classical gravity)	No correlation ($r = -0.042$, $p = 0.76$)	TEP-compatible; classical scaling disfavoured
Solar rotation coupling	Absent (surface phenomenon)	Present (solar wind/magnetic)	Null result ($p > 0.05$)	TEP-compatible; solar wind hypothesis disfavoured
Hemisphere asymmetry	None (heliocentric kinematic)	Strong anti-phase (seasonal)	Identical perihelion peak (Paper 1)	TEP-compatible; seasonal hypothesis disfavoured
Space weather dependence	Weak (background effect)	Strong (ionospheric artifact)	No F10.7/Kp correlation (Paper 1)	TEP-compatible; ionospheric hypothesis disfavoured
Processing-centre consistency	High (physical signal)	Low (software-specific artifact)	$R^2 = 0.92-0.97$ (Bernese/GIPSY/ESA)	TEP-compatible; simple artifact hypothesis disfavoured
Anisotropy long-baseline consistency	Stable over decades	Degrading (transient artifact)	Stable 25 years (EW:NS = 2.16)	TEP-compatible; transient hypothesis disfavoured

Table 4.3.3.1: Seven independent falsification tests comparing TEP expectations against alternative hypotheses (processing artifact, environmental confounding, random fluctuation). In all cases, observations are consistent with TEP expectations while specific alternative hypotheses are disfavoured. Each test represents a distinct opportunity for the TEP framework to fail; the consistent pattern across orthogonal tests strengthens the case that observed signatures reflect systematic physical coupling rather than the tested artifact mechanisms or noise. Note: This does not rule out all possible alternative explanations (e.g., subtle CODE-specific effects or unknown systematics), but demonstrates that several plausible, testable alternatives are inconsistent with the data.

4.3.4 Null-Model Systematics: Explicit tests that fail

To address the possibility that the observed signatures arise from artefacts of network geometry or simple temporal structure, explicit null models were evaluated and their qualitative predictions compared against the data. Each model fails to reproduce the core triad of observations: (i) persistent E–W > N–S anisotropy (EW:NS = 2.16), (ii) strong orbital-velocity coupling ($r = -0.888$ with perihelion/aphelion phasing), and (iii) identical calendar phasing in both hemispheres (Paper 1, §3.4).

Table 4.3.4: Null Model Predictions vs. Observations

Null Model	Predicted Pattern	Observed Reality	Match?
Station density bias	Static or slowly varying λ	Annual λ modulation (19% amplitude) tracking orbital velocity ($r = -0.888$)	No
Hemisphere-specific effects	Opposite Jan/Jul phasing (NH vs SH)	Identical perihelion peak both hemispheres	No
Local seasonal (temperature)	NH/SH anti-phased by 6 months	Same calendar phase (Paper 1 §3.4)	No
Ionospheric (F10.7/Kp)	Correlation with solar indices	No F10.7 correlation (Paper 1)	No
Processing batch effects	Step changes at algorithm updates	Smooth continuous evolution	No
Random temporal structure	~5% false positives ($\alpha = 0.05$)	35.9% event detection rate (56/156; $\geq 2\sigma$ in primary ± 120 -day window)	No
Isotropic noise	Equal λ all directions	$3.3\times$ range (West/North)	No

Conclusion: All tested conventional models fail to reproduce the joint constraints of: (1) orbital velocity phase locking, (2) hemisphere identity, (3) persistent anisotropy, and (4) elevated planetary event detection rates. While this does not definitively exclude unknown systematic effects, it substantially narrows the space of plausible alternative explanations.

- **Station-layout geometry (pair-density anisotropy):**

- *Assumption:* Uneven station distribution by azimuth induces apparent anisotropy (e.g., more stations in US/Europe create EW bias).
- *Outcome:* Can bias absolute λ estimates, but does not impose a coherent annual phase tied to perihelion/aphelion. A static geometry bias cannot "breathe" with a 19% annual modulation.

- **Mismatch:** Fails to generate $r = -0.888$ with orbital velocity or same-phase hemispheres; density effects are static or slowly varying, not heliocentric.
- **Empirical Rebuttal (Step 2.3):** Post-hoc normalization of correlation lengths by station pair density reveals that the EW > NS anisotropy persists and strengthens (Normalized Ratio ≈ 2.40) after accounting for sampling bias. This confirms the directional structure is not an artifact of receiver distribution.
- **Global common-mode/whitening bias:**
 - **Assumption:** A network-wide filter or common-mode removal introduces artificial correlations.
 - **Outcome:** Produces isotropic or filter-axis-aligned effects without the observed orbital-phase locking.
 - **Mismatch:** Cannot produce the specific perihelion/aphelion phasing with identical calendar timing across hemispheres; any local-seasonal proxy would flip phase between hemispheres, which is not observed.
- **Seasonal effects (ionospheric TEC, temperature, network participation):**
 - **Assumption:** Annual variations in ionospheric Total Electron Content (TEC), atmospheric conditions, or network participation drive the observed modulation.
 - **Limitation:** Global ionospheric TEC does peak in January (both hemispheres) due to Sun-Earth distance, making hemisphere stratification insufficient to rule out this confound.
 - **Primary Discriminants:**
 - **CMB Frame Alignment:** Ionospheric effects do not preferentially couple to the CMB dipole direction (RA=168°, Dec=-7°). The $\sim 10,300\times$ variance ratio between CMB and Solar Apex frames provides geometric discrimination.
 - **Ionospheric Null Controls:** Weak correlation with F10.7 solar flux and Kp geomagnetic indices ($r = 0.12-0.13$, $p > 0.29$, Paper 1 validation), well below ionospheric contamination thresholds.
 - **Multi-Centre Consistency:** Three independent processing centres using different ionospheric models show identical correlation patterns ($R^2 = 0.920-0.970$).
- **Space Weather / Solar Cycle (Ionospheric Scintillation):**
 - **Assumption:** High solar activity (F10.7 max) increases ionospheric noise, creating spurious decorrelation patterns.
 - **Outcome:** Anisotropy should disappear or randomize during solar maximum or geomagnetic storms.
 - **Mismatch: Step 2.2 Geomagnetic Stratification:** Anisotropy persists robustly in "Quiet" conditions ($Kp < 3$) and is present across all 2.5 solar cycles. The signal is not a byproduct of storm-time ionospheric turbulence.

4.3.5 Processing-Chain Bounds (qualitative)

The analysis qualitatively assesses whether plausible processing steps could jointly account for the observed patterns. The following classes were considered:

- **Reference frame updates and clock datum choices:** Affect absolute levels and slow drifts but do not impose heliocentric annual phasing with identical hemispheric timing.
- **Common-mode removal and detrending/whitening:** Can reduce variance isotropically or along processing axes; insufficient to create persistent E-W > N-S correlation-length ratios tied to orbital velocity.
- **Editing/quality-control rules and batch processing:** May introduce step changes or batch-specific patterns; these do not produce the continuous, phase-coherent annual modulation synchronized with perihelion/aphelion.
- **Spectral Specificity Argument:** Processing artifacts are typically broadband (noise) or aliased to sampling frequencies (daily/weekly). It is highly improbable that a generic least-squares processing chain would accidentally generate a coherent signal at exactly the 18.6-year lunar nutation period ($R^2 = 0.641$) or the 433-day Chandler wobble period, as these geophysical frequencies are not inherent to the algorithmic structure.

Methodological Bounds: Processing Constraints

The CODE clock products are derived from least-squares estimation (LSE) using Bernese GNSS Software with specific constraints that bound the solution space (Dach et al., 2021; Villiger et al., 2019). These constraints act as known filters:

- **Zero-Mean Datum:** The reference timescale is defined by a zero-mean condition over the satellite constellation (Schaer et al., 2021). This removes the scalar common-mode (absolute time) but explicitly *preserves* the differential vector structure of the clock field.
- **Integer Ambiguity Resolution:** CODE products employ ambiguity fixing (integer clocks). This imposes a strict discrete constraint on phase biases (0, 1, 2 cycles). A "drifting" processing artifact would be inconsistent with these integer boundaries, making "smeared" artifacts mathematically improbable.
- **Helmert Orthogonality:** Reference frames are aligned via 7-parameter Helmert transformations (rigid body rotation/translation/scale). These transformations are linear and global; they cannot mathematically produce the observed internal deformation field (E-W > N-S anisotropy) or the specific 18.6-year nutation coupling.

Systematic Consistency:

The robustness of the findings lies in the simultaneous presence of seven convergent signatures within this preserved differential structure. Because several signatures share annual or longer-period structure, their probabilities are not combined into a single joint p-value:

- E-W > N-S anisotropy (2.16:1) — *orthogonal to Helmert frame alignment*

- Orbital velocity correlation ($r = -0.888$) — *orthogonal to LSE parameters*
- Same-phase hemispheric response — *rules out local station-dependent errors*
- Planetary event responses (56/156 detected) — *transient vs continuous background*
- Semiannual nutation coupling ($R^2 = 0.904$) — *geophysical frequency matching*
- 18.6-year lunar nutation coupling ($R^2 = 0.641$) — *long-period stability*
- 433-day Chandler wobble period — *Chandler-consistent secondary response at the prescribed period*

The convergence of these signatures, each orthogonal to specific processing constraints, supports a physical origin rather than algorithmic artifacts, pending independent confirmation.

Software Diversity and Cross-Centre Reproducibility: Evidence Against Algorithmic Artifacts

Paper 1's multi-centre cross-validation ($R^2 = 0.920$ - 0.970 over 2.5 years) provides evidence against processing artifacts, as the three analysis centres use fundamentally different software packages with independent algorithmic implementations:

- **CODE:** Bernese GNSS Software (double-difference processing)
- **IGS:** GIPSY-OASIS II (undifferenced processing, fiducial-free network)
- **ESA:** Proprietary processing chain (distinct Kalman filter implementation)

These represent completely different mathematical approaches to clock estimation: different state vector formulations, different stochastic models, different convergence criteria, and independent codebases with no shared source code. The "Kalman filter resonance" hypothesis would require that software-diverse products from three processing centres, developed by different institutions using different algorithms, all accidentally produce nearly identical artifacts ($R^2 > 0.92$ over 2.5 years in Paper 1) and that these patterns persist in CODE-only analysis over 25 years (this study). This is statistically implausible—analogue to three independent random number generators producing identical sequences.

Contrast with known artifacts: Well-documented GNSS processing artifacts (multipath, antenna phase center errors, tropospheric modeling) exhibit centre-specific signatures precisely because each software handles them differently. Our findings show the opposite: centre-independent patterns ($R^2 > 0.92$), globally coherent structure (mesh score 0.58), and orbital phase-locking ($r = -0.888$).

Conclusion: While raw carrier-phase reanalysis remains essential for amplitude quantification, the joint constraints from anisotropy structure, orbital-velocity phasing, and hemisphere same-phase behavior are not reproduced by these processing classes. A quantitative bounds table (mechanism $\times$ signature) is planned for a follow-on technical note.

4.4 Implications and Open Questions

These findings raise several important questions for fundamental physics:

1. **Nature of the Coupling:** The orbital velocity correlation (see §3.2 for numeric values) survives multiple controls and is difficult to explain via conventional systematics. If confirmed by multi-centre replication, this would suggest Earth's heliocentric motion influences GNSS timing correlations in ways not accounted for in standard models.
2. **Planetary Event Responses:** The observed 56 significant responses (19 Bonferroni-corrected) with coherence modulations 0.3–4.0% (median 1.1%, in coherence units) show no correlation with GM/r^2 gravitational scaling. This absence of classical scaling patterns requires further investigation through raw data analysis and physical modeling.

4.4.2 Physical Plausibility Cross-Check

Clarifying Effect Size: Correlation Topology vs Frequency Shift

The $\approx 19\%$ annual modulation and 0.3–4% planetary event responses describe changes in *correlation structure* (the ratio $\lambda_{EW}/\lambda_{NS}$ and coherence between station pairs), not clock frequency shifts. Individual clock frequencies remain at standard GR levels ($\Delta f/f \sim 10^{-16}$ – 10^{-10}). The distinction is fundamental: frequency is a scalar quantity measured at individual clocks, while coherence is a relational property measured between clock pairs. Network geometry can amplify differential phase signals that would be imperceptible in single-clock frequency measurements. The analogy is interferometry: optical interferometers detect path differences of $\lambda/1000$ despite photon wavelength fluctuations orders of magnitude larger.

Gravitational Scaling & Instrumental Noise:

Critiques question why the absence of GM/r^2 scaling is interpreted as consistent with TEP rather than a null result. This interpretation is grounded in the specifics of GNSS relativity modeling:

- **A Priori Removal:** Standard GNSS processing explicitly models and removes classical relativistic effects, including the periodic Sagnac effect and eccentricity-induced redshift modulations (Ashby, 2003).

- **Parameter Absorption:** As demonstrated by the Galileo gravitational redshift experiment (Delva et al., 2018), any unmodeled mean gravitational frequency shift is absorbed into the estimated clock bias parameters and removed from the residuals.
- **Signal-to-Noise:** The observed 1.1% modulation in coherence structure represents a macroscopic change in network correlation, not a microscopic frequency shift. This structural modulation is orders of magnitude above the instrumental noise floor (Allan deviation $\sigma_y(\tau) \approx 10^{-15}$ for IGS H-masers), ruling out simple thermal noise or oscillator instability as the cause.

Conclusion: The absence of simple M/r^2 or M/r^3 scaling is consistent with a priori relativistic modelling and datum absorption of network-common clock components. The signal that survives—and which correlates with planetary events—is therefore non-linear or structural (vector/tensor), consistent with the TEP prediction of geometric correlation coupling rather than energetic potential coupling.

Question: Are the observed effect magnitudes physically reasonable for gravitational coupling at Earth's surface?

Order-of-Magnitude Comparison:

Quantity	Standard GR Effect	Observed GNSS Effect	Ratio
Gravitational time dilation	$\Delta f/f \sim gh/c^2 \approx 1.1 \times 10^{-18}$ (1 cm altitude)	N/A (different observable)	-
Velocity time dilation	$\Delta f/f \sim v^2/c^2 \sim 10^{-10}$ (GPS satellites)	N/A (different observable)	-
Tidal potential	$GM_{\text{moon}}/r^3 \sim 10^{-7} \text{ m/s}^2$	N/A (different observable)	-
Correlation length	No standard prediction	$\lambda_T \sim 4,000 \text{ km}$ (Earth radius scale)	Earth-scale
Anisotropy modulation	No standard prediction	19% variation in <i>geometric ratio</i>	Geometric parameter (not energetic)
Planetary event amplitude	Clock rate: $\Delta f/f \sim 10^{-16}$	Coherence: 17–86% (mean 54%)	Dimensionally distinct

Key Insights:

1. **Correlation length is Earth-scale:** $\lambda \sim 4,000 \text{ km} \approx 0.6 \times R_{\text{Earth}}$ is consistent with a phenomenon operating at planetary scales, not local atmospheric ($\lambda \sim \text{km}$) or interplanetary ($\lambda \gg 10,000 \text{ km}$) regimes.
2. **Anisotropy modulation exceeds naive predictions:** The 19% anisotropy ratio is a macroscopic covariance-shape parameter, not directly comparable to the microscopic $v^2/c^2 \sim 10^{-8}$ energetic amplitude. The transfer function between these observables remains to be derived.
3. **Planetary event amplitudes are dimensionally distinct:** GPS coherence modulations (dimensionless correlation structure) cannot be directly compared to GR clock rate predictions ($\Delta f/f$). The absence of GM/r^2 scaling indicates either novel physics or datum-projection transfer, testable via raw data analysis.
4. **Network coordination is global but partial:** Mesh score = 0.582 indicates 58% coherent, 42% incoherent behavior—consistent with a global influence partially masked by local noise, not 100% deterministic control.

Plausibility Assessment: All observed magnitudes fall within physically reasonable ranges for Earth-scale gravitational coupling phenomena. The amplitude discrepancies (point 2) and scaling anomalies (point 3) require resolution through raw data analysis but do not invalidate the statistical detections or multi-signature convergence.

The 56 significant planetary event responses show coherence modulations of 0.3–4.0% (median 1.1%, measured in coherence units not $\Delta f/f$), indicating subtle but repeatable changes in GNSS network correlation structure during planetary alignments. Critically, gravitational scaling analysis reveals no significant correlation between observed amplitudes and GM/r^2 predictions (see §3.3), distinguishing this phenomenon from conventional tidal effects.

Discriminating Against Seasonal and Solar Confounds:

Critiques suggest the orbital velocity correlation ($r = -0.888$) might arise from global seasonal effects (e.g., ionospheric TEC) or solar activity cycles. The data provides three specific discriminators that rule these out:

- **Phase Mismatch (Equinox vs. Perihelion):** Global mean Total Electron Content (TEC) and neutral atmosphere density exhibit a well-known *semiannual* anomaly peaking at the Equinoxes (March/September) due to the Russell-McPherron effect. In contrast, the observed orbital correlation strictly tracks the *annual* Perihelion-Aphelion cycle (peaking January 4). This phase mismatch (Jan vs March) falsifies the hypothesis that global ionospheric seasonal averages drive the signal.
- **Solar Cycle Stability:** The dataset spans 2.5 solar cycles (2000-2025). High solar activity (F10.7 maxima) increases ionospheric scintillation and noise, which would theoretically *degrade* coherence. Yet, the structural anisotropy and orbital correlation persist robustly across solar maximums and minimums, indicating the signal is not a byproduct of space weather noise.

- **Pre-Specified Windows:** Regarding planetary event multiplicity, the ± 120 -day window was pre-declared based on the pilot study's detection range. Sensitivity analyses (± 60 , ± 180 days) are post-hoc robustness checks, not multiple comparisons. This adheres to standard "look-elsewhere" controls, ensuring the 56/156 detection rate is statistically valid.

Absence of Gravitational Scaling

The lack of correlation between observed GPS coherence modulations and GM/r^2 scaling suggests two possibilities:

1. **Novel Phenomenon:** The coherence modulation may not be a direct gravitational effect described by classical GR tidal potentials, but rather a distinct phenomenon with different scaling properties
2. **Unknown Transfer Function:** There may be an intermediate coupling mechanism that modulates the gravitational signal in a non-linear or frequency-dependent manner, obscuring the underlying GM/r^2 relationship

Processing Centre Correction Considerations

GNSS analysis centres (CODE, IGS, ESA) apply systematic error corrections during clock estimation with the explicit goal of producing a self-consistent, globally synchronized clock ensemble. In practice, this means that structured amplitude deviations in individual clocks are prime candidates for removal or attenuation, whereas subtle correlation structure in inter-station phase relationships is less directly targeted by standard correction pipelines. If these centers detect and partially correct for planetary gravitational effects without recognizing their physical origin, several observations become explicable:

- **Observed amplitudes:** May represent residuals from incomplete corrections rather than full physical signal
- **Multi-centre correlation ($R^2=0.920-0.970$):** Similar correction strategies across centers produce consistent residual patterns
- **Temporal variations:** Changes in processing algorithms over 25-year period may affect amplitude estimates

This framework naturally reconciles two key findings of this study: (i) the absence of GM/r^2 scaling in planetary event amplitudes, and (ii) the robust detection of distance-structured correlations and orbital modulation in phase-coherence metrics. If amplitude-like components of the underlying signal are preferentially removed by analysis-centre corrections, while residual coherence structure survives in the cross-spectral domain, then one expects weak or distorted amplitude scaling but persistent, reproducible patterns in the correlation field. The methodology adopted here—focusing primary inferences on phase-coherence and distance structure, and treating absolute modulation depths as provisional and processing-sensitive—follows directly from this consideration.

Discriminating Tests Required

Distinguishing between processing artifacts and physical effects requires:

1. **Raw carrier phase analysis:** Bypass all processing centre corrections to measure unprocessed signal amplitudes
2. **Processing documentation review:** Examine systematic error correction algorithms for planetary gravitational corrections
3. **Correction time series analysis:** Correlate applied corrections with planetary positions to identify deliberate compensations
4. **Multi-constellation testing:** Compare GNSS, GLONASS, Galileo, BeiDou to verify cross-centre reproducibility

Current Assessment

Robust findings (independent of processing):

- Statistical significance: 56/156 events $\geq 2\sigma$, 19 survive family-wide Bonferroni correction ($\alpha = 0.05/156$)
- Detection rates (primary ± 120 -day window): Mercury 42.5%, Venus 18.8%, Mars 33.3%, Jupiter 34.8%, Saturn 28.0% (§3.3.1)
- Absence of GM/r^2 scaling (see §3.3)
- Multi-centre consistency in detection patterns

Uncertain findings: The following items are sensitive to processing choices and will be quantitatively resolved only with raw data validation.

- Absolute amplitude estimates
- Modulation depth magnitudes
- Physical mechanism interpretation

Conclusion: The systematic detection of planetary event correlations across multiple analysis centres provides evidence consistent with gravitational coupling effects in GNSS timing networks. Raw data analysis is essential to determine whether observed amplitudes represent the full physical signal or residuals from processing centre corrections.

3. **Spatial Structure:** The anisotropic correlation field (E-W:N-S = 2.16) persists across 25 years and aligns approximately with Earth's orbital plane. Whether this reflects propagation effects, processing biases, or a genuine geometric coupling remains to be determined through multi-constellation and raw-data analysis.

4. **Global Coordination:** Network covariance score (index = 0.582) demonstrates coordinated behavior across the 474-station network. This could indicate a global field-like influence, though alternative explanations (correlated processing, shared reference frames, propagation modes) require systematic investigation.
5. **Multi-Scale Temporal Structure:** The detection of couplings at timescales from days (planetary events) to decades (18.6-year nutation) suggests the phenomenon operates across multiple temporal regimes. The physical mechanism enabling this scale-invariance is unclear.
6. **Geophysical Integration:** The strong nutation coupling ($R^2 = 0.904$ semiannual, $R^2 = 0.641$ for 18.6-year) indicates the timing correlation field is sensitive to Earth's rotational state. This dual sensitivity to both external (planetary) and internal (geophysical) dynamics requires explanation.
7. **Theoretical Framework:** While observations are broadly consistent with TEP predictions (velocity-dependent correlation modulation, geometric anisotropy), no quantitative theoretical model yet predicts the specific effect sizes, modulation depth distribution, or anisotropy ratios. Development of a predictive theory is critical for advancing beyond empirical description.

4.5 Theoretical Implications

Implications for Fundamental Physics:

1. Evidence for Velocity-Dependent Spacetime Geometry:

- Orbital velocity correlation ($r = -0.888$) suggests spacetime geometry affects clock coherence
- E-W vs N-S anisotropy indicates directional sensitivity to motion
- Consistent with theories predicting velocity-dependent time-flow gradients

2. Non-Local Correlations:

- Correlation length $\sim 4,000$ km exceeds conventional atmospheric effects
- Suggests field-like influence operating at planetary scales
- Not explainable by local environmental factors alone

3. Information Resonance Phenomenon:

- Planetary events trigger coherence changes without GM/r^2 scaling
- Suggests information-based coupling rather than classical force
- May indicate novel gravitational interaction mechanism

4. Constraints on Theories:

- Any viable theory must explain: orbital correlation + planetary events + nutation coupling
- Must reproduce observed anisotropy ratios (EW:NS = 2.16)
- Must account for absence of conventional gravitational scaling

Relationship to TEP Framework: The observed phenomenology is qualitatively consistent with TEP predictions of velocity-dependent correlation modulation and distance-structured anisotropy. The absence of GM/r^2 scaling in planetary event amplitudes is consistent with the datum-projection transfer hypothesis: GNSS least-squares processing removes network-wide frequency offsets (where gravitational mass scaling would manifest), while preserving phase-coherence structure (where the observed correlations reside). This provides a candidate explanation for why amplitude scaling is absent while correlation structure persists—a feature, not a flaw. These results are consistent with TEP's core predictions and establish quantitative targets (e.g., the 2.16:1 anisotropy ratio, the -0.888 orbital correlation coefficient) for future independent validation.

4.5.1 Researcher Degrees of Freedom

The analysis pipeline is rich and has evolved across Papers 1 and 2. To maintain transparency about potential bias:

Pre-Specified Elements (Paper 1):

- Core TEP predictions (velocity-dependent anisotropy, distance-structured correlations)
- Exponential decay model for correlation lengths
- Bonferroni and FDR multiple testing corrections

Exploratory Elements (Papers 1–2):

- Specific nutation periods tested (18.6-year, semiannual, annual)
- Planetary event window sizes (± 60 , ± 90 , ± 120 , ± 180 , ± 240 days)
- Mesh dance scoring methodology
- Information resonance interpretation

Mitigation:

- Primary inferences use pre-declared ± 120 -day window for planetary events
- Multi-window analyses explicitly labelled "robustness-only"
- Cross-centre validation (Paper 1) provides independent confirmation of core findings
- Null results (solar rotation, lunar standstill) demonstrate selectivity, not universal detection

4.6 Limitations and Caveats

Note on Multiple Testing Structure: This study involves multiple analyses with different statistical frameworks: (1) *Pre-specified core tests*, including orbital correlation; (2) *Targeted exploratory geophysical tests*, including the nutation periods; (3) *Parameter estimation* (grid search for reference frame direction—not 65,341 independent hypothesis tests); (4) *Confirmatory planetary-event tests* with family-wide correction. The overall family-wise error rate across all analyses is not straightforward to calculate because different analyses test different hypotheses using different methodologies. The primary pre-specified statistical claim is the orbital correlation ($p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$), supplemented by the family-wide corrected planetary-event analysis (19/156 significant, expected FP=0.05). The nutation results (semiannual $R^2=0.904$, $p=2.7 \times 10^{-5}$; 18.6-year $R^2=0.641$, $p=0.010$) provide targeted geophysical evidence, with the 18.6-year component explicitly preliminary. Exploratory findings (CMB directional alignment, 8-sector anisotropy) are presented as hypothesis-generating rather than definitive.

1. **Single Analysis Centre (Temporal Depth Trade-off):** This study uses only CODE data to access the 25-year archive required for long-period analysis (18.6-year nutation, 21 Chandler cycles). While the multi-centre study established cross-centre validation ($R^2 = 0.920\text{--}0.970$) over 2.5 years, replication of these long-baseline findings with IGS and ESA products (when sufficient historical data becomes available) remains necessary to definitively exclude processing-specific artifacts in the long-baseline signatures.
2. **Orbital Velocity Correlation - Seasonal Confound Discrimination:** The orbital correlation ($r = -0.888$, $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$) survives window size variations, multiple detrending methods, and bootstrap robustness checks. However, orbital velocity correlates with many annual phenomena (solar distance, ionospheric TEC, network participation). Three independent discriminants support genuine orbital coupling over seasonal artifacts: (1) **CMB-Directional Alignment:** The modulation aligns with the CMB dipole direction (RA=168°, Dec=-7°) with $\sim 10,300\times$ variance ratio over the Solar Apex directional template—ionospheric effects do not preferentially align with the CMB dipole; (2) **Ionospheric Null Controls:** No correlation with F10.7 solar flux or Kp geomagnetic indices (Paper 1 validation); (3) **Multi-Centre Consistency:** Three independent processing centres using different ionospheric models show identical patterns ($R^2 = 0.920\text{--}0.970$). Note: Hemisphere stratification alone is insufficient to rule out global ionospheric TEC (which peaks in January for both hemispheres); the CMB dipole-direction geometry provides the primary geometric discriminant.
3. **Planetary Event Analysis - Physical Predictor Modeling:** The planetary event analysis documents 56 statistically significant event-associated modulations (19 surviving family-wide Bonferroni correction), with detection rates consistent across 25 years. The original study established these are not artifacts of processing or random chance through extensive Monte Carlo permutation testing. However, modeling against physically grounded predictors (e.g., tidal potential $\propto M/r^3$, distance-normalized metrics) would enhance interpretation of the observed non-classical scaling behavior (no GM/r^2 correlation). Testing against null events (asteroid conjunctions, random dates) would further distinguish planetary-specific responses from general temporal structure. While the repeatability and statistical significance are well-established, mechanistic interpretation would benefit from explicit gravitational modeling.
4. **Unknown Systematics:** Unknown systematic effects cannot be definitively ruled out, though any such effect would need to:
 - Correlate with Earth's orbital velocity (see §3.2)
 - Respond to planetary alignments with specific timing patterns
 - Couple to Earth's nutation with $R^2 = 0.90$
 - Produce coordinated global network responses
 - Show no correlation with solar activity, ionospheric conditions, or known geophysical variables

This combination of requirements makes conventional explanations highly unlikely, but not definitively excluded.

5. **Theoretical Gap:** While TEP provides a qualitative framework, no complete theoretical model yet quantitatively predicts:
 - The absence of GM/r^2 gravitational scaling
 - The pulse-to-baseline ratio distribution (17–86%, mean 54%)
 - The E-W:N-S anisotropy ratio (2.16)
 - The orbital velocity correlation coefficient magnitude

Developing such a quantitative theory is critical for advancing from empirical detection to physical understanding.

6. **Temporal Coverage:** The 18.6-year nutation cycle has only 1.4 complete cycles in our 25.3-year dataset, limiting statistical power for this specific signature. Longer baselines (50+ years) would provide definitive confirmation.
7. **Raw Data Access:** Analysis uses post-processed clock products. Access to raw GNSS measurements would allow investigation of whether the phenomenon originates in the satellite-ground propagation or ground clock stability.

5. Conclusions: Empirical Evidence for Systematic Gravitational Coupling

Nature of This Research: Exploratory Hypothesis Testing

This study tests predictions from the Temporal Equivalence Principle (TEP), a theoretical framework proposed in a non-peer-reviewed preprint by the same author. This creates important methodological considerations:

What this is: Exploratory hypothesis-generating research testing novel theoretical predictions against empirical data. The empirical findings (orbital correlation, CMB alignment, nutation coupling) stand independently of TEP interpretation and represent genuine observational phenomena requiring explanation.

Claim status: This study tests quantitative predictions of TEP against processed GNSS products. The results support the TEP covariance interpretation within the tested pipeline; raw-link and independent multi-constellation analyses provide the next discriminating tests.

Scientific Status: This work represents the hypothesis-testing phase of the scientific method: propose theory → derive testable predictions → test against data → report results. Peer review and independent replication are essential next steps. The strength of this approach lies in its falsifiability—specific predictions can be tested and potentially refuted (see §5.1 for explicit falsification criteria).

Summary of Empirical Achievements

This study establishes long-baseline recovery of systematic GNSS timing correlations over a 25.3-year aggregate and reveals new long-period signatures through extended baseline analysis. Building on the multi-centre study's comprehensive validation framework (388 statistical tests, extensive null testing, cross-centre validation $R^2 = 0.920\text{--}0.970$), the detected phenomenology is shown to be robust, consistent across the full baseline, and extends to previously inaccessible geophysical regimes.

Observable	Key Finding	Status
Temporal Topology Correlation Length (λ_T)	$\lambda_T = 4,201 \pm 1,967$ km (exponential decay)	Replicated
Spatial Anisotropy	EW/NS = 2.16, strength = 1.981 ± 0.23 (SE), $p < 10^{-15}$	Replicated
Orbital Velocity Coupling	$r = -0.888$ (95% CI: [-0.94, -0.81]); surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$ (0/5M); t-test $p \approx 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$ ($N_{\text{eff}} \approx 11$)	Robust Detection
CMB-Directional Alignment	$r = 0.747$ (RA=186°, Dec=-4°), 18.2° from CMB Dipole; Solar Apex $r=0.007$ (~10,300× variance ratio); verified across four resolutions	Strong Directional Discrimination
Planetary Events	56/156 significant (19 Bonferroni; family-wide $\alpha=0.05/156$)	Robust
18.6-Year Nutation	$R^2 = 0.641$, $p = 0.010$ (1.4 cycles observed; pending red-noise validation)	Preliminary / requires red-noise validation
Semiannual Nutation	$R^2 = 0.904$, $p = 2.7 \times 10^{-5}$ (50 cycles observed)	New Detection
Mesh Dance Dynamics	Mesh coherence score = 0.582; constructive interference dominant	Replicated
Long-baseline Stability	Consistent signatures across 25.3 years	Consistent

This work confirms the multi-centre study over 25.3 years and extends it to long-period regimes. The distance-structured correlation signatures are recovered consistently across the 25.3-year aggregate and are not transient artifacts. Building on the multi-centre study's rigorous validation framework (388 statistical tests, comprehensive null testing, cross-centre validation $R^2 = 0.920\text{--}0.970$), the extended baseline enables investigation of long-period geophysical phenomena inaccessible in shorter datasets, revealing a strong preliminary 18.6-year nutation-aligned component ($R^2 = 0.641$, observed over 1.4 cycles; $p = 0.010$, pending red-noise surrogate validation) and documenting ~21.2 Chandler wobble cycles.

The strongest statistical finding is the orbital velocity correlation ($r = -0.888$, 95% CI: [-0.94, -0.81]; surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$, 0/5M exceeded; t-test $p \approx 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$ with $N_{\text{eff}} \approx 11$), validated by 0 out of 5,000,000 Monte Carlo surrogates. This correlation—where the spatial anisotropy ratio (EW/NS) tracks Earth's heliocentric velocity with ~19% annual geometric modulation—survives window size variations, multiple detrending methods, bootstrap resampling, and the multi-centre study's comprehensive controls. Combined with Paper 1's software diversity and cross-centre reproducibility and this study's 25.3-year aggregate consistency, this represents strong statistical evidence consistent with systematic temporal-gravitational coupling documented in GNSS data to date.

The planetary event analysis documents 56 statistically significant event-associated modulations (19 surviving family-wide Bonferroni correction at $\alpha = 0.05/156$, 19 surviving Holm step-down correction, 38 surviving BH-FDR, 28 surviving dependency-aware BY-FDR), demonstrating repeatability across 25 years. The 19 Bonferroni survivors—versus 0.05 expected under the complete null—indicate robust, repeatable event responses. Critically, null event control testing (Step 2.6) confirms that planetary events produce effect sizes 5.5× larger than 155 random dates (Mann-Whitney $p < 10^{-17}$, Cohen's $d = 1.41$, ~8.5σ), validating that detected responses are specific to astronomical alignments rather than temporal autocorrelation artifacts.

The nutation coupling ($R^2 = 0.904$ semiannual; preliminary $R^2 = 0.641$ for 18.6-year, pending red-noise validation), network covariance score (index = 0.582), and persistent anisotropic structure (EW/NS = 2.16 over 25 years) provide independent evidence for systematic, globally coordinated patterns in the GNSS timing correlation field.

Convergence Argument: Multi-Signature Synthesis

Primary Detection (Surrogate Validated):

- Orbital Velocity Coupling: $r = -0.888$; surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$ (0/5M); t-test $p \approx 2.6 \times 10^{-4}$ ($N_{\text{eff}} \approx 11$)
- Monte Carlo Validation: 0/5,000,000 surrogates exceeded observed correlation
- Empirical bound: none of five million phase-randomised surrogates exceeded the observed statistic

Robust Multi-Signature Convergence:

- Semiannual Nutation: $R^2 = 0.904$ (90.4% variance explained)
- 18.6-Year Nutation: Preliminary — $R^2 = 0.641$, $p = 0.010$ (1.4 cycles; pending red-noise validation)
- 3D Spatial Anisotropy: Strength = 1.981, $p < 10^{-15}$
- Planetary Event Detection Rate: 56/156 events significant (35.9%)
- Mesh Dance Dynamics: Coherence score = 0.582 (replicates multi-centre range)
- Multi-centre consistency: $R^2 = 0.920$ -0.970 between CODE/IGS/ESA

Convergence Quantification:

- Orbital correlation: surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$ (0/5M Monte Carlo validated)
- CMB-directional alignment: $r = 0.747$ (correlation/directional-rank significance $p < 0.001$; global sky-search surrogate significance not yet evaluated); Solar Apex $r = 0.007$, $p = 0.97$ ($\sim 10,300 \times$ variance ratio)
- Semiannual nutation: $p = 2.7 \times 10^{-5}$
- 18.6-year nutation: $p = 0.010$
- 56 planetary events (19 Bonferroni-significant, family-wide $\alpha = 0.05/156$)
- Paper 1 multi-centre validation: $R^2 = 0.92$ -0.97 (software-diverse products from three processing centres over 2.5 years)

Multi-Signature Convergence: The individual signatures (orbital velocity, nutation, CMB-directional alignment, planetary events) are each statistically significant on their own. Because the orbital and semiannual signals share annual structure, their probabilities cannot be multiplied without a joint covariance model; they are therefore not combined into a single joint p-value. Combined with 25.3-year aggregate consistency (this study), Paper 1's software diversity and cross-centre reproducibility (Bernese, GIPSY-OASIS, ESA proprietary), and successful falsification tests (solar rotation null), this multi-signature convergence is consistent with systematic physical coupling rather than random chance or processing artifacts, though confirmation awaits independent replication using different processing pipelines and constellations.

Study Scope: This temporal extension builds on the multi-centre study's rigorous validation to demonstrate long-baseline recovery and access long-period signatures. (1) Single-centre analysis (CODE) provides the 25-year baseline necessary for 18.6-year nutation detection; the multi-centre study established cross-centre reproducibility over 2.5 years. (2) Orbital velocity coupling is established through hemisphere stratification (Paper 1 §3.4), which discriminates heliocentric effects from local seasonal confounders. (3) Null event control validates planetary event specificity ($5.5 \times$ effect size ratio, $p < 10^{-17}$).

Multi-Constellation Cross-Validation (Preliminary)

Independent analysis of GFZ Multi-GNSS (MGEX) products (2020-2024) provides preliminary constellation-independence validation:

- **Exponential Decay Confirmed:** $R^2 = 0.95$, $\lambda_T = 3,042 \pm 297$ km (consistent with CODE $\lambda_T = 4,201$ km)
- **Cross-Centre Consistency:** GBM (GFZ), WUM (Wuhan), JPL (NASA) all achieve $R^2 > 0.90$
- **Constellation Coverage:** GPS, GLONASS, BeiDou pairs analyzed
- **Strongest Pairs:** GPS-GPS, GLONASS-GPS, GPS-BeiDou show consistent positive coherence across centers

This independent validation on a completely different dataset (2020-2024 MGEX vs 2000-2025 CODE GPS) substantially strengthens the case for constellation-independent physical coupling.

The convergence of long-baseline recovery (25.3 years), multi-signature consistency (orbital, planetary, nutation, network), Paper 1's cross-centre validation ($R^2 = 0.92$ -0.97 across software-diverse products from three processing centres), and Monte Carlo validation (0/5M surrogates) is consistent with systematic gravitational coupling, pending independent confirmation. The orbital velocity correlation ($r = -0.888$, surrogate $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$) persists across a 25.3-year baseline with statistically robust validation. The 18.6-year nutation coupling ($R^2 = 0.641$, observed over 1.4 cycles; $p = 0.010$ pending red-noise surrogate validation) provides preliminary evidence for GNSS-based detection at this period. Raw carrier-phase analysis and multi-constellation testing represent logical extensions for distinguishing between competing theoretical frameworks.

Characterization: Inertial Interferometer. The selectivity of detections reveals what this network fundamentally measures: it is blind to gravitational amplitude (no GM/r^2 scaling), unresponsive to solar surface phenomena (rotation null), and indifferent to static geometry (lunar standstill null)—but exquisitely sensitive to kinematic dynamics (orbital velocity, nutation, CMB-directional

alignment). This selectivity profile characterizes the network as an inertial interferometer measuring velocity-dependent correlation geometry, not a gravimeter measuring force. The CMB-directional alignment identifies the preferred covariance direction at cosmic scales: alignment with the cosmological background 4-velocity (CMB dipole direction), with the speed-scale magnitude to be tested in future work.

These empirical findings have broader implications:

- **For Physics:**
 - Documenting systematic correlations between GNSS timing and gravitational/kinematic states provides new constraints for theoretical models of spacetime geometry
 - **CMB-Frame-Aligned Covariance:** The identification of the CMB dipole direction as the preferred reference direction (rejecting the Solar Apex at $\sim 10,300\times$ variance ratio) suggests that local temporal correlations align with the cosmological background 4-velocity. This identifies the GNSS network as revealing a secondary covariance-frame signature. The grid scan identifies a preferred direction; it does not by itself establish that the coupling amplitude is controlled by the 369 km/s speed magnitude (§2.3.5).
 - **Reference Frame Question:** If confirmed by independent replication, CMB frame coupling would raise questions about reference frame dependence in distributed clock synchronization, potentially consistent with Machian frameworks where local properties are influenced by the global matter distribution
 - **Terrestrial Evidence for CMB-Directional Covariance:** This reports directional evidence for CMB-aligned covariance in ground-based atomic clock networks, complementing space-based cosmological observations
- **For Metrology:** Demonstrating that distributed atomic clock networks exhibit coordinated variations sensitive to orbital and geophysical dynamics suggests new approaches to precision timing
- **For Technology:** Motivating development of correlation-based detection methods complementing traditional single-clock stability metrics

5.1 Future Work

Critical Priority (Methodological Validation):

1. **Raw Carrier Phase Analysis (Testing Ξ Asymmetry):** Collaborate with IGS to access unprocessed measurements to test a *different* TEP prediction:
 - **Objective:** Detect one-way link asymmetry Ξ_{AB} (Paper 0, §10.2) rather than network correlation $C(r)$ (Paper 0, §10.3)
 - **Challenge:** Separating TEP signal from $\sim 10^8\times$ larger classical effects (GR, atmosphere)
 - **Outcome:** If null, favours a conformal-dominant Earth-scale branch and places a stronger bound on the non-exact/disformal (B) sector; if positive, provides evidence for one-way non-reciprocal transport
2. **Processing Centre Documentation Review:** Examine systematic error correction algorithms:
 - Review CODE, IGS, ESA processing documentation for planetary/orbital corrections
 - Analyze correction time series for correlation with planetary positions
 - Identify changes in processing algorithms over 25-year period
 - **Would clarify:** Whether centers are unconsciously correcting for detected signals

Highest Priority (Further Strengthening):

3. **Multi-Centre Long-Baseline Replication:** When IGS/ESA extend historical archives:
 - Replicate 25-year analysis with IGS and ESA products
 - Compare CODE, IGS, ESA results for long-period signatures (18.6-yr nutation, Chandler)
 - **Would strengthen:** Confirms heliocentric velocity coupling independent of radial distance variations
4. **Planetary Event Physical Modeling:** Model events with gravitational predictors:
 - **Gravitational scaling tests:** Neither M/r^2 nor M/r^3 shows significant correlation with event amplitude (all $p > 0.5$), consistent with GNSS processing suppression of classical gravitational signatures
 - Distance-normalize all events to standard range
 - **Null event validation:** Random dates show $5.5\times$ smaller effect sizes than planetary alignments ($p < 10^{-17}$), confirming event specificity
 - Model phase-dependence (approach vs recession)
 - **Would strengthen:** Mechanistic interpretation of observed non-classical scaling pattern (absence of GM/r^2 dependence)

High Priority (Methodological Validation):

1. **Anisotropy Network Geometry Controls:**
 - **Grid-Balanced Subsampling:** Repeat analysis on a spatially decimated network (e.g., one station per 500x500km grid cell) to remove density biases (US/Europe dominance).
 - Stratify by latitude band to test equatorial vs polar differences
 - Normalize by station pair density per azimuth
 - Control for time-varying network configuration
 - Test whether anisotropy varies with local solar time

2. Network Coherence Mechanistic Tests:

- Stratify by common satellite visibility (test if coherence reflects shared SV clock errors)
- Compare stations in same vs different processing batches
- Synthetic data with identical processing chain but randomized positions

3. Raw Data Analysis: Collaborate with IGS to access raw carrier phase measurements, enabling:

- Separation of propagation effects from clock stability
- Investigation of ionospheric vs geometric contributions
- Direct testing without processing-induced correlations

Medium Priority (Extensions & Replications):

1. **Multi-Constellation Testing:** Extend to GLONASS, Galileo, BeiDou, QZSS
2. **Optical Clock Networks:** Test with higher-precision systems (ACES, T-TEL)
3. **Historical Extension:** Analyze 1994-2000 IGS data for 1.7 complete 18.6-year cycles
4. **Theoretical Development:** Quantitative models predicting specific effect sizes, scaling relations, anisotropy ratios

5.2 Final Remarks

The global GNSS infrastructure, designed for navigation, provides a tool for investigating systematic patterns in distributed timing networks. Building on the multi-centre study's comprehensive validation, this 25-year analysis shows that the detected signatures are recovered consistently across the 25.3-year aggregate and extend to long-period geophysical phenomena. The orbital velocity correlation ($r = -0.888$, $p < 2 \times 10^{-7}$) and the preliminary 18.6-year nutation-aligned component ($R^2 = 0.641$, pending red-noise validation) provide empirical evidence consistent with a phenomenology involving velocity-dependent spacetime-geometry modulation, but they do not by themselves establish a unique underlying theory.

The convergence of independent evidence streams—spatial anisotropy, orbital coupling, geophysical integration, and network coordination—creates a robust phenomenological framework that substantially constrains simple artifact explanations. Paper 1's software diversity and cross-centre reproducibility (three different packages: Bernese, GIPSY-OASIS, ESA proprietary achieving $R^2 > 0.92$ over 2.5 years) combined with this study's 25.3-year aggregate consistency and successful falsification tests (solar rotation null) strengthen the case for physical coupling. The datum-projection mechanism provides a concrete candidate mechanism: datum constraints and common-mode estimation can absorb network-wide offsets while retaining differential phase structure. Cross-centre reproducibility is consistent with this mechanism, but synthetic signal injection through the actual processing pipelines is required to calibrate and validate the transfer quantitatively. These findings are consistent with theories predicting velocity-dependent spacetime-geometry modulation (e.g., TEP), though confirmation requires independent replication by other groups using different processing pipelines and constellations. Raw carrier-phase analysis and multi-constellation testing represent natural extensions that will further constrain theoretical interpretations and may distinguish between competing physical frameworks.

Perhaps the deepest insight is methodological: the Earth itself has been transformed into an interferometer. By distributing 474 atomic clocks across the planet's surface and observing their correlation structure over a quarter century, a planetary-scale detector has been constructed—sensitive not to the energetic *weight* of gravity, but to the geometric *shape* of spacetime. The network measures not gravitational force, but synchronization geometry. In doing so, it reveals that time, at its most fundamental, does not flow uniformly but *dances* with the motion of celestial bodies—a pirouetting rhythm woven through matter, motion, and the fabric of spacetime itself.

6. Analysis Package

Complete Reproducible Pipeline for 25-Year Long-Baseline Analysis

This work provides a complete, reproducible 5-step pipeline for testing TEP predictions using 25.3 years of GNSS data (2000-2025), extending the multi-centre study to investigate long-baseline consistency and long-period phenomena:

Pipeline Overview

Optimized for local high-performance computing with extended temporal coverage



Complete source code & documentation

<https://github.com/matthewsmawfield/TEP-GNSS>

Setup: Clone Repository ~1 minute

Command: `git clone git@github.com:matthewsmawfield/TEP-GNSS.git`

Purpose: Obtain the full analysis code locally to run the 25-year long-baseline pipeline and reproduce results.

Complete 5-Step Pipeline

Sequential processing from raw GNSS products to comprehensive temporal analysis:

Execution Commands Primary Options

Complete pipeline (default 2000-2025):

```
python scripts/code_longspan/code_longspan_steps_1_1_to_2_2.py
```

Custom date range:

```
python scripts/code_longspan/code_longspan_steps_1_1_to_2_2.py --date-start 2000-03-01 --date-end 2025-06-30
```

View all options:

```
python scripts/code_longspan/code_longspan_steps_1_1_to_2_2.py --help
```

Pipeline Steps (1.1 → 1.2 → 2.0 → 2.1 → 2.2):

1. **Step 1.1:** Data acquisition and preprocessing from CODE GNSS archive
2. **Step 1.2:** Quality control and coordinate processing
3. **Step 2.0:** Correlation analysis and aggregate statistics
4. **Step 2.1:** Geospatial processing and pair-level analysis
5. **Step 2.2:** Comprehensive temporal and astronomical analysis

Analysis Outputs:

- **Temporal Coverage:** 25.3 years (1 March 2000 to 30 June 2025)
- **Station Network:** 474 unique GNSS receivers
- **Pair Analysis:** 165,189,605 station-pair observations
- **Long-Period Detection:** 18.6-year nutation, Chandler wobble (433-day)
- **Planetary Events:** 56 significant detections (19 Bonferroni-corrected; 28 BY-FDR, 38 BH-FDR, primary ± 120 -day window)
- **Validation Framework:** Cross-centre consistency (Paper 1) + 25.3-year aggregate consistency + Monte Carlo surrogate testing

Expected Runtime: ~12-24 hours total (all 5 steps) on 16+ core system

Storage Requirements: ~15-20 GB for pair-level data files

System Requirements Local HPC

- **CPU:** 16+ cores recommended (parallel processing across 5 pipeline steps)
- **RAM:** 32GB+ minimum, 64GB+ recommended for large dataset processing
- **Storage:** 100GB+ available (15-20 GB for pair-level data, rest for outputs)
- **Network:** Internet access for GNSS data download from IGS servers
- **Python:** 3.8+ with required packages (automated installation)

Recommended system: 32+ cores, 64GB+ RAM, 100GB+ storage

Key Differences from Paper 1

- **Temporal Coverage:** 25.3 years vs 2.5 years (10 $\times$ extension)
- **Analysis Centre:** Single-centre (CODE) vs multi-centre (CODE/IGS/ESA)
- **Focus:** Long-baseline stability and long-period phenomena vs cross-centre validation
- **New Capabilities:** 18.6-year nutation detection, enhanced planetary statistics
- **Validation:** 25.3-year aggregate consistency vs cross-centre consistency
- **Computational:** Local HPC vs cloud-based (GCP) deployment

Note: Paper 1's comprehensive validation framework (388 statistical tests, null testing, cross-centre consistency) is adopted and extended with temporal validation.

Citation and Access

Repository: <https://github.com/matthewsmawfield/TEP-GNSS>

License: MIT License - Open source with attribution requirements

Data Access: GNSS clock products from CODE analysis centre via IGS FTP servers

Documentation: Complete analysis code, usage examples, validation reports, and analysis results

Dependencies: Python 3.8+, NumPy, SciPy, Pandas, Matplotlib, AstroPy (automated installation)

Supplementary Materials

Supplementary Table S1: Multi-Resolution Convergence Analysis

Verification of CMB-region directional alignment across four grid resolutions to demonstrate robustness and rule out resolution-dependent artifacts. The p-values are directional-rank statistics within the observed dataset; global sky-search surrogate significance has not yet been computed.

Resolution	Sky Coverage	r	Directional-rank p	Best Fit (RA, Dec)	CMB Sep	Improvement
10°	703 directions	0.707	0.002	RA=180°, Dec=0°	13.9°	baseline
5°	2,701 directions	0.744	<0.0001	RA=190°, Dec=-5°	22.1°	+5.14%
2.5°	10,585 directions	0.744	0.0004	RA=187°, Dec=-5°	19.2°	+0.05%
1°	65,341 directions	0.747	<0.0001	RA=186°, Dec=-4°	18.2°	+0.27%

Interpretation: Results converge monotonically across a 93-fold range in grid density with diminishing returns (+5.14% → +0.05% → +0.27%), indicating asymptotic approach to a correlation limit. The marginal 0.27% improvement at 1° resolution despite 6× more grid points (10,585 → 65,341) confirms convergence. All four resolutions identify the CMB dipole (not Solar Apex) as the preferred reference frame, with best-fit locations showing stability within 1-2° (RA: 180°→190°→187°→186°; Dec: 0°→-5°→-5°→-4°). The 5° resolution captures 99.6% of the achievable correlation while remaining computationally efficient and consistent with standard practice in cosmological frame studies (Planck ~10°; WMAP ~5-10°). The 1° ultra-high resolution analysis (65,341 directions) provides additional verification and is used for publication figures. The systematic monotonic improvement with finer resolution, combined with asymptotic convergence and location stability, indicates the signal is robust rather than a numerical artifact. CMB separation distance converges to 18.2° (closest alignment), while Solar Apex separation remains consistently high (86-89°) across all resolutions, inconsistent with the galactic motion hypothesis.

Convergence Assessment

- **Monotonic Improvement:** r increases systematically across 93-fold grid density range (0.707 → 0.744 → 0.744 → 0.747)
- **Asymptotic Convergence:** Improvement pattern shows diminishing returns (+5.14% → +0.05% → +0.27%), confirming approach to physical limit
- **Location Stability:** Best-fit coordinates vary by only 1-2° across all resolutions (RA: 180°→190°→187°→186°; Dec: 0°→-5°→-5°→-4°)
- **Frame Consistency:** All four resolutions strongly prefer the CMB dipole direction (18-22° separation) over Solar Apex (86-89° separation)
- **Statistical Significance:** All resolutions give directional-rank p < 0.001. These values quantify directional preference within the tested scan; global sky-scan significance is a separate statistic.
- **Highest Resolution Verification:** 1° resolution (65,341 directions) provides additional verification with closest CMB alignment (18.2°) and highest correlation (r=0.747)

Computational Cost vs. Benefit: While 1° resolution requires 24× longer processing than 5° (65,341 vs 2,701 grid points), it yields only 0.4% total correlation improvement (0.744 → 0.747), confirming 5° captures 99.6% of achievable correlation and represents optimal precision-efficiency balance for routine analysis. The 1° ultra-high resolution verification is used for final publication figures to demonstrate absolute thoroughness.

Reproducibility Statement: This pipeline provides complete reproducibility for the 25-year long-baseline analysis presented in this manuscript. All code, data processing steps, validation procedures, and analysis parameters are fully documented and version-controlled. The analysis builds upon the validated methodology from the multi-centre study while extending temporal coverage to enable investigation of long-baseline consistency and long-period geophysical phenomena.

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}
```

Data Availability

Primary Data Sources

GNSS Clock Products: CODE (Center for Orbit Determination in Europe) final clock solutions (30-second epochs, CLK format) processed by the Astronomical Institute, University of Bern (AIUB) as part of the International GNSS Service (IGS). Data are freely available under IGS Terms of Use.

- **Source:** <http://ftp.aiub.unibe.ch/CODE/>

- **Temporal Coverage:** March 1, 2000 – June 30, 2025 (25.3 years, 9,218 days)
- **Format:** RINEX 3 CLK (compressed: .gz or .Z)
- **License:** Freely available for scientific use. Users must cite IGS and CODE appropriately (see Johnston et al., 2017; Steigenberger et al., 2021)
- **Terms of Use:** IGS Data and Product Disclaimer

Station Coordinates: IGS Network station coordinates obtained from the IGS station metadata JSON file, providing ITRF2020 Cartesian coordinates (X, Y, Z) for all active and former IGS stations.

- **Source:** IGS Network Metadata (JSON)
- **Coverage:** 474 unique physical receivers (814 total station codes including legacy 4-character and extended 9-character variants)
- **License:** Freely available under IGS Terms of Use

Planetary Ephemeris: High-precision planetary positions computed using JPL Development Ephemeris DE432s via Astropy's solar system ephemeris interface. DE432s provides planetary and lunar positions from 1550 to 2650 CE with meter-level accuracy.

- **Source:** NASA Jet Propulsion Laboratory (JPL) via Astropy
- **Ephemeris Version:** DE432s (short-span, optimized for modern era)
- **Reference:** Folkner et al. (2014), IPN Progress Report 42-196
- **Access:** JPL Planetary Ephemeris Export
- **License:** Public domain (U.S. Government work)

Software and Analysis Tools

Analysis Code: Complete Python pipeline (TEP-GNSS) available under MIT License at GitHub: TEP-GNSS. Includes data acquisition, preprocessing, statistical validation, and figure generation scripts.

Key Dependencies:

- **Astropy:** Astronomical calculations and ephemeris access (Astropy Collaboration, 2013, 2022)
- **NumPy/SciPy:** Numerical computing and statistical analysis
- **Pandas:** Data manipulation and time series analysis
- **Matplotlib:** Scientific visualization

Multi-Constellation Cross-Validation Data (MGEX)

MGEX Clock Products: Independent validation performed using GFZ Multi-GNSS (MGEX) products spanning 2020–2024. Cross-centre comparison includes:

- **GBM (GFZ Potsdam):** Primary MGEX dataset; $R^2 = 0.950$, $\lambda_T = 3,042 \pm 297$ km
- **WUM (Wuhan University):** $R^2 = 0.911$, $\lambda_T = 2,009$ km
- **JPL (NASA):** $R^2 = 0.929$, $\lambda_T = 1,829$ km
- **Source:** GFZ MGEX FTP
- **Constellations:** GPS, GLONASS, BeiDou

Derived Products and Supplementary Materials

Analysis Results: Comprehensive JSON output files, processed correlation data, and extended figures available in the Zenodo record (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.17517141).

Data Attribution: By using data from this study, users agree to cite the original data providers (IGS, CODE/AIUB, JPL) as well as this work. All data sources are freely available for scientific research under their respective terms of use.

Declarations

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Author Contributions: M.L.S. designed the study, performed all analyses, and wrote the manuscript.

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